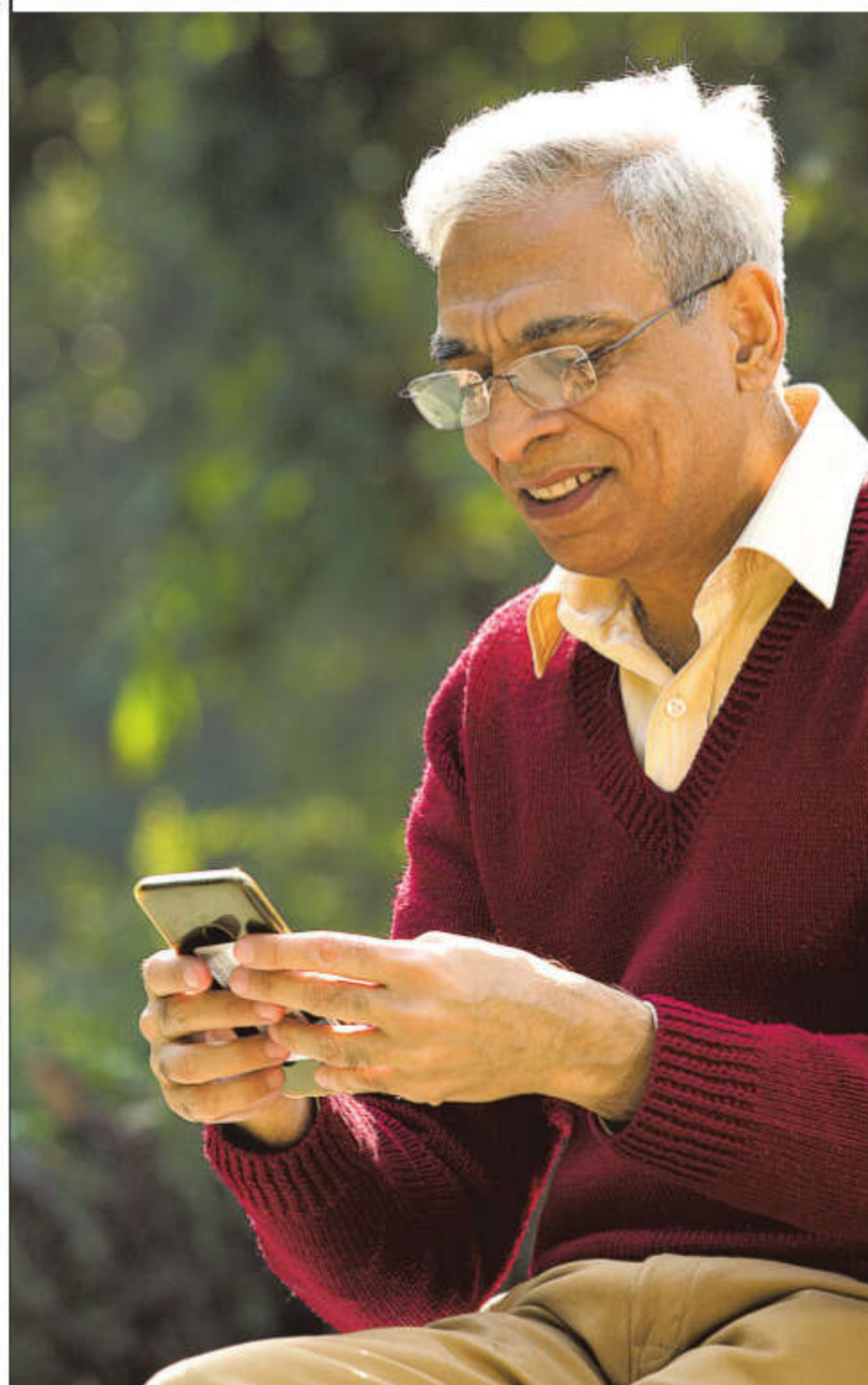




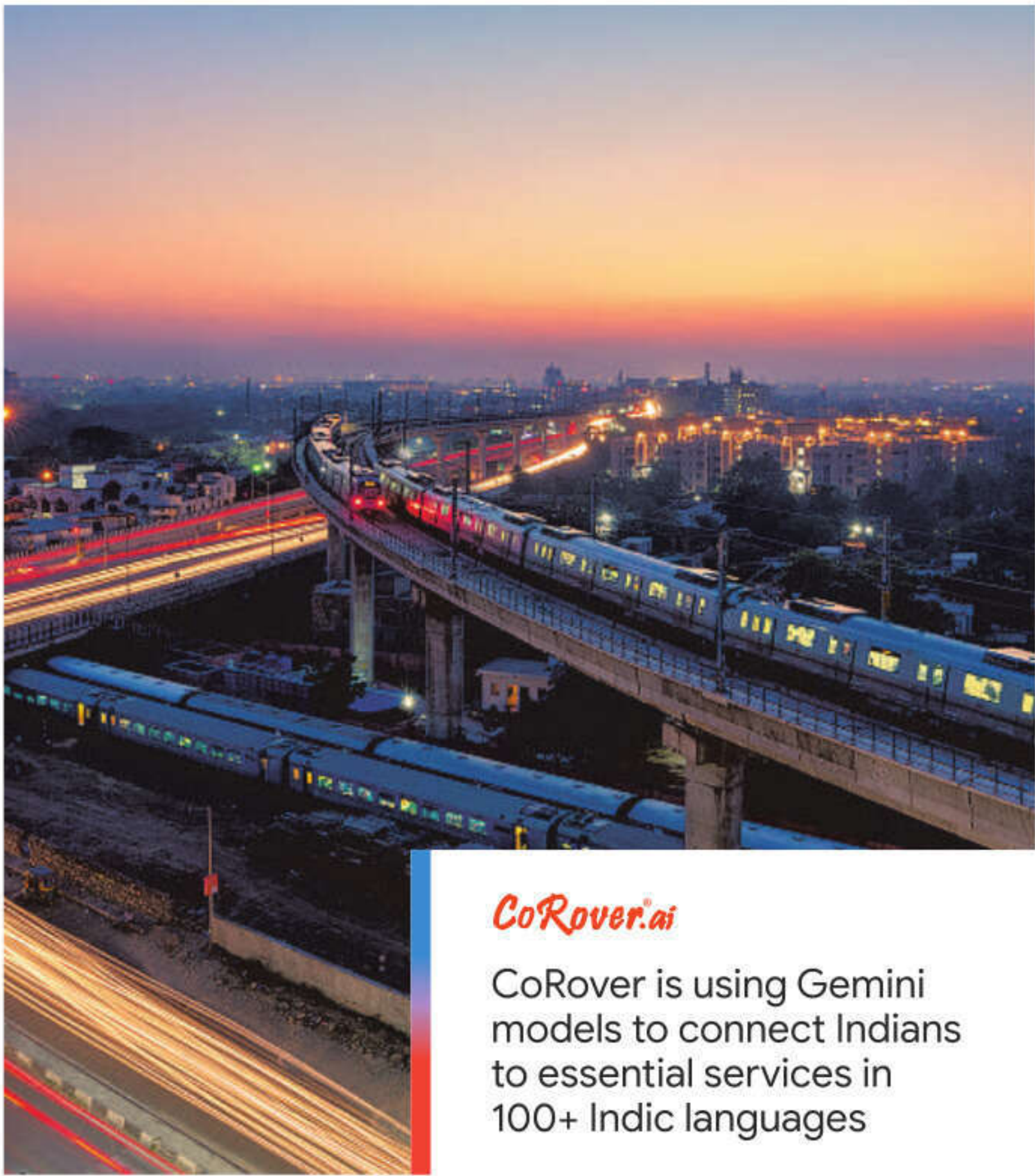
A new era of Innovation



The potential of AI to deliver population-scale impact can be realized only with crucial collaboration across India's academic, public and private ecosystems. From agriculture and healthcare to education and essential services, our partners are using **Google AI** to solve the nation's greatest challenges.

Together, we continue our commitment to ensuring AI delivers real impact, safely and responsibly, to drive progress for every Indian.

A new era of Innovation



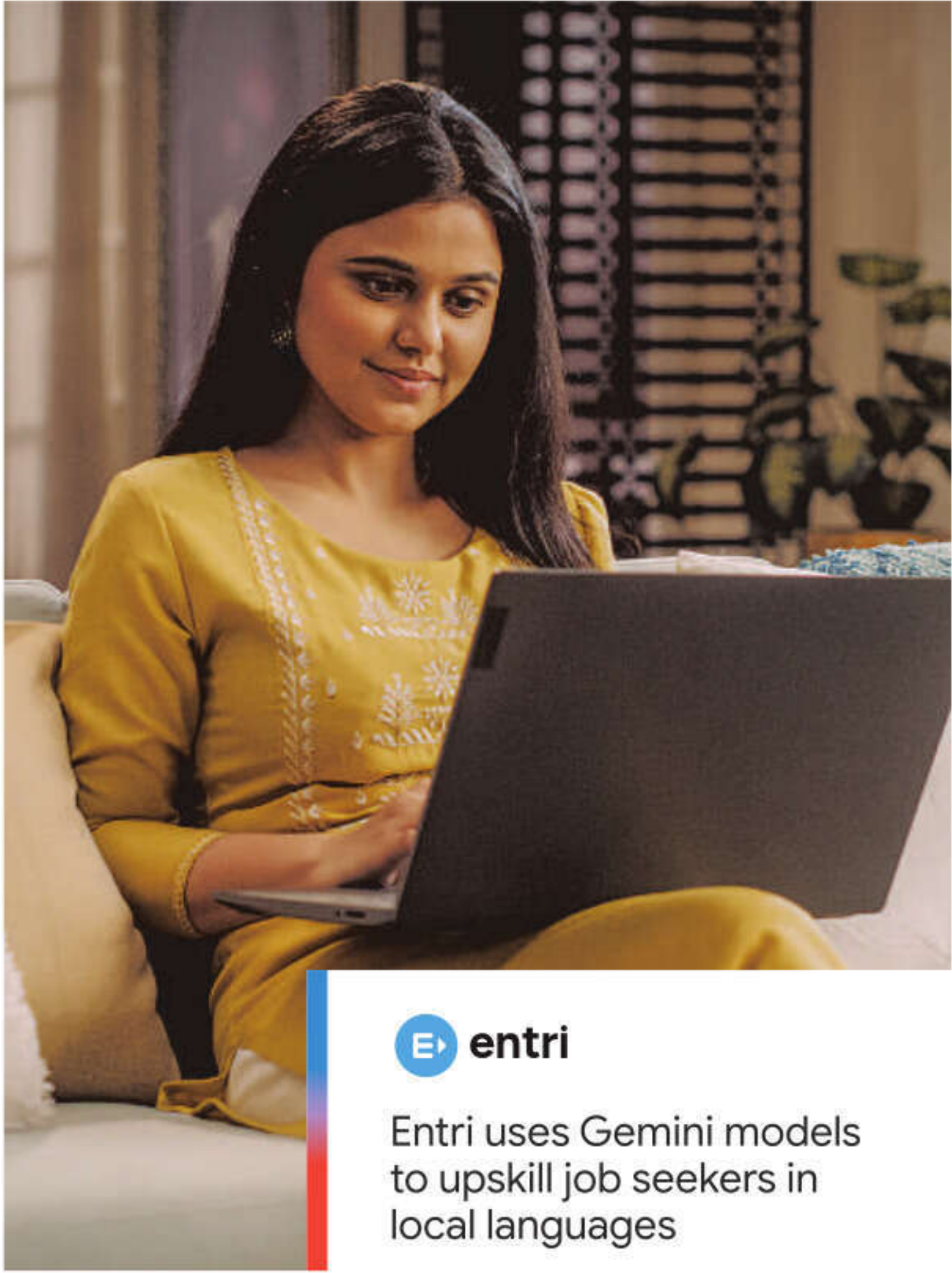
CoRover.ai

CoRover is using Gemini models to connect Indians to essential services in 100+ Indic languages



Terrastack

Terrastack uses Google AI to power models that integrate satellite, crop, weather and administrative data to unlock land intelligence across India's farming system



entri

Entri uses Gemini models to upskill job seekers in local languages



WADHWANI AI

HealthVaani, powered by Google AI, provides verified health information in local languages to help frontline workers deliver better care



Scan to learn more





DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

Happening today

● A BENCH of the Patiala House Court is scheduled to hear the Indian Polo Association's appeal against the Centre's takeover of the Jaipur Polo Ground in Delhi.

TRACK THIS AND MORE ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



THE BIG PICTURE



LIVES AT SEA
Hormuz set to reopen, a look at what draws Indians to the seafaring workforce
[PAGE 13](#)

Mumbai INOX executive duped of Rs 10.4 cr via WhatsApp, four arrested in Delhi

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, June 16

A SENIOR accounts executive with the INOX Group in Mumbai was allegedly duped into transferring more than Rs 10.40 crore in 63 transactions over several days this month after receiving WhatsApp messages from a mobile number he believed was that of the company's Executive Director, Siddharth Jain. The conglomerate has interests in industrial gases and is a cinema chain major. As the Mumbai Police launched an investigation, Delhi Police Tuesday arrested four persons, including two who had allegedly rented out
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

India seeks \$900-mn steel quota to end UK trade deal logjam

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, June 16

INDIA IS pushing for a steel quota in the UK market worth nearly \$900 million under the bilateral free trade agreement (FTA) signed in July 2025 in a bid to resolve the ongoing row over steel curbs announced by the UK. *The Indian Express* has learned.

● TENSION ON AND OFF THE FIELD DURING MATCH AGAINST NEW ZEALAND, WHICH ENDED 2-2

Iran plays in LA, told to leave the country soon after: 'Our team most oppressed'



Sandip G
New Jersey, June 16

WHEN IRAN reached the locker room after their tense 2-2 draw against New Zealand on Monday, bouncing back twice from a goal down, they were informed of a late change

150 MILLION USERS PUNISHED: TELEGRAM FOUNDER

Govt bans Telegram until June 22 in bid to 'secure' NEET retest

Platform told to disable editing of messages posted until June 30

Soumyarendra Barik & Abhinaya Harigovind
New Delhi, June 16

THE GOVERNMENT Tuesday temporarily blocked Telegram, a popular messaging application, until June 22, after the platform's "non-responsiveness" in aiding the ongoing probe into the May 3 NEET-UG paper leak and for curbing the spread of fraudulent claims of access to the June 21 re-examination paper by handles on the platform. *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Telegram is among the most popular personal messaging applications in the country, with an estimated 150 million users, behind only Meta's WhatsApp, which has over 500 million users.

Pavel Durov, founder of the Telegram messaging app, said that by temporarily banning Telegram in the country, the Indian authorities have "punished" over 150 million ordinary users in India.

The ban has not stopped
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Kota is the hub for NEET preparations. PARUL KULSHRESTHA

BJP and Cong face off ahead of Rahul visit, Kota wants to be left alone

Parul Kulshreshtha
Kota, June 16

A DAY before senior Congress leader Rahul Gandhi arrives in Kota to kick off his campaign on issues plaguing the education sector, hoping to tap into public anger sparked by the NEET paper leak, the coaching hub has other things on its mind. Like, ironically, the NEET retest, scheduled for June 21.

As Congress leaders approached students as well as

coaching institutes, urging owners to send their members for the meeting Gandhi will address Wednesday, there was more than a little consternation over the timing of the Congress leader's public engagement.

By mid-Tuesday, the BJP had seized on this to mount protests in Kota against Gandhi's interaction, accusing him of inconveniencing students.

Gandhi, who dropped his plans to take a train from Delhi
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

BILATERAL TALKS WITH U.S. PRESIDENT TODAY

Trump listening, Modi tells G7: Shortage of trust, need to rebuild

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, June 16

UNDERLINING THAT "mutual trust is the most important strategic asset today" and that the world "suffers from a shortage of trust", Prime Minister Narendra Modi Tuesday told leaders of the G7, including US President Donald Trump, that the "future of our partnerships depends on rebuilding this trust".

Welcoming efforts to end the crisis in West Asia, Modi, while addressing the leaders at the summit in Evian-les-Bains in eastern France, flagged the issue of the Strait of Hormuz and the



PM Narendra Modi with President Donald Trump in Evian, Tuesday. AP
death of Indians, including seafarers, in the conflict.
"We welcome the progress
made in peace efforts in West Asia. Our friendly nations in
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Now, Uddhav's Sena stares at split, 4 of 9 MPs reach Delhi with Shinde

Vallabh Ozkarar
Mumbai, June 16

AMID GROWING speculation about a group of MPs of the Uddhav Thackeray-led Shiv Sena (UBT) planning to break away, several of them reached Delhi on Tuesday while Deputy Chief Minister and Sena leader Eknath Shinde left for the Capital late in the night, sources

said. In response, MP Arvind Sawant, on behalf of the Sena (UBT), has written to Speaker Om Birla, urging him not to recognise any breakaway group of the party's MPs.

This comes after reports about a breakaway group forming in the Sena (UBT)'s parliamentary party, just a week before the fourth anniversary of
»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NEWS 18 इंडिया PRESENTS **अमृत रत्न**
देश के लाल और बेदियां बेमिसाल

CO-PRESENTED BY: vedanta, DRIVEN BY: Kia Syros, STATE PARTNERS: [Logos], CO-POWERED BY: Rajesh MASALA, orient electric, Hamdard, DOLLAR BIGBOSS, ASSOCIATE PARTNER: Reliance

जहां होगा उनका सम्मान
जिन्होंने बढ़ाया देश का मान

 किरेन रीजू संसदीय कार्य एवं अल्पसंख्यक कार्य मंत्री	 सी. आर. पाटिल केंद्रीय जल शक्ति मंत्री
 जितिन प्रसाद केंद्रीय वाणिज्य एवं उद्योग राज्य मंत्री	 संजय सेठ केंद्रीय रक्षा राज्य मंत्री
 रेखा गुप्ता मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली	 स्मृति इरानी पूर्व केंद्रीय मंत्री
 जनरल वी.पी. मलिक पूर्व थल सेना अध्यक्ष	 आलिया भट्ट अभिनेत्री
 राकेश बेदी अभिनेता	 सोनू निगम गायक
 ज़ीनत अमान अभिनेत्री	 गुरदास मान गायक, गीतकार एवं अभिनेता
 बाइचुंग भट्टिया पूर्व फुटबॉलर	 पंडित विश्वमोहन भट्ट श्रेणी विजेता
 पंडित सलिल भट्ट सात्विक वीणा अविष्कारक	 शुभांशु शुक्ला अंतरिक्ष यात्री
 डॉ. शुभा वी. अयंगर वैज्ञानिक	

आज दोपहर 2 बजे से, सिर्फ NEWS 18 इंडिया पर



लाइव देखने के लिए स्कैन करें

www.News18India.com

फॉलो करें: News18India





AROUND 4 LAKH PEOPLE EXPECTED TO BENEFIT

New slum and JJ cluster rehabilitation policy for Delhi ready, says Amit Shah

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 16

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday said that the Delhi Slum and JJ Cluster Rehabilitation and Relocation Policy, 2026, has been finalised, and directed the Delhi government to notify it at the earliest.

Chairing a review meeting on slum rehabilitation, Shah asked the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) and the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) to issue tenders for five Jhuggi Jhopdi (JJ) clusters within 45 days.

The Union Minister also directed officials to prepare project documents and tender forms for 50 additional JJ clusters. According to officials, the decisions taken at the meeting are expected to benefit around four lakh families living in Delhi's JJ clusters.

In a push for time-bound implementation, Shah said the Delhi government should float tenders for at least five public-private partnership-based rehabilitation projects every month.



Amit Shah, LG Taranjit Singh Sandhu, CM Rekha Gupta at the meeting on Tuesday.

He said rehabilitation colonies should be planned with adequate social infrastructure, including anganwadi centres, schools, health centres and playgrounds.

Shah also said the eligibility cut-off date for JJ clusters should be January 1, 2025.

The meeting was attended by Union Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal, Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Delhi's Urban Development Minister, the Union Home Secretary, the Delhi Chief Secretary and other senior officials.

Shah said the Centre was committed to the welfare of the poor under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership.

The Indian Express had earlier reported that there are 675 slums in the Capital under the Delhi government's Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB). Of these, 376 are on government land and come under the DDA jurisdiction, while 299 come under DUSIB's jurisdiction.

The DDA's 2007 slum rehabilitation policy covers public private partnerships in redevelopment of slums, but the implementation has been slow. DDA had floated a tender in 2022 for six such projects, but found no takers. The Delhi government's Delhi Slum and Jhuggi Jhopri Rehabilitation and Relocation Policy, 2015, includes in-situ rehabilitation or development of alternate housing within 5km.

According to sources, previous attempts in this direction failed due to lack of viability gap funding for the projects with the last unsuccessful tender aimed at the in-situ rehabilitation of such clusters in Delhi floated in 2022.

PHASE-1 OF CENSUS 2027 ENDS IN DELHI

54.9 lakh households listed in Capital, most in South West, North East districts

Population Enumeration will be held in February 2027

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, June 16

SOUTH WEST and North East districts have topped the household enumeration list as the first phase of the Census 2027 ended on Monday in the national capital. Of the 54.98 lakh households listed in the city, 8.20 lakh households have been enumerated in the South West district while the North East district has 8.04 lakh households.

Across the Capital, an increase of more than 20 lakh households has been recorded as compared to the 2011 exercise when 34.35 lakh households were listed. Meanwhile, a total of 75.98 lakh households have been counted in the exercise.

However, a direct comparison cannot be drawn with the findings of Census 2011 as the districts in Delhi underwent a

₹38,400 Crore Record Defence Exports enhancing India's pride

5,500+ Defence Items Delisted from Imports, Boosting indigenous defence industry



DISTRICT	TOTAL HLBS	TOTAL NO. OF CENSUS HOUSES	TOTAL NO. OF HOUSEHOLDS
New Delhi	585	1,02,706	63,050
Old Delhi	1,606	2,96,196	1,63,785
Central	2,356	3,59,383	2,44,816
Central North	2,234	3,81,428	2,73,669
North	3,467	5,45,533	3,98,447
Outer North	4,137	7,21,732	4,35,631
South	3,526	6,79,007	5,34,212
North West	4,313	6,25,088	4,65,586
East	4,101	7,52,169	5,47,461
South East	4,349	7,07,660	5,43,412
West	4,999	8,02,589	5,89,210
South West	4,241	8,20,529	6,25,453
North East	5,949	8,04,962	6,13,828
TOTAL	45,863	75,98,982	54,98,560

revision recently, with the number of districts increased from 11 to 13. Outer North, Central North and Old Delhi are new districts that have been carved out from existing ones, while the area of Shahdara district was incorporated in the Northeast and East districts.

As per the officials, a household is a group of people

who usually live together and share meals prepared in the same kitchen. People who live in the same building but cook and eat separately are not considered part of the same household.

A census house is a building, or a part of a building, that has its own separate entrance and is recognised as an independent unit. It may be occu-

piated or vacant and can be used for residential, commercial, or mixed purposes.

The exercise was carried out through 45,863 House Listing Blocks (HLB). One HLB consists of around 180 houses comprising 600-800 people, said officials.

In the first phase of the Census 2027, the House Listing and Housing Census (HLO), happening between April to September across India, enumerators go door-to-door to collect details of houses, their conditions and the assets owned by the household.

The second phase, called the Population Enumeration, will be held in February 2027 to count the people. The final population count will be known after the second phase scheduled for next year.

In Delhi's South West district, comprising areas such as Najafgarh, Dwarka, Matiala and Bijwasan, 6.25 lakh households and 8.2 lakh houses have been listed — the highest across Capital's 13 districts.

North East Delhi, made up of densely populated areas like Karawal Nagar, Gokal Puri, Shahadara and Yamuna

Vihar, followed closely with 6.13 lakh households and 8.04 lakh houses.

Enumerators recorded 5.89 lakh households and 8.02 lakh houses in West Delhi, comprising areas such as Viskaspuri, Janakpuri and Rajouri Garden. In East Delhi, 5.47 lakh households and 7.52 lakh houses have been listed.

New Delhi, made up of the New Delhi Municipal Corporation and Delhi Cantonment Board areas, had the least number of households at 63,050 and 1.02 lakh houses. The exercise concluded in New Delhi district on May 15. As part of the houselisting and housing census exercise, enumerators collected information on the condition and use of houses, including the materials used for floors, walls and roofs, ownership status, and the number of rooms. They also gathered details about household members, access to basic amenities such as drinking water, toilets, electricity and cooking fuel, as well as assets owned by the household, including mobile phones, televisions, computers, vehicles and internet access.

BLAZE KILLED 23 EARLIER THIS MONTH

Malviya Nagar B&B owner wanted to open hotel, police rejected application in 2022

Alok Singh
New Delhi, June 16

LAVKESH BAJAJ, the owner of Flourish Stay in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar where a massive fire earlier this month killed 23 people, had applied to the Delhi Police in 2022 for a licence to operate a hotel from the premises. But the application was rejected because he did not possess the mandatory health and trade licence from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) and a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the Delhi Fire Service (DFS). *The Indian Express* has learnt.

According to police sources, Bajaj, who was arrested hours after the blaze, was involved in the medical tourism business since 2012 and was living in the Hauz Rani area. He also owned



At the site of the incident. FILE

a property in Chhatarpur, where he accommodated medical tourists visiting the city. "After the Covid pandemic, he realised that he could expand his business by opening additional facilities. In 2022, he purchased a three-storey house in Hauz Rani, and decided to develop it into a full-fledged facility. He subsequently began constructing three additional floors to increase the number of

rooms," a source said.

The source added that Bajaj applied for a hotel licence through the Delhi Police Licensing Department in August 2022. However, the application was rejected. Officials said that, at the time, Delhi Police issued final hotel licences only after applicants submitted all mandatory clearances, including licences from civic authorities, revenue records, and a fire NOC from the DFS — Bajaj had not secured these clearances.

The licensing system was revised in 2025, and Delhi Police no longer issues such licences.

Investigators had earlier claimed that Bajaj went on to construct additional floors and operate 26 rooms, despite having approval for only six rooms under the B&B scheme. "Since construction of the building

had already begun, he (Bajaj) decided to obtain approval under the Bed and Breakfast (B&B) scheme administered by the Delhi Tourism department," a source said.

For registration under the B&B scheme, it was mandatory for the owner to reside at the same premises. Police alleged that Bajaj showed his accountant as the owner of the property before the Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation (DTTDC), which subsequently issued the B&B licence.

Police said they have collected all relevant documents linked to the bed and breakfast facility to strengthen their case. Bajaj and two employees have already been arrested in connection with the case and the investigation is still underway.

Tughlakabad 'arson': One more death takes toll to 4

New Delhi: The death toll in the incident of fire, which ripped through a residential building in Southeast Delhi's Tughlakabad on the intervening night of June 12 and 13, rose to four after a 50-year-old woman succumbed to her injuries on Monday evening, police said.

The victim, identified as Guddi, had sustained severe burn injuries and died at a hospital. Police said that the three others who died in the fire were Guddi's son Pankaj (28), daughter Soni (20), and mother Sushila (70). Another member of the family, Moni, is currently critical, they said.

Two days after the incident, police had found that the fire was not accidental. They said a minor girl was allegedly

planted to set a scooter parked on the ground floor of the building on fire. The blaze soon engulfed the building, spreading to the upper floors. The police also found that the scooter belonged to another family residing in the building.

Relatives of the deceased said that they are not aware of any dispute that the family might be involved in. According to a relative, Guddi's husband Subhash worked as a driver for a private firm and spent years saving money to buy a home for the family. After his death, Pankaj managed to buy a flat after years of hard work. The family also demanded strict action against those responsible for the fire and that they be prosecuted for murder.

ENS

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to bring to the notice of general public that our client intends to explore the possibility of extending debt facility, inter-alia, against the mortgage of land admeasuring 76 Kanal 01 Marla (9.506 Acres) comprised in Rectangle No. 11, Killa No(s). 7/1 (4-14) and 8/1 (4-14); Rectangle No. 11, Killa No(s). 2/2 (1-12), 3/2 (6-16) and 4 (8-0); Rectangle No. 11, Killa No(s). 5/1 (6-16), 5/2 (1-4) and 10/1/3/2 (0-18); Rectangle No. 11, Killa No. 6/1 (4-14); Rectangle No. 12, Killa No(s). 1/1/1 (3-1) and 10/2/2/1 (1-18); Rectangle No. 11, Killa No. 9/1/1/1 (4-10); Rectangle No. 5, Killa No(s). 20/2/1 (5-7), 21/1 (5-17), Rectangle No. 6, Killa No(s). 16/2 (2-13), 23/2 (0-8), 24/2 (4-19) and 25 (8-0), situated within Village Harsaru, Sub-Tehsil Harsaru and District Gurugram (hereinafter referred to as the "Said Property"), currently under the ownership of Neem Secured Private Limited (hereinafter collectively referred to as "Landowner").

Any person(s) or entity(s) including but not limited to any bank or financial institution having or claiming or asserting to have any demand and/or objection and/or any right/ title/ interest/ estate in respect of the Landowner and/or Said Property or any portion thereof including by way of mortgage, hypothecation, encumbrance entitlement, sale, agreement for sale, transfer, assignment, lease, agreement to lease, sub-lease, agreement to sub-lease, tenancy, license, sub-license, lien, pledge, charge, trust, maintenance, easement, compensation claims, gift, lis-pendens, exchange, share, beneficial interest, possession, release, relinquishment, partition, power of attorney, contract/ agreement, will, bequest, inheritance, future FAR, future FSI, development rights, family arrangement/ settlement, partnership, possession, allotment, order or decree or direction of any court of law or any other statutory or adjudicating authority or acquisition by government or any entity, prohibition or any other impediment with respect to the Landowner and/or the Said Property or by way of any other method or otherwise howsoever ("Claims") or have already filed any suit, dispute, petition, appeal or other proceedings or sent any demand notice or obtained any decree, judgement, award or other order concerning the Landowner or Said Property or any part thereof, are hereby called upon and are required to give notice of any such Claims or objections, if any, in writing to the undersigned within 15 (fifteen) days of publication of this public notice together with copies of all relevant documents supporting their claims(s)/interests(s)/rights(s)/title/demand(s)/estate interest failing which it will be construed that such claimants have relinquished/ waived their claim(s)/interests(s)/right(s)/title/demand(s)/estate interest in Said Property and there exists no claim(s)/interest(s)/right(s)/demand(s)/estate interest against the Landowner and/or Said Property, and the Landowner shall be free to deal with the Said Property, in the manner as it/they deem fit.

Akshara Grover, Advocate
Luthra and Luthra Law Offices India
Phone No. +91 11 4121 5100

Add: 1st and 9th floor, Ashoka Estate, 24, Barakhamba Rd, Fire Brigade Lane, Barakhamba, New Delhi, Delhi 110001

Citizen lounge by day, study hub by night: CM opens library at New Delhi DM office

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 16

THE NEW Delhi District Magistrate's office, a key public-facing facility handling services ranging from property registrations to caste and income certificates, has opened part of its premises to underprivileged children from nearby areas and civil services aspirants who will be offered a dedicated reading corner, library and computer facilities with internet access to study and prepare for exams.

Called as a 'citizen lounge-cum-new-age learning centre', the space was inaugurated by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday. It will function as a community learning centre after public hours, providing a conducive environment for students and job aspirants.

The lounge-cum-learning centre has a seating capacity for 40 people and is equipped with AC,

computers with Wi-Fi connection and books, besides basic amenities like toilets and drinking water.

The CM inspected the lounge, the library and reading corner, and the newly constructed toilet block. Describing the initiative as an excellent example of good governance and public service, she said ensuring that citizens visiting administrative offices have a dignified, comfortable and positive experience is a key priority for the government.

Gupta said the facility is not merely a waiting lounge or a library, but a symbol of a new approach to governance and administration. Children from nearby settlements and economically weaker sections will be able to benefit from facilities that are not ordinarily or easily available to them, she added.

The centre will serve as a citizen lounge from 9 am to 3 pm, after which it will be open for students and job aspirants.

बैंक ऑफ इंडिया
Bank of India **BOI**

GENERAL OPERATIONS DEPARTMENT, CHANDIGARH ZONAL OFFICE

APPOINTMENT OF ARCHITECT CUM
PROJECT MANAGEMENT CONSULTANT

Bank of India invites applications for appointment of Architects cum Project Management Consultants for major structural repair and maintenance work of staff residential flats at sector 42C, Chandigarh-160036. Detailed notification is available in tender menu of the Bank's website: www.bankofindia.bank.in and MSTC Website www.mstccommerce.com. The tender is to be applied online only (through e-tendering mode only) through www.mstccommerce.com. Last date of submission of online application is **16.07.2026** Any addendum/ corrigendum in this matter will be published in the same websites only.

(DEPUTY ZONAL MANAGER)

DR. RAMMANOHAR LOHIA AVADH
UNIVERSITY, AYODHYA (U.P.)

Admission Notice-2026-27

Online Applications are invited on
SAMARTH PORTAL

N.E.P. 2020 Applied on Courses as per Uttar Pradesh Government Orders

पत्रांक : लो०अ०वि०/ शैक्षण०/4208N/2026 दिनांक: 15.06.2026

एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि डॉ० राममनोहर लोहिया अवध विश्वविद्यालय, अयोध्या के आवासीय परिसर एवं सम्बद्ध महाविद्यालयों में संचालित विभिन्न पाठ्यक्रमों में पंजीकरण / प्रवेश हेतु ऑनलाइन आवेदन आमंत्रित किये जा रहे हैं। स्नातक / परास्नातक स्तर के पाठ्यक्रमों में प्रवेश हेतु आनलाइन आवेदन प्रारम्भ कर दिये गये हैं, जो 30 जून, 2026 तक खुले रहेंगे। इच्छुक अभ्यर्थी विश्वविद्यालय की वेबसाइट www.rmlau.ac.in एवं समर्थ पोर्टल के वेब लिंक (rmlauadm.samarth.edu.in) पर ऑनलाइन आवेदन कर सकते हैं। एम०एड०, एलएल०एम०, एलएल०बी०, बी०फार्म०, डॉ०फार्म०, एम०पी०एड०, बी०पी०एड० प्रवेश परीक्षा को प्रस्तावित तिथि 07 जुलाई, 2026 है।

नोट:- CUET PG के अभ्यर्थी rmlaucuet.samarth.edu.in/pg पर आवेदन कर सकते हैं। CUET UG परीक्षा परिणाम के आने के बाद वेबलिक विश्वविद्यालय की वेबसाइट पर उपलब्ध होगा।

विनय कुमार सिंह
कुलसचिव

MIZORAM UNIVERSITY
Aizawl – 796004, Mizoram

No.MZU/ADMSN/2026-27/5 Dated 16th June, 2026

Applications are invited for admission into PG/UG courses in various departments for the even semester 2026-27. The details of admission and other terms and conditions may be seen from the Website of Mizoram University www.mzu.edu.in. Subsequent addendum/corrigendum in connection with the advertisement shall be posted in the University website only.

Sd/-
Director of Admissions
Mizoram University

BEML Limited
(CIN: L35202KA1964GOI001530)
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
(Schedule 'A' Company under the Ministry of Defence)
Regd. Office: BEML Southa, 23/1, 4th Main,
Sampangirama Nagar, Bengaluru - 560 027, INDIA.

BEML Limited is a diversified Central Public Sector Company, known for its innovation, Inclusion and Integration across the various Business Verticals as a pathway of success. BEML has attained the requisite competitive edge by developing its in-house capabilities in Product-design, Manufacturing & servicing as a part of the Business Ecosystem & has become the Flag-bearer of India's Engineering Sector. It supplies global standard products to Multi-Sectors such as Defence & Aerospace, Mining & Construction, Rail & Metro across India and overseas.

BEML is looking for energetic personnel for its Business Operations towards the following positions:

Sl. No.	Position	Advt Ref
1	Non-Executive personnel on Tenure basis (ITI with NAC) / Electrician, Fitter, Machinist, Turner, Welder.	KP/S/10/2026 DT: 17.06.26

Interested candidates may please visit the career page on BEML website www.bemlindia.in for detailed advertisement and application process, which will be hosted shortly.

काशी हिन्दू
विश्वविद्यालय

BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY
An Institution of National Importance established by an Act of Parliament

Banaras Hindu University invites ONLINE applications from eligible candidates for teaching posts to be filled through direct recruitment on a regular basis under the following Rolling Advertisements:

1. Rolling Advertisement No. IMS-12/2025-26 (Teaching Posts) – Institute of Medical Sciences (Faculty of Medicine, Faculty of Dental Sciences & College of Nursing).

2. Rolling Advertisement No. FAy-13/2025-26 (Teaching Posts) – Faculty of Ayurveda, Institute of Medical Sciences.

For details regarding qualifications, eligibility conditions, application procedure, and other instructions, candidates may visit the University website at www.bhu.ac.in/rac. The last date for online submission of the application form and payment of the application fee is **10.07.2026 up to 5:00 PM (IST)**.

Advertisement No. 14/2025-26
(Non-Teaching Positions of Group 'B' & 'C' – Bharat Kala Bhavan)

Banaras Hindu University invites online applications in the prescribed format from eligible candidates for appointment to Non-Teaching positions under Group 'B' and Group 'C' in Bharat Kala Bhavan.

The last date for online submission of the application form and payment of the application fee is **08.07.2026 up to 5:00 PM (IST)**. For details of qualifications and other instructions, please visit the University website: <http://www.bhu.ac.in/rac>.

The duly completed downloaded application form along with supporting documents must reach the office of the Deputy Registrar, Recruitment & Assessment Cell, Holkar House, Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi – 221005 on or before **13.07.2026 up to 5:00 PM**

Date: 09/11.06.2026 REGISTRAR

WENT TO UTTARAKHAND FOR VACATION WITH HUSBAND Selfie at 1.36 am, then tragic call at 8 am: Techie found dead at Mussoorie homestay

Aiswarya Raj
Dehradun, June 16

AT 1.36 AM on Monday, Soumya Sricharan and P Radha Gayatri sent a selfie from their Mussoorie vacation to the latter's father, P Sudhakar. When he woke up in the morning at his Visakhapatnam home, he shared it with his wife.

"At 8 am, Sricharan called me to say that Gayatri was dead," said Sudhakar, waiting at the government district hospital in Dehradun on Tuesday.

On Monday morning, Sricharan found his 27-year-old wife, Gayatri, in bed and unresponsive. She was bleeding from the nose, and by the time medical staff tried to resuscitate her in the ambulance, she had died, as per police.

The couple had travelled from Delhi to Rishikesh on Saturday. On Sunday night, they travelled from Rishikesh to a homestay in Mussoorie. The duo were scheduled to visit Visakhapatnam for Sudhakar's birthday on Wednesday.

"We had talked to her on Sunday night, when both of them talked to us about their stay in Uttarakhand," Sudhakar, a retired Army man, said.

The couple had gotten married in November. Gayatri's friend and Sricharan's cousin introduced them to each other. Sricharan's family, originally



The couple got married in November last year.

from Visakhapatnam, has been based in Delhi since 1989, says his father, Durga Prasad.

"She was working in Hyderabad and he in Pune. When they got acquainted, they informed us, and they got married. Their engagement ceremony was in October, and in November, they had their wedding," said Prasad. Gayatri moved to her in-laws' house in Delhi after the wedding, and got a job in Gurgaon soon after.

Cause of death yet to be determined

Police said that during questioning, the husband said that both of them had consumed alcohol during the night and had gone to their room at around 3.30 am. When he woke up in the morning, he found his wife unconscious.

The body was sent to the district hospital for post-mortem

examination on Tuesday.

During the post-mortem, no external injury marks were found on the body. For further scientific examination and determination of the exact cause of death, the doctors have preserved the viscera for forensic analysis.

"The deceased's father, P Sudhakar, has submitted an application seeking an investigation into the cause of death. Based on this application, a thorough inquiry is being conducted from all angles. A conclusion regarding the cause of death can only be drawn after receipt of the post-mortem report, viscera examination report, and other scientific evidence," said police.

Mussoorie Circle Officer Jagdish Pant said that a few strips of various medicines were found at the spot, which have been collected as evidence. "We found glasses and bottles, and collected these samples. The viscera have been preserved during autopsy and sent for toxicological analysis. We will ascertain what she had consumed before her death," Pant said.

The Mussoorie station-in-charge, Devender Singh Chauhan, said that the woman had been receiving treatment for low blood pressure. He said that they collected all the materials from the spot to establish a sequence of events.

NCR set to get four greenfield 'Namo' cities under Regional Plan 2041

Damini Nath
New Delhi, June 16

FOUR GREENFIELD cities, called "Namo" cities, will be developed in the National Capital Region (NCR) — one each in Delhi, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan — at a total cost of Rs 5,000 crore over the next five years, Union Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal said on Tuesday.

This will be part of the NCR Regional Plan-2041, which is yet to be approved. The decision was taken at a meeting of the National Capital Region Planning Board (NRCPB) chaired by the minister, which was attended by Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Uttar Pradesh Urban Development Minister Arvind Kumar Sharma and Rajasthan Urban Development Minister Jhabbar Singh Kharrar.

The meeting was called for "consideration and passing" of the NCR Regional Plan-2041, delayed by five years so far, among other proposals. Manohar Lal said while most of the issues regarding the NCR Regional Plan-2041 had been agreed upon, the final plan would be declared in about two months.

Addressing a press conference after the meeting, the Union Minister said the "Namo" cities would be chosen through a challenge, with each state submitting three proposals. In the case of Delhi, a sub-city would be proposed, he said.

These new cities or sub-city would be along the transport nodes, including the Regional Rapid Transit System (RRTS). He said the name "Namo" cities was in line with the name of the RRTS trains, Namo Bharat. He said eight RRTS corridors were being planned. Sharma said he had proposed Jewar, Dadri, Bulandshahr, Noida and Khurja as options in Uttar Pradesh.

Later, addressing a separate press conference, Saini said a sub-committee had been formed to look into the details of the NCR Regional Plan-2041, and the next board meeting would be held in December.

In addition to the new cities, the board also decided to divide the NCR into three zones, including the core NCR, for the purpose of pollution control measures. The Haryana government's proposal to reduce the NCR area was not approved, the Union Minister said. He said Haryana had made the request in view of anti-pollution measures invoked across the NCR districts, including in areas that don't need them.

He said it was therefore decided to split the NCR into three zones for a graded implementation of the Graded Response Action Plan. The core NCR zone would be the area between the Eastern Peripheral Expressway and the Western Peripheral Expressway, he said.

Asked whether the Regional Plan-2041 had retained the protection of the Aravallis as natural conservation zone (NCZ), as the

Regional Plan-2021 does, the Minister said: "Many such suggestions have come. There are many decisions of the NGT, the Court, High Court and MoEF. There will be no violation of those decisions. But those things that are within our thinking and jurisdiction, we said we will increase the green cover as much as possible".

The draft Regional Plan-2041 had diluted the protection for the Aravallis by terming it a "natural zone" instead of NCZ.

Asked about the status of the survey of green cover, he said the reports from Delhi and Haryana were yet to be received. "Sometimes, in the satellite imagery, it is not possible to see whether the green cover is forest or is just appearing green, because if grass is there, it will also look green from there, even algae and weeds in ponds will look green," he said, adding that ground-truthing was required.

He said the board had decided to come up with a scheme to promote increasing green cover in the NCR through a competition between districts.

"We want the green cover to increase as much as possible.

There is always a controversy about how much area is forest cover and how much is green cover. After considering that issue, we have decided to keep the two distinct. Forest area is demarcated already and NCR Planning Board cannot make any changes as it is a matter for the MoEF or court decisions," he said.

CM: States must work together to curb pollution in NCR

New Delhi: All states must work together to curb pollution and expand green cover, said Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta after attending the NRCPB meeting on Tuesday. Calling the increasing pollution in NCR a shared challenge, she said the pace of regional development can be accelerated only through a coordinated approach, enabling the benefits of growth to reach every part of the NCR.

In a statement issued by CMO, Gupta said all the concerned states must work jointly to provide adequate and quality services to people across the NCR, ensuring bal-

anced development and an improved quality of life for citizens. "Delhi, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan currently have like-minded governments that are working in better coordination and giving priority to public welfare, state interests and development. If all four states adopt a common policy, modern technology and appropriate resources for pollution control in a coordinated manner, the problem can be tackled more effectively...issue is crucial not only for the present generation but also for the health and future of generations to come," Gupta said.

ENS

• Skywatch



Forecast: June 17, 2026
Partly cloudy sky. Light rain, thunderstorm, lightning

MAX: 33-35
3.8°C below normal

MIN: 25-27
0.5°C below normal

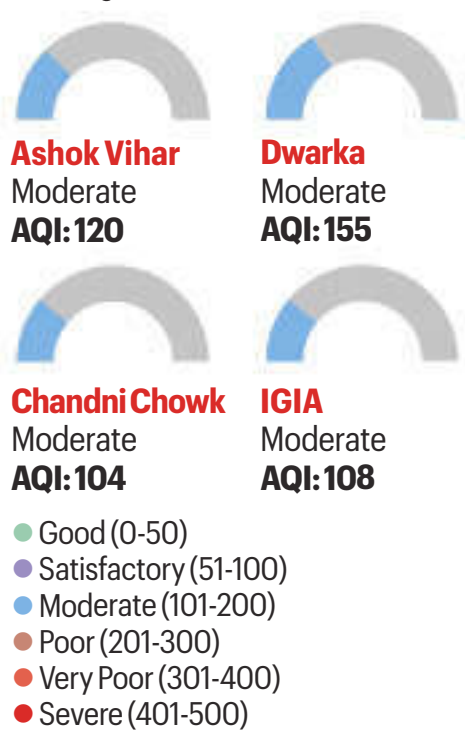
• *Sunrise: 5:24 AM (June 18)*

• *Sunset: 7:21 PM (June 17)*

• *Moonrise: 8:39 AM (June 18)*

• *Moonset: 9:50 PM (June 17)*

• AQI Tracker



DEMOLITIONS CARRIED OUT TO CLEAR O-ZONE

'My house reduced to rubble'

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, June 16

NAJIRA, WHO is in her late 20s, walked barefoot on the debris on Tuesday as her husband slept near her demolished house. Najira's house in Pradhan Gardens in Southeast Delhi was among the many unauthorised structures razed during a drive carried out by the Sub-Divisional Magistrate (Badarpur) on Tuesday.

While stacking their belongings on a cycle rickshaw, Najira and her husband wondered where to go next. This is not the life they expected to live when they left Assam six months ago.

Tuesday's drive was carried out along the Yamuna floodplain in areas falling under the O-Zone, such as Pusta Road, Pradhan Garden, Khadda Colony and Jaitpur Part-II.

It was in line with the Delhi High Court's directions on action against unauthorised constructions. Only 91 unauthorised colonies in the O-Zone have been exempted from demolition.

A number of jhuggis were razed, residents alleged, without the authorities providing them enough time to shift their belongings.

Santosh, 38, was at a construction site in Greater Noida when he was informed that his house, built in 2019, would be taken down. Members of his family were asleep when officials, he said, knocked on their door and asked them to step outside.



At the site of demolition along Yamuna riverbank in Kalindi Kunj's Pradhan Garden. GAJENDRA YADAV

"Everything that I had worked for was inside. The whole house I built from scratch is reduced to rubble now," said Santosh.

Dilwara said she told officials that she could start shifting only once her husband returned from work. She said she couldn't do it alone with their child in her arms. "They stuck a notice at a nearby temple and left. How were we supposed to know? Had we got a couple hours more, we would have shifted... look at the state they have left the place in now. Where are we supposed to go when it's raining everyday?" said Dilwara.

"It took me 15 years to start life afresh and not be worried about the future. It took less than five minutes for them to tear it all down," said Khalil Ahmed, in his 70s, who pulls a cycle rickshaw in Jaitpur for a living.

Several residents, mean-

while, also alleged that they were duped by dealers or owners of their plots.

Noor Muhammad, a scrap collector hailing from Guwahati, said he was paying a monthly rent of around Rs 15,000 to one Akthar Pradhan, the owner of Pradhan Gardens. He claimed that Pradhan had assured them that nothing would happen to them.

Santosh said that he had bought the land from a dealer for nearly Rs 6 lakh.

He said he was never informed about the issues associated with the land. Dev, a battery dealer, who also bought a plot of land from a dealer, looked on as the house that he had stayed in for less than a year was reduced to debris.

The Indian Express reached out to the SDM to get the total number of structures which have received notices, but did not get a response.

'Govt has habit of lying': AAP seeks protection for affected residents

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, June 16

THE AAM Aadmi Party (AAP) on Tuesday launched a signature campaign demanding legal protection for residents living in unauthorised colonies in the O-Zone of Yamuna riverbanks in Delhi and urged the Centre to enact a law safeguarding them from demolition.

O-Zone is the ecologically sensitive area on the floodplains of the Yamuna river where construction is prohibited. More than five lakh people live in 91 unauthorised colonies in the O-Zone.

The Delhi High Court on May 23 had observed that residential colonies in the region are "completely impermissible", while noting that 91 unauthorised colonies in the area continue to enjoy temporary protection from punitive action only until December 31 of this year.

Last week, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced that no demolition would be carried out on existing constructions in the colonies and maintained that the Delhi High Court's concerns were related to only fresh or ongoing construction activity.

"Verbal promises of Rekha Gupta and this government mean nothing as they have a habit of lying. Despite saying demolitions won't happen, demolitions are continuing everyday in Jaitpur, Burari and Timarpur," AAP Delhi chief Saurabh Bharadwaj told *The Indian Express* when asked about why a campaign was being launched when the government has assured that no demolitions will take place.

Bharadwaj said party MLAs, councillors, leaders and workers would go door-to-door in affected colonies to collect signatures, which would later be submitted to the Prime Minister Narendra Modi, demanding a legislation in the Parliament granting protection to O-Zone residents. "We will go to the residents in all 91 of these colonies, which are spread across the assembly constituencies of Burari, Timarpur, Karawal Nagar, Okhla and Badarpur," he said.

The campaign would last for around a month, Bharadwaj said.

Referring to O-Zone areas, he said thousands of families had been living in these colonies for decades and were now facing uncertainty.

PROJECT TO COST RS 700 CRORE

Govt nod to 4-km corridor to boost connectivity between South Delhi and Gurgaon

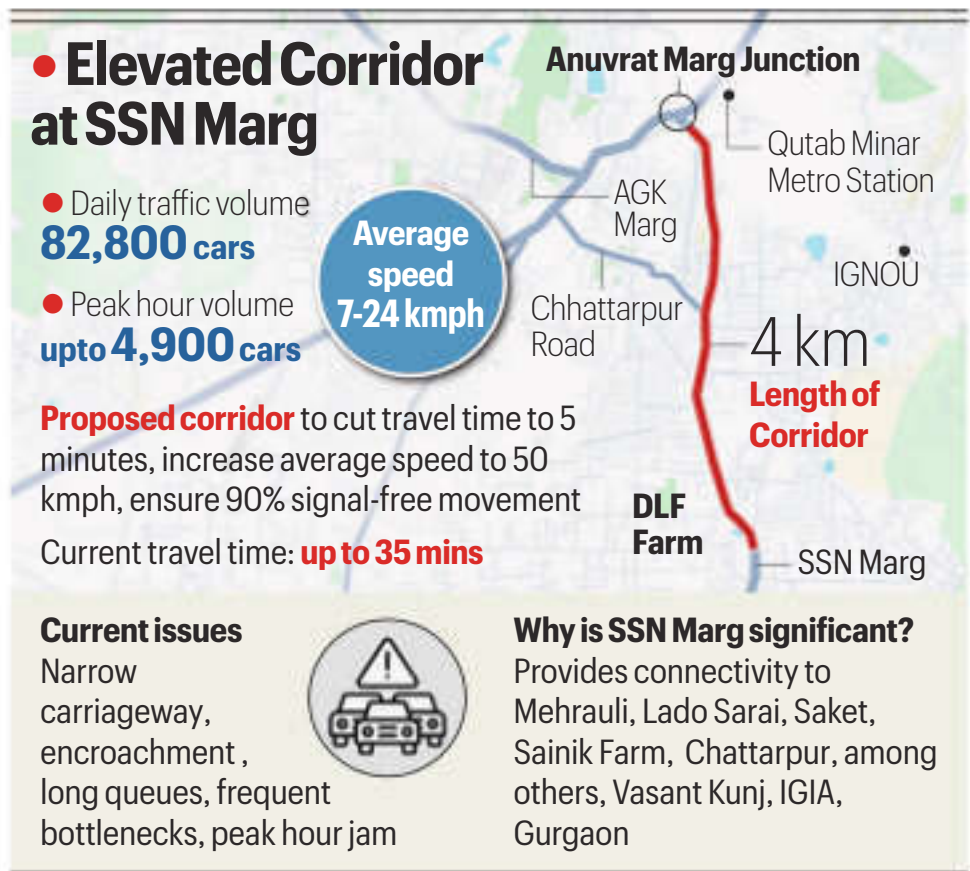
Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, June 16

AIMING TO ensure seamless connectivity for commuters headed to Gurgaon from South Delhi, the Delhi government has approved the construction of a 4-km-long signal-free flyover on SSN Marg, Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Tuesday.

"The stretch is one of South Delhi's busiest urban corridors and is currently constrained by a signalised bottleneck at Anuvrat Marg. Due to this, vehicles get stuck at the red light, leading to heavy traffic jams," said the Minister, adding, "There are also encroachments, and this stretch connects farms in the Chattarpur area. The traffic jams become a nightmare during the wedding season."

The proposed corridor will stretch from the Anuvrat Marg intersection to DLF Farms in Chattarpur and is expected to significantly reduce travel time and improve traffic flow along the busy route.

Officials said that it currently takes up to 35 minutes to complete the 4-km journey, and average operating speeds frequently drop below 10 kmph during peak periods. The proposed corridor, once con-



structed, is expected to reduce travel time to five minutes and improve average speeds to 50 kmph. "It will also bring down the vehicular load, as the majority of traffic will shift to the flyover, while local traffic can use the surface road. This will help people save 12.3 minutes per vehicle," a PWD explained.

The project is estimated to cost Rs 700 crore. Officials also underlined that the main objective of the project is to augment the capacity of the existing corridor. "Reducing traffic congestion along the SSN corridor, strengthening connectivity be-

tween NH-148A and the surrounding residential and institutional areas in South Delhi are some of the key objectives of the project" said another PWD official.

The PWD Minister said that the feasibility study has been completed and the detailed project report (DPR) is ready. "Tenders will be floated soon.. the process will take about a month, and once the work is awarded, civil construction will begin on the ground," the official said, adding that it will take about two years to complete the project.

AT GURGAON HOME, CASE CASTS LONG SHADOW ON WEDDING

'Right can't be defeated': NEET paper leak accused in custody can take retest

Nirbhay Thakur, Vidheesha Kuntamalla & Abhimanyu Hazarika
New Delhi, June 16

A DELHI court Tuesday allowed Yash Yadav, an accused in the NEET UG paper leak case, to give the NEET retest scheduled on June 21 in custody.

"... while the applicant does face grave allegations of wrongful dissemination and trading of confidential questions of the very examination in which he now seeks to appear, his rights as a student cannot be defeated by turning bail into punishment by denial of the opportunity to appear in the examination," said Special Judge Dr Vishal Gogne of Rouse Avenue Court in his order dated June 16.

"More so, when the eligibility,

candidature and selection of any student in an examination is subject to appropriate orders from the competent authorities/exam conducting body. In this view, the court finds the applicant to be entitled to appear for the examination on 21.06.2026," he added.

The judge, however, didn't grant interim bail to Yash but allowed him to take the exam and attend his sister's wedding in judicial custody. This means police will escort him to the exam venue and to the wedding, and he will be under the supervision of officers.

Celebration, anxiety at home

A block away from Yash's family's home in Khera Khurrampur village in Gurgaon, rem-

nants of a torn poster can be seen on a wall on the street. Months ago, it carried a smiling photograph of the 20-year-old alongside the words "MBBS Selection" and "Heartiest Congratulations".

Last month, Yash became the talk of the town after his name surfaced in one of the country's biggest examination scandals -- he was arrested by the CBI on May 13 in connection with the NEET-UG paper leak, which led to the cancellation of the exam.

A first-year student at an Ayurvedic college in Uttarakhand, he is currently lodged in judicial custody while investigators probe allegations that leaked examination material was circulated among candidates before the medical en-



The torn poster near the house of the accused. EXPRESS

trance examination. He had appeared in the now-cancelled May 3 exam.

At the family home, preparations were underway for his elder sister Neha's wedding. Relatives started arriving at the family's house and decorations

were being planned. But the tension was palpable.

When *The Indian Express* visited Khera Khurrampur on Sunday, relatives and neighbours described a household caught between celebration and anxiety. Yash's mother, who

suffers from blood pressure-related ailments, told *The Indian Express* that the family has been struggling to cope with the sudden arrest.

"Yash was abruptly taken away by a few men in the middle of the night. We had no idea why he was being summoned. Since then, our father has been running around for help with my brother's case," said Neha, a law student at SGT University in Gurgaon.

According to the family, Yash had returned home from Uttarakshi earlier in March this year after suffering a foot injury and was preparing to take the NEET examination again. He had hoped to secure admission to an MBBS programme through another attempt at the examination.

Neha maintained that her brother has been wrongly implicated: "They have not found any evidence or money trail linked to my brother unlike the others. He is unfairly inside."

What the court said

Yadav had sought interim bail citing the retest as well as his sister's wedding. His lawyer had also statd the alternative of allowing him to give the exam in custody.

Judge Gogne did not grant interim bail to Yadav. "... considering the initial stage of the investigation, the wide sweep of the material and evidence sought to be collected and the prospect of other suspects being still investigated, the court is not inclined to grant interim bail to facilitate such participation,"

the court said. It added, "The application is allowed with permission to applicant/accused Yash Yadav to take the examination dated 21.06.2026 and also attend the marriage ceremony of his sister on 22.06.2026 in judicial custody."

Earlier this month, the court had allowed Yash to keep study material while in custody after his lawyers argued that he was preparing for the re-examination.

"The books have reached him," his lawyer, Ambika Yadav, told *The Indian Express*.

According to the CBI, Yash allegedly received PDF files of leaked question papers through Telegram and sold them for Rs 10 lakh. The agency claimed he was instrumental in distributing the "leaked" paper.

Neither my height nor build matches: Mann on video as AAP continues firefight

Kanchan Vasdev
Chandigarh, June 16

A DAY after Akal Takht Jathe-dar Giani Kuldeep Singh Gar-gaj declared Bhagwant Mann “Guru Dokhi” (anti-Guru) and rejected his contention that the controversial video was AI-generated, the Punjab CM Tuesday denied the claims, accusing those holding religious posts of acting at the behest of political interests, even as the AAP continued to firefight to contain the political fallout.

The Akal Takht pronouncement came amid an escalating confrontation between the Sikh clergy and the AAP government over the recently enacted anti-sacrilege law. The Jathedar had maintained that the video in question was genuine, while also criticising Mann over his remarks concerning the functioning of Sikh religious institutions.

Responding to the Akal Takht’s observations, Mann, in a video message, said the person seen in the purported video was not him. “When I appeared before the Jathedar, I had categorically stated the person in the video was not me. Neither my height nor my build matches that of the individual,” Mann said, adding he was “shocked people holding such high posts are saying these things at the behest of their political bosses”.

Mann said, “I bow before the Akal Takht. I believe Akal Takht is supreme. But the Sikh sangat is well aware of how political appointments are made there.”



Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann in Hoshiarpur on Tuesday. EXPRESS

Calling the video objectionable, Mann described it as a “kojhi harkat” (a vile and despicable act) and alleged it was part of a campaign orchestrated by political opponents.

The CM linked the controversy to Punjab government’s recent anti-sacrilege legislation, claiming that its popularity had unsettled his opponents.

“When they realised that people had appreciated the sacrilege law brought by our government, they could not digest it because they themselves failed to enact such a law. Earlier, the managers of the SGPC and Akal Takht were asking why the government was not bringing such legislation. Now that we have done so, they are questioning it,” he said.

As concerns mounted within the party over the implications of Akal Takht pro-

nouncement, AAP national convenor Arvind Kejriwal lent support to Mann by reposting the CM’s video on X. The post was shared by party ministers, MLAs and other leaders, signalling that the party had decided to stand firmly behind the CM.

However, even as the leadership rallied around Mann publicly, discussions within the party centred on whether appearing alongside the CM at official meetings or functions could invite action from the Akal Takht, which has advised the Sikh community against maintaining any relationship with him. The issue assumes significance as AAP ministers and MLAs prepare to appear before the Akal Takht on June 29 after being summoned in connection with the sacrilege legislation passed by the Punjab Assembly.

Cong meets 33 Punjab leaders; infighting, poll strategy in focus

Total 66 leaders summoned; AICC panel to meet ex-ministers, dist Cong chiefs today

Manoj C G
& Man Aman Singh Chhina
New Delhi, Chandigarh, June 16

WITH FACTIONALISM in its Punjab unit threatening to derail the party’s Assembly election preparation, the Congress high command on Tuesday began a massive exercise to set its divided house in order. The party has summoned 66 leaders from Punjab to Delhi to gauge whether the state unit needs to be restructured before the polls early next year.

This comes amid talk of Punjab Assembly elections being advanced. The BJP leadership has already directed its state units in Punjab, UP, Uttarakhand, and Goa to prepare for the possibility of elections being advanced by at least a month to avoid a scheduling clash with the Census enumeration scheduled for February 2027.

The Congress has set up a three-member panel headed by AICC treasurer Ajay Maken to prepare a report on the current political scenario in Punjab, including factionalism, and the

Assembly elections. A final report is expected to be submitted by Saturday and is likely to influence decisions on potential changes in the state Congress leadership and election strategy.

Sources said Maken, along with Meenakshi Natarajan and Bhajan Lal Jatav, on Tuesday met as many as 33 leaders, including CWC members Ambika Soni, Charanjit Singh Channi, Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa, and Vijay Inder Singla; former state Congress chiefs Rajinder Kaur Bhattal and Shamsher Singh Dhullio; and CLP leader Partap Singh Bajwa, besides MPs and MLAs, to hear their views on the way forward. The panel will meet former state ministers and district Congress presidents on Wednesday.

Asked what was discussed, Singla said, “I was asked about the issues the party should highlight in its election campaign. I listed the issues that the Congress can focus on to expose the AAP government.” The CWC member said he was not asked about “organisational issues”.

Another senior leader said he told the observers that there was a possibility of the elections being advanced and the high command would have to decide on leadership as early as possible. Sources said some of the leaders told the panel that the party should project a Jatt Sikh as CM face. The Congress does not have a tradition of projecting a CM face when it is in

the Opposition. When in power, the CM automatically leads the party into elections. But the party departed from that tradition in 2017 when it projected Amarinder Singh as the face at the instance of political consultancy firm IPAC, which oversaw the party’s campaign efforts.

The Congress had set up a three-member panel — headed by current national president Mallikarjun Kharge — in 2021, too, to find ways to resolve factionalism and infighting in the party ahead of the 2022 Assembly polls in which the party was eventually routed.

While the tussle then was between Captain Amarinder Singh and Navjot Singh Sidhu, the factional feud now primarily involves Channi, the former CM who had replaced Amarinder Singh months before elections, and state Congress chief Amarinder Singh Raja Warring. Sources said a section of the party wants the high command to replace Warring with Channi. Sources said the high command was seeking the leaders’ views on leadership change as well.

While the Congress fancies its chances of returning to power in Punjab, its underwhelming performance in the recent local body elections has triggered an alarm. Sources said the Maken committee had sought the views of the leaders on the formation of election-related panels and the need for balancing caste and regional equations.

BJP-RSS leadership finalises Nabin’s new team, announcement to be made ‘any time’

Centre planning a rejig of Governors

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, June 16

A DAY after a hours-long huddle of senior BJP and RSS leaders at the home of Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, party sources said BJP president Nitin Nabin’s new team would be announced at “any time”, with some saying it was likely to be made public following PM Narendra Modi’s return from the G7 Summit in France later this week.

“In addition to Rajnath ji and Nitin ji, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and senior RSS leaders Arun Kumar ji and Shiv Prakash ji were part of the meeting... which was around four hours long and ended around midnight,” said a BJP insider.

Apart from BJP organisational overhaul, government-related changes are also expected along with a reshuffle of Governors.

“The announcement of significant organisational, gubernatorial, and government-related changes is likely to take place any time since the adhi maas period, during which the party traditionally avoids such matters due to religious concerns, ended yesterday (June 15). But it remains to be seen whether it is delayed till PM Modi’s return on June 19,” this source said.

BJP sources said Nabin’s

team — 11 national vice presidents and six national general secretaries — will likely see the party attempt to balance its gender and caste composition and maintain a mix of young and experienced leaders. There will also be representation from states going to the polls next year, including Gujarat, UP, and Uttarakhand, and states such as Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh.

The BJP’s national organisational ranks have largely remained intact since the six-year tenure of Nabin’s predecessor and current Union Health Minister J P Nadda began in January 2020, a party leader said.

The ruling party has already started making changes, shifting leaders around. Earlier this month, BJP national general secretaries Vinod Tawde and Tarun Chugh were elevated to the Rajya Sabha alongside national secretary Alka Gurjar and former Rajasthan BJP president Satish Poonia.

“Some of the sitting national general secretaries, especially Tawde and Chugh, are seen as key office-bearers with a proven track record of delivering on political tasks. So, it remains to be seen whether they remain part of the new team or are considered for positions such as MoS, for instance,” a senior BJP leader said.

SC seeks Govt reply on plea against Aadhaar use as citizenship proof

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 16

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday issued notice on a plea against alleged use of Aadhaar as proof of citizenship and age despite laws to the contrary.

A bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justice V Mohana sought the response of the Centre, states, UTs, Election Commission and UIDAI on a PIL filed by Advocate Ashwini Kumar Upadhyay.

The plea pointed out that Section 9 of the Aadhaar Act 2016, expressly states that Aadhaar is “not the evidence of citizenship or domicile” and a UIDAI notification dated 22.08.2023 clearly states that Aadhaar “is proof of identity, not of citizenship, address or date of birth”. The apex court and various High Courts too have held that Aadhaar is not the proof of age, he pointed out.

“Despite this, the Aadhaar is not only being used as a proof of age, citizenship; domicile for school admission, property purchase and to obtain birth certificate, ration card, driving licence but also being used in Application Form for New Voter Registration (Form-6) as

a proof of date of birth, proof of residence,” the PIL said. Consequently, “infiltrators; illegal immigrants are obtaining various documents using the Aadhaar,” it said.

Upadhyay pointed out that “currently, as per Form-6 of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, Aadhaar can be submitted as proof of date of birth and residence, which runs contrary to the UIDAI Office Memorandum and the judgments passed by this Hon’ble Court and various High Courts”.

He said this raises the legal question whether Form-6 has become temporally unreasonable for failing to keep up with the legislative intent and whether enrollment system under Form-6 is arbitrary for failing to provide a robust system of verification and distinction between lawfully entered foreign nationals and infiltrators.

Highlighting the ill-effects of illegal immigration on the polity, the PIL said “infiltration is a weapon of political parties to subvert electoral process for their benefit. Bengal, Assam and other Northeastern states have been afflicted by cheap political tactics”.

Strict regulatory oversight on sale of cough syrups

In small villages, no sale except from pharmacies

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, June 16

THE UNION Health Ministry has amended the rules that provided certain sales exemptions to cough syrups.

This comes months after at least 22 children died in MP’s Chhindwara district after allegedly consuming Coldrif cough syrup in September last year.

The ministry has amended the rules to remove “syrups ... for cough” from Schedule K — the list of medicines given special exemptions under the drug rules. In this case, it allowed the sale of cough syrups in general stores in small villages.

Prior to this amendment, Entry No. 13 of Schedule K permitted the sale of cough syrups in villages with a population of less than 1,000 without requiring compliance

with certain retail sale licensing provisions, the statement said.

“With the omission of the word ‘syrup’ from the said entry, this exemption will no longer be available for cough syrups. Consequently, the sale and dispensing of cough syrups in smaller villages will now be required to take place only through duly licensed pharmacies in accordance with the provisions of the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940 and the Rules framed thereunder,” it said.

पंजीकरण

पीएम श्री केन्द्रीय विद्यालय सेक्टर-12 द्वारका दिल्ली, से संबंधित विभिन्न सेवाओं, खरीद आपूर्ति एवं विद्यालय भवन, फर्नीचर, एवं सेनेटरी की मरम्मत, सफेदी, तथा एमसी कार्यों हेतु पंजीकरण कराने हेतु दिल्ली की इच्छुक फर्मों एवं एजेंसियों से आवेदन पत्र 14 दिनों के अंतर्गत जी. एस. टी. पै न. लाइसेंस की कॉपी लगाकर पंजीकरण करवा सकते है।

प्राचार्य

CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(A NAVATNA UNDERTAKING OF GOVT OF INDIA)
NSIC New MDBP Building, 2nd Floor, Okhla Indl. Estate
(Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station), New Delhi-110020

INVITATION FOR E-TENDER

CONCOR invites E-Bids for **Open e-Tender (Single Bid System)** for “Zonal annual maintenance contract for operation and maintenance of firefighting and fire detection system at ICD/KHDB, MMPL-Dahaj (Ahmadabad Cluster) and MMPL-Bali (Mumbai Cluster)”

The brief of tender is as under:

Tender no.	CON/A-I/ZONAL/F/O&M/KHDB/Dahaj/Bali/E-103351/2026-27
Total Estimated Cost	₹ 2,59,41,412.37 (incl. GST)
Cost of Tender documents (Non-refundable)	₹ 1,120 (Inclusive all) through e-payment
Tender Processing Fee (Non-refundable)	₹ 3,540 (Inclusive all) through e-payment
Earnest Money	₹ 5,18,829 (through e-payment)
Date of sale of tender (online)	From 17-06-2026 at 17:00 Hrs. to 07-07-2026 up to 12:30 Hrs.
Last Date & Time of submission	07-07-2026 up to 14:00 Hrs. (E-Tendering Mode Only)
Date and time of Opening Tender	07-07-2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

The complete Tender Document for eligibility criteria and other details can be viewed & downloaded only from the website (www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL). The tender notice is also available on the website www.concorindia.co.in and website of Public Procurement Portal (<http://eprocure.gov.in>). Bidders are requested to visit the websites regularly.

Group General Manager/P&S/Area-II

NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY, TRIPURA
Advertisement No. NLUT/Faculty-Recruitment/2026/01
Date: 16.06.2026

RECRUITMENT NOTICE FOR TEACHING POSITIONS

Applications are invited from the prospective and eligible candidates for the post of **Professor (Law), Associate Professor (Law), and Assistant Professor (Sociology)** on regular basis. Pay Scale and qualifications as per UGC Regulations. Please visit University website www.nlutripura.ac.in for number of posts, qualifications, General Instructions, Eligibility criteria and other details.

Date for release of online application form **17th June, 2026** Last Date for submission of filled in application **5th July, 2026**.

Sd/-
Registrar (I/C)

CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(A NAVATNA UNDERTAKING OF GOVT OF INDIA)
NSIC, MDBP Building, 3rd Floor, Okhla Industrial Estate,
Opp. NSIC Okhla Metro Station, New Delhi-110020

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

CONCOR invites E-Bid Open Tender in two packets system of tendering for Manufacture, Supply and Commissioning of 7 nos. of Boxer Power packs (500 kVA) at ICD Dahaj details as follows:

Bid Reference	TENDER NO: CON/ICD/DER/TECH/REEFER POWERPACK/500 kVA/2026-27
Tendered Quantity	7 nos.
Estimated Cost	Rs.15,39,91,394
Bid Security / EMD	Rs 10.8 (Ten) Lakhs through on-line gateway to CONCOR.
Cost of Document	Rs 1,000 through online payment gateway to CONCOR.
Tender processing fee (Non-refundable)	Rs. 3540/- (Inclusive of Taxes) through online payment
Period of Tender Sale (online)	17-06-2026 at 17:00 Hrs to 08-07-2026 up to 17:00 Hrs.
Date and time of Submission of Bid	09-07-2026 up to 17:00 Hrs.
Date and time of opening of Bid	10-07-2026 at 14:30 Hrs.
Place of Opening	Group General Manager/Tech/Area-1, CONCOR, NSIC, Okhla, Ph-3, Near NSIC Estate Metro Station, Gaurind Park, New Delhi-110020
Communication Address	Group General Manager/Tech/Area-1, CONCOR, Inland Container Depot Dahaj, Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh – 201311, Email: enwaskar@concorindia.com

Thought e-payment, For eligibility criteria and other details, please log in www.concorindia.co.in or eprocure.gov.in or www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL. Bidders are requested to visit the websites regularly.

CONCOR reserves the right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason thereof. For complete details login www.tenderwizard.com/CCIL.

Group General Manager/Tech/Area-1

PM SHRI SCHOOL JAWAHAR NAVODAYA VIDYALAYA,
JAFFARPUR KALAN, DELHI-110073

NOTIFICATION FOR ADMISSION OF STUDENTS TO CLASS-XI AGAINST VACANT SEATS DURING THE SESSION 2026-27

Applications are accordingly invited from eligible students for admission to Class XI against the vacant seats likely to be available in JNVs during the academic year 2026-27. Admission will be made on the basis of performance of students in Class X Board Examinations conducted by CBSE / State Education Board.

Eligibility

- Date of birth of the candidate must be between 01.06.2009 to 31.07.2011 (both dates are inclusive).
- The candidate must have passed Class X from a recognized school (affiliated to CBSE or any other State Education Board) of the district where the Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalaya is located during the academic session 2025-26.
- Only a student securing 60% or above (First class) in class X is eligible to apply.
- The candidate opting for Science Stream must have at least 60% marks in Science subject and candidate opting for Mathematics in any stream must have at least 60% marks in Mathematics in class X.

Selection Criteria Preference will be given to:

- Candidates from CBSE affiliated Schools
- If seats still remain vacant, candidate from other recognized State Boards may be considered, strictly in order of merit.
- Merit list will be prepared and students will be selected only against the vacancies based on the marks obtained in class X.
- Stream wise merit list will be prepared for a JNV in accordance with the criteria decided by the Samiti.

How to Apply Any eligible candidate can apply by submitting the application form through OFFLINE mode by visiting the JNV concerned or by obtaining Application Form from JNV concerned or downloading from the website www.navodaya.gov.in. Candidates may submit the duly filled form on the Email Id of the JNV concerned (jnvjaffarpurkalan@gmail.com) or in physical form.

The last date to submit the APPLICATION Form is 25th June, 2026.

(Rajinder Kumar)
Principal PM SHRI SCHOOL JNV,
Jaffarpur Kalan, Delhi-110073

Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Technological University, Lonere
Tal. Mangaon, Dist. Raigad-402103, Maharashtra

Recruitment for the Various Statutory Posts

DR. Babasaheb Ambedkar Technological University, Lonere-Raigad invites applications for various statutory posts from the eligible candidates in the prescribed format form 12/06/2026 (Friday) to 02/07/2026 (Thursday). Educational qualifications and all other related information in available on the University website (www.dbatu.ac.in).

Sd/-
Registrar,
Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Technological University,
Lonere- Raigad

Date: 12/06/2026.
Place: Lonere

भारतीय कंटेनर लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(भारत सरकार का उपक्रम) (A Govt. of India Undertaking)
(A Navatna Company)

ICD, Tughlakabad, New Delhi – 110 020

PUBLIC AUCTION/TENDER NOTICE

DISPOSAL OF UNCLEARED/UNCLAIMED IMPORTED CARGO THROUGH E-AUCTION

Container Corporation of India Ltd. shall be auctioning scrap items, empty damage containers and unclaimed/uncleared imported cargo landed at the terminals of Area 1 and Area-IV those containers arrived on or before 31.12.2025 through e-auction on 30.06.2026 on “AS IS WHERE IS BASIS”. All details along with Terms & Conditions of auction sale & cargo details will be available on www.concorindia.co.in & www.mstcecommerce.com w.e.f. 17.06.2026. All importers including Government Undertakings/Departments whose containers/goods are lying unclaimed/uncleared and failing in the said list uploaded in website at respective terminals, because of any dispute, stay by Court/Tribunal/others or any such reason may accordingly inform the concerned Area Head at Area 1 of CONCOR as well as Commissioner of Customs of the concerned Commissioners, and file their objections/claims regarding disposal of such goods within 7 (Seven Days) of this notice failing which the goods will be auctioned on “AS IS WHERE IS BASIS” without any further notice. For full details please log on to www.concorindia.co.in & www.mstcecommerce.com

Area Head, Area 1

महाराजा छत्रसाल बुन्देलखण्ड विश्वविद्यालय छतरपुर (म.प्र.)
E-mail : mchhatrasaluniversity@gmail.com
Website : <https://mcub.ac.in>

विज्ञापन क्र. 1741/स्था./विज्ञापन/2026 छतरपुर, दिनांक : 16.06.2026

शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के सह-प्राध्यापक के पदों पर सीधी भर्ती हेतु विज्ञापन 2026

महाराजा छत्रसाल बुन्देलखण्ड, विश्वविद्यालय, छतरपुर (म.प्र.) के शैक्षणिक विभागों के 10 विषयों के शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के सह-प्राध्यापक के कुल 20 रिक्त पदों पर सीधी भर्ती से नियुक्ति हेतु विश्वविद्यालय अनुदान आयोग (UGC) द्वारा निर्धारित अर्हताधारी अभ्यर्थियों से आवेदन पत्र दिनांक 15.07.2026 सय 6 बजे तक आमंत्रित किए जाते हैं। विज्ञापित पदों का संक्षिप्त विवरण निम्नानुसार है :-

सह-प्राध्यापक – 20 पद (चित्रकला-02, अर्थशास्त्र-02, भूगोल-02, हिन्दी-02, इतिहास-02, संगीत-02, दर्शनशास्त्र-02, राजनीतिशास्त्र-02, संस्कृत-02, प्राणीशास्त्र-02) रिक्त पदों का विस्तृत विवरण/आवेदन प्रपत्र/सामान्य नियम एवं शर्तें आदि विश्वविद्यालय की वेबसाइट <https://mcub.ac.in> पर उपलब्ध है।

म.प्र. माध्यम/126429/2026 **कुलसचिव**

संस्कृत मंत्रालय
भारत सरकार

समसामयिक अध्ययन केन्द्र
प्रधानमंत्री संग्रहालय एवं पुस्तकालय द्वारा आयोजित

वार्ता

दि फॉर्मेशन ऑफ एनसीईआरटी एंड दि राइटिंग ऑफ हिस्ट्री टेक्स्टबुकस (1961-2006)

में

आप सादर आमंत्रित हैं।

वक्ता:

डॉ. प्रतीक कुमार

पूर्व फेलो, प्रधानमंत्री संग्रहालय एवं पुस्तकालय

दिनांक गुरुवार 18 जून 2026, समय : अपराह्न 3.00 बजे

स्थल :

संगोष्ठी कक्ष,

प्रधानमंत्री संग्रहालय एवं पुस्तकालय

तीन मूर्ति भवन, नई दिल्ली

सभी का स्वागत है।

आमंत्रण प्राप्त करने के लिए हमें ईमेल करें: ccs2nmml@gmail.com

CBC 09142/11/0016/2627

DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-I
7TH FLOOR, ADDITIONAL OFFICE BUILDING, SHASTRI BHAVAN,
HADDOWS ROAD, NUNGAMBAKKAM, CHENNAI 600 006

DRC No. 267/2017 Dated: 12.06.2026.

E – AUCTION SALE

The under mentioned properties will be sold “As is and where is/on what it is / no complaint” basis by on line e-auction through website <https://www.banketauctions.com/> for recovery of a sum of the ₹ 829,26,46,671/- [Rupees Eight Hundred and Twenty Nine Crores Twenty Six Lakhs Forty Six Thousand Six Hundred and Seventy One Only] as on 22/4/2026 Plus further interest and costs payable as per law till the date of realization, less amount already recovered, if any, from Siva Industries & Holdings Ltd. to Life Insurance Corporation, Central Office, Investment Department, Mid Office, Yogakshema, Mumbai - 400 021 as per Order of Hon'ble Supreme Court dated 24/2/2026 in S. JAYALAKSHMI VERSUS M/S SIVA INDUSTRIES AND HOLDINGS LIMITED bearing Miscellaneous Application Nos. 191-192 of 2023 in Civil Appeal Nos. 1811-1812 OF 2022 and Miscellaneous Application Nos. 193-194 of 2023 in Civil Appeal Nos. 1811-1812 of 2022.

DESCRIPTION OF PROPERTY

1. Plot No.39 at Ambattur Industrial Estate:
All that piece and parcel of land situated at Plot No. 39 (North Phase) at together with building/structure/pathway Ambattur Industrial Estate, Ambattur Taluk, Tiruvallur District, measuring **10.87 acres** comprised in S. Nos. 76/1 part, 76/2 part, 79/1 part, 79/2 part, 80 part, 107 part, 117 part, 118 part, 119 part, 120 and 124 part of Ambattur Village; and S. Nos. 231 part, 232 part, 234 part, 235, 236 part, 237/1B part, 237/2, 240 part and 241 part of Pattaravakkam Village, Tiruvallur District and bounded on

North by : 60 feet road
South by :Plot Nos. 40 (NP) & 42 (NP)
East by :Plot No. 52 (NP)
West by :120 feet road

Within the Registration District of North Chennai and the Sub Registration District of Ambattur.

2. Plot No.40 at Ambattur Industrial Estate:
All that piece and parcel of land situated at Plot No. 40 (North Phase) at Ambattur Industrial Estate, Ambattur Taluk, Tiruvallur District, measuring **3.19 acres** comprised in S. Nos. 78 part, 80 part, 107 part, 112 part, 114 part, 115 part, 116 part, 117 part and 118 part of Ambattur Village, Tiruvallur District and bounded on

North by : Plot No. 39 (North Phase)
South by :Plot No. 40A (North Phase)
East by :Plot No. 42 (North Phase)
West by :120 feet road

Within the Registration District of North Chennai and the Sub Registration District of Ambattur.

Date and time of e-auction: 22.07.2026 between 03:00 P.M. and 04:00 P.M. with auto time extension of 3 minutes each, till sale is concluded. **UPSET PRICE: ₹ 4,01,76,91,680/-; Earnest Money Deposit: 10% of the upset price; ₹ 40,17,69,168/- Last date for submission of bid form with EMD: EMD from bidders Account on or before 21.07.2026 through EFT/NEFT/RTGS Transfer in favor of “The Recovery Officer, DRT-I, Chennai” to the credit of Current A/c. No. 01651010005110, Punjab National Bank, IFSC Code - PUNB0016510, Branch - Mount Road, Chennai - 600 002; Bid Multiplier for Item: ₹ 1,00,00,000/-; Inspection of Property: 10.07.2026 from 11.00 A.M. to 3.00 P.M.; Poundage Fee: 2% upto ₹ 1000/- & 1% on the sale amount in excess of ₹ 1000/- as poundage fee to be paid by Demand Draft in favour Of “The Registrar, DRT-I, Chennai – 600 006”**

UNDER ANY CIRCUMSTANCES BIDS IN PHYSICAL FORM WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED BY THE TRIBUNAL & NO ENQUIRIES WILL BE ENTERTAINED.

The other details about the above auction and the e-auction bid form and declaration form and detailed terms and conditions are available in the website;
Website: <https://www.banketauctions.com/>

Further property details if any required shall be obtained from Shri. Prasant Unawane, and Shri. Rajan Babu, Administrative Officers Life Insurance Corporation, Central Office, Investment Department, Mid Office, Yogakshema, Mumbai – 400 021 (Contact No. 97465 73593 / 70453 61922 / 022-6659-9303) and Assistance in respect of e-auction Procedure contact Mr. Prabakaran M (07418281709) M/s C1 INDIA PVT. LTD, Plot No.301, First Floor Udyog Vihar, Phase-2, Gurgaon Haryana – 122 015

(S. PREM MANOHAR WILLIAM)
RECOVERY OFFICER



Moving In

BJP PRESIDENT Nitin Nabin is scheduled to move into his officially allotted residence on 1 Motilal Nehru Marg on Wednesday following the end of the “Adhik Maas” period, considered favourable only for non-material pursuits as per Hindu traditions. According to party insiders, an elaborate *Griha Pravesh* ceremony will take place at the Rajya Sabha MP’s new home where the entire senior leadership of the party and the RSS among other political bigwigs are likely to be in attendance.

In Solidarity

THE ULTIMATE test of a friendship is enduring hardship together. And that is what is happening within the INDIA bloc during the time of crisis for the TMC. The Mamata Banerjee-led party is undergoing a crisis as its MPs have made it clear that they are set to break away. In between all this and Abhishek Banerjee being questioned on consecutive days by agencies, several top leaders of the INDIA bloc have stayed in touch with Mamata and other senior leaders of the party over the past couple of days. Sources said that Rahul Gandhi, Akhilesh Yadav, Uddhav Thackeray and at least 10 other leaders from different parties have been in touch with Mamata and others, extending their solidarity and support to the party.

Lodging Protest

AFTER THE Centre lodged what it described as a “strong protest” with Washington over the killing of three Indian seafarers in US military action last week, the Sangh Parivar too has joined the chorus — albeit in much sharper terms. The RSS-affiliated Swadeshi Jagaran Manch (SJM) has written to the US Ambassador in New Delhi expressing “deep pain and anguish” over what it called the “tragic unprovoked killing” of unarmed Indians, and accused the US administration of adding “insult to injury” through its response. It described the incident as a “serious violation” of international law, and warned India could raise the issue at global forums.

Uzbekistan looks to woo investors as TIIF opens today

Harikishan Sharma
Tashkent, June 16

UZBEKISTAN LAUNCHED the Tashkent International Investment Forum (TIIF) 2026 on Tuesday, welcoming global business leaders and heads of governments, mainly from neighbouring countries, as part of its drive to attract foreign investment.

While President Shavkat Mirziyoyev will formally inaugurate the TIIF on Wednesday, pre-opening sessions and a “Discover Uzbekistan’s Industrial and Investment Potential” exhibition were held on Tuesday.

President Mirziyoyev welcomed foreign dignitaries and business delegates and held meetings. Mirziyoyev held talks with Albania President Bajram Begaj, where both sides “agreed” to expand cooperation in trade, investment, logistics, culture, and tourism, while establishing new bilateral relations.

Mirziyoyev also held a meeting with Tajikistan PM Kokhir Rasulzoda and Adylbek Kasymaliyev, Chairman of the Cabinet

DMK’s post-breakup letter spells it out: Rahul is prime target

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, June 16

FOR YEARS, the Congress in Tamil Nadu occupied a peculiar place in Dravidian politics. It was too weak to threaten the DMK, too useful to discard, and too dependent to negotiate as an equal. The arrangement survived election after election because both sides understood its logic. The Congress brought a national face, the DMK supplied almost everything else.

That arrangement is now over. And if one wants to understand how bitter the divorce has become, one need only read the latest editorial in ‘Murasoli’, the DMK’s official mouthpiece, published on Sunday.

The article is not merely an attack on Rahul Gandhi. It is an attempt to explain, justify and emotionally process what many in the DMK view as a political betrayal after Congress legislators left the DMK-led alliance and joined the Vijay-led government.

The headline question posed by the editorial is deceptively simple: How can Rahul Gandhi lecture others about opposition unity when, according to the DMK, he has spent years undermining it? The



Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi with Congress MP Praveen Chakravarty and Tamil Nadu Ministers Rajesh Kumar and Viswanathan Perumal in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

piece begins with an argument that has become increasingly common among regional parties within the INDIA bloc. Rahul Gandhi, it suggests, speaks the language of unity nationally while practising a different politics in the states.

The editorial’s principal exhibit is Kerala. It recalls Gandhi’s repeated attacks on former CM Pinarayi Vijayan and CPI(M), particularly his allegation during election campaigns that there existed a “secret understanding” between Left and BJP. That charge has long

infuriated Communist leaders.

At the recent INDIA bloc discussions, CPI(M) leaders reportedly confronted Rahul directly over those remarks. The Murasoli editorial prominently cites CPI(M) RS MP John Brittas, who argued that Left did not require certificates from Congress regarding its anti-BJP credentials. The article also invokes CPI General Secretary D Raja’s criticism that Rahul’s comments reflected “political immaturity.”

The underlying complaint is larger than Kerala. Regional parties increasingly believe that

Congress demands solidarity from allies during parliamentary elections while often behaving like a competitor during state elections. The editorial’s most cutting line may be its suggestion that Congress asks regional parties to help defeat the BJP nationally after spending years trying to weaken those same parties locally.

In other words: Congress wants coalition politics in Delhi and competition everywhere else. The DMK’s anger, however, is not really about Kerala. It is about Tamil Nadu.

The Congress won five seats as part of the DMK-led alliance in 2026 election. Within weeks, those legislators entered the Vijay-led coalition government. To DMK leaders, this was not merely political realignment. It was abandonment.

The editorial repeatedly suggests such a move could not have happened without the knowledge — or at least the blessing — of Congress leadership. That accusation remains politically explosive because it converts what might otherwise have been seen as legislative pragmatism into something resembling organised desertion.

The article’s emotional tone is also revealing. Historically,

the party’s harshest attacks were directed at ideological opponents such as the BJP or electoral rivals such as the AIADMK. Now Rahul Gandhi is being discussed in language once reserved for adversaries.

The editorial repeatedly portrays him as a leader whose actions have weakened opposition unity in state after state. It cites complaints attributed to SP chief Akhilesh Yadav, RJD leader Tejashwi Yadav and others as evidence that dissatisfaction with Congress extends well beyond Tamil Nadu.

The DMK wants to establish a narrative: that the crisis inside the INDIA bloc is not the product of ideological differences but of Congress behaviour. There is also unmistakable sarcasm running through the article. Gandhi’s remark that Congress must absorb criticism “like Lord Shiva drinking poison” receives particularly mocking treatment.

According to the editorial, even the mythology Rahul invokes undermines his argument. In the story, Shiva did not create the poison. He merely consumed it. If poison now circulates within the opposition alliance, the editorial asks, who created it in the first place?



Former minister Vijayabaskar hands over his resignation letter to Speaker J C D Prabhakar in Chennai on Tuesday. ANI

AIADMK crisis deepens as its 4-time MLA quits; fifth after poll loss

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, June 16

THE EROSION of the AIADMK continued on Tuesday as former Health Minister and Viralmalai MLA Dr C Vijayabaskar resigned from the Tamil Nadu Assembly, becoming the fifth AIADMK legislator to quit the House since the recent election results were declared.

Speaker J C D Prabhakar accepted the resignation soon after Vijayabaskar submitted his letter at the Secretariat. His exit reduces the AIADMK’s strength in the Assembly to 42, and comes just weeks after four other legislators — Maragatham Kumaravel, S Jayakumar, P Sathyabama and Esakki Subaya — resigned and joined Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay’s TVK.

Unlike those departures, however, Vijayabaskar’s resignation carries a different political weight. A four-time MLA, former health minister and one of the most recognisable faces of the Edappadi K Palaniswami era, Vijayabaskar has long been considered among AIADMK’s strongest constituency politicians, a leader who built influence not through television studios or social media campaigns but through relentless ground-level engagement.

In his social media post, he signalled the break publicly. “Leadership is not authority or

arrogance. It is a profound embrace of dedication,” he said, which has been interpreted as a criticism of the current AIADMK leadership.

Vijayabaskar’s political journey has been closely intertwined with the AIADMK. Associated with the party since his college days, he rose through its ranks to become one of the youngest ministers in Jayalalithaa government and later served as health minister under CMs Jayalalithaa, O Panneerselvam and EPS.

He first entered the Assembly from Pudukkottai in 2001, and later transformed Viralmalai into one of the party’s safest constituencies, winning in 2011, 2016, 2021 and again in 2026. During the dramatic confidence vote that followed Vijay’s rise to power, Vijayabaskar was among the 25 AIADMK legislators who rebelled against the party whip and voted in favour of the new government.

For Palaniswami, the loss is both numerical and symbolic.

Within the AIADMK, Vijayabaskar occupied a rare position combining ministerial experience with a durable local base and an ability to maintain personal relationships across party lines. For Vijay, Vijayabaskar represents something more valuable than a single seat. He represents an established regional power centre.

Great Nicobar project: Zoological Survey to soon seek nod for translocating corals

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, June 16

THE ZOOLOGICAL Survey of India (ZSI) will soon seek a nod from the Department of Environment and Forest, Andaman and Nicobar Islands, for translocation of over 16,000 coral colonies that are to be impacted around the Galathea Bay transshipment port site, under Great Nicobar Island (GNI) project, senior officials told The Indian Express.

ZSI has also begun data collection to measure sediment deposition at coral translocation recipient sites and around existing coral colonies, to assess current levels of sediment load, said C Raghunathan, additional director and Scientist-F at ZSI.

Translocation of coral colonies — to mitigate potential impacts of port construction activities such as capital dredging — is one of the key conditions in the environmental clearance granted for the Rs 81,000 crore mega project.

In a challenge before the NGT, the ZSI had submitted that 16,150 coral colonies found within 15 m depth of water column and in proximity of the project may get impacted because of the project. These coral colonies need to be translocated to suitable recipient sites based on “sediment trap results”.

“ZSI has been assessing sediment load in the port project area as well as at the recipient sites. Dredging is an intensive activity and that will cause turbidity in the waters around the project area. A baseline sediment load analysis is also necessary to gauge the impact on corals,” said Raghunathan.

He said ZSI is in the process of seeking an approval for coral translocation from the A&N Island administration. Subsequently, an approval will also be sought from the wildlife division of the Ministry of Environment. The ZSI has identified four sites on the west coast of the Great Nicobar Island.

Asked about the success rate of transplantation or translocation, Raghunathan cited the ZSI’s project in the Gulf of Kutch involving restoration of degraded corals. The ZSI’s coral conservation plan for the GNI project states that the success rate varied from above 90% in terms of restoration and between 68% to 85% for coral transplants. The ZSI’s coral conservation plan for the Great Nicobar project states that coral colonies are to be extracted with the help of coral cutting saw, hammer and chisel and hydraulic underwater hammer drill.

Experts, though, called the task of moving entire coral colonies as “near impossible”. Marine biologist and independent researcher Vardhan Patankar, who has been researching coral reefs found off Nicobar Islands since 2005, said globally coral translocations have had limited success. “Whatever little translocation that has happened involves translocation of fragments of corals and not large colonies. Coral composition along the Galathea River is dominated by Porites, Favia, and other large boulder corals. A coral colony consists of complex, interconnected colonies of several individual organisms and keeping all of them alive after breaking the colony is a near impossible task,” he said.

Mamata moves HC, challenges her poll defeat in Bhabanipur

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, June 16

NEARLY A month-and-a-half after her defeat in the Bhabanipur Assembly constituency, TMC chief and former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee on Tuesday filed an election petition in the Calcutta HC, challenging the election result.

The TMC chief had lost to her aide-turned-rival Suwendu Adhikari by 15,105 votes. The victory in Bhabanipur, considered Mamata’s stronghold, propelled Adhikari to become the first BJP chief minister of the state.

A day after the TMC’s crushing defeat, a defiant Mamata, in a press conference at her Kalighat residence, on May 5 refused to submit her resignation to the Governor, alleging “looting of votes” by the BJP “through EVM manipulation”.

She alleged that TMC candidates, including herself, were assaulted. “We have not been defeated. I have not been defeated. I will not resign. There is no question of my going to the Raj Bhavan,” she had said. “In this election, BJP and the Election Commission played a dirty game. They forcibly grabbed votes,” she had alleged.



TMC chief Mamata Banerjee leaves Calcutta HC on Tuesday. PTI

“I was assaulted inside the counting centre. I was not allowed to enter. My agent was also not allowed to enter. If such atrocities happened against me, imagine what happened with other candidates,” the TMC chief claimed.

Alleging EVM manipulation, Mamata had said, “How can EVMs have 90%, 95% battery (during counting). We have all the proof.”

On Tuesday, Mamata, accompanied by TMC leaders Dola Sen, Derek O’ Brien, and Kunal Ghosh, reached the Calcutta High Court around 2 pm

to file the petition.

TMC MP and senior counsel Kalyan Banerjee told reporters, “Mamata Banerjee had come to Calcutta HC to affirm the election petition filed by her challenging the election of Suwendu Adhikari (from Bhabanipur). After the 12th round of the counting of votes, she and her election agent were beaten up.”

This is not the first time Mamata has challenged an election result. She had challenged Adhikari’s victory in Nandigram, where she lost by 1,960 votes. The case is still pending in the Calcutta High Court.

RS polls: As BJP moves MLAs to Ranchi hotel, Cong claims some of them in touch

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, June 16

WITH JUST two days left for voting for the Rajya Sabha polls in Jharkhand, the battle for the second upper house seat has entered a crucial phase, with the BJP-led NDA moving its legislators to a Ranchi-based hotel and the Congress claiming that some of them are in touch.

The development comes a day after seven NDA legislators skipped a meeting convened by the alliance in Ranchi ahead of the June 18 election, where NDA-backed Independent candidate Parimal Nathwani was present. BJP leaders, however, maintained that the absent legislators had informed the party in advance and dismissed suggestions of any unease within the alliance.

Sources in the BJP said NDA legislators would stay at a hotel in Ranchi until polling day and would be taken directly from there to the Assembly for voting. The move assumes significance as Nathwani’s candidature has made the contest for the second Rajya Sabha seat one of the most closely watched political battles in the state.



Jharkhand Leader of Opposition Babul Marandi arrives at a hotel in Ranchi on Tuesday. PTI

A candidate requires 28 first-preference votes to win. While the JMM-led alliance, with 56 MLAs, is comfortably placed to secure one seat for its nominee Baidyanath Ram, the NDA has only 24 MLAs — BJP (21), AJSU Party (1), JD(U) (1) and LJP-RV (1) and remains dependent on support beyond its official strength for Nathwani’s victory.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Congress MLA Bandhu Tirkey claimed some BJP MLAs are in contact with leaders of INDIA bloc, though he refrained from naming anyone. “There are people within

the BJP who are giving us information. We are completely confident, and our alliance is intact,” Tirkey said.

A BJP functionary rejected the claim and described the decision to keep legislators together as a routine exercise ahead of the election. “Many MLAs are new. Coordination and training are also necessary. Everyone will stay together and from there they will go to the assembly for voting,” Jharkhand Legislative Assembly Leader of Opposition and BJP leader Babul Marandi said. Asked how the NDA plans to secure the

28 votes needed for a win, he said that was a question for the candidate to answer, while asserting that all NDA MLAs are united.

BJP spokesperson Mrityunjay Sharma said that the NDA remained confident of winning the second seat. “We already have 24 votes and need only four more. We will get the required support,” he said, adding that the alliance’s confidence was no different from what it was when it first entered the contest.

Sources said 17 NDA legislators attended Monday’s meeting at the party’s state headquarters. Leaders across party lines acknowledged that housing legislators in hotels before RS polls is a common strategy adopted by parties to prevent rival camps from approaching their members and to ensure attendance during voting.

Nathwani, the Independent candidate BJP is backing, is a Gujarat-based businessman and sitting YSRC RS member. Having earlier represented Jharkhand in the RS, he has publicly appealed for support from MLAs across party lines and has maintained he shares cordial relations with leaders from different political parties.

Pragati
Path@
12
Varsh

Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke



Har Ghar Jal Jal Jeevan Mission

UTTAR PRADESH

LEADS INDIA'S RURAL WATER REVOLUTION

Uttar Pradesh has emerged as a national leader in rural water transformation under the Jal Jeevan Mission, providing piped drinking water to over 2.62 crore households across the state. More than 2.22 crore rural families in 66 districts have been connected through an extensive 5.18 lakh km pipeline network, while 35,746 villages achieved 100% tap water connectivity. The mission is further strengthening sustainability through 33,000+ solar-powered water projects benefiting 2+ crore families. Alongside infrastructure growth, the state is promoting local employment, women's participation, and digital transparency through skill development initiatives and the Jal Sarathi App. With investments exceeding ₹28,000 crore, Uttar Pradesh is creating a strong, inclusive & future-ready rural water ecosystem.



TRANSFORMING RURAL WATER ACCESS IN UTTAR PRADESH

- Piped drinking water reached 2.67+ crore households across Uttar Pradesh.
- Safe tap water delivered to 20.63 lakh families in Vindhya & Bundelkhand.
- 2.22+ crore rural families connected under Jal Jeevan Mission across 66 districts.
- Rapid progress across 97,070 villages for clean & uninterrupted water supply.
- 35,746 villages achieved 100% tap water connectivity.
- 26,816+ villages certified as 'Har Ghar Jal' villages.
- 5.18 lakh km pipeline network laid across the state.
- Safe drinking water ensured in 1.16 lakh+ schools.
- 5 lakh+ rural women trained in water quality testing.
- Uttar Pradesh won Second Prize at the Isha International Awards.
- Solar-powered Jal Jeevan projects recognised with PM Excellence Award 2023.
- 'Har Ghar Jal Model' won Best Display Award at International Trade Show 2025.
- State's first Jal Jeevan Mission Skill Development Centre established in Ayodhya.
- 550+ artisans trained in plumbing, fitting, masonry & electrical work in Ayodhya.



Har Ghar Jal Across Vindhya & Bundelkhand



- Bundelkhand Region achieving major success with 42 water supply schemes covering 3,556+ villages, 10.90+ lakh households, and 65.62+ lakh population across Mahoba, Chitrakoot, Banda, Hamirpur, Jalaun, Jhansi & Lalitpur.
- 97.72% targeted villages in Bundelkhand already connected with safe piped drinking water.
- Vindhyaachal Region witnessing rapid progress through 21 major schemes benefiting 2,756+ villages, 5.97+ lakh households, and 35.83+ lakh population in Mirzapur & Sonbhadra.
- 94.87% targeted villages in Vindhyaachal region covered under safe tap water connectivity.
- Clean tap water ensuring better health, improved dignity, and enhanced quality of life in water-scarce rural districts.

DIGITAL TRANSPARENCY THROUGH JAL SARATHI APP



जल सारथी

- Live monitoring from water source to household tap connections.
- Real-time dashboards tracking projects from state to village level.
- Geo-tagging ensuring transparent tracking of pipelines & water assets.
- Citizens can apply for tap connections and register complaints online.
- Quick grievance support through online plumber & official details.
- Road restoration updates available after pipeline installation.
- Women-led water quality testing strengthening accountability & participation.



STRONG FINANCIAL SUPPORT FOR MISSION EXPANSION



- ₹28,000+ crore allocated for project expansion and completion.
- Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 launched to strengthen rural water infrastructure.
- Strong focus on water quality testing in chemically affected areas.
- Village Water & Sanitation Committees empowered for long-term maintenance.
- Special emphasis on water conservation for future water security.

SOLAR-POWERED RURAL WATER SUPPLY



- 33,000+ solar-powered water projects running across 67,000 villages.
- Clean drinking water reaching 2 crore+ families through solar schemes.
- Nearly 900 MW power savings achieved via solar integration.
- ₹37,000+ crore savings projected over the next 30 years.
- Green energy adoption driving major annual carbon reduction.
- Uninterrupted water supply ensured even during power cuts.

At G7 meet, Carney invites Modi to visit Canada; both vow to strengthen relations

Urges stronger cooperation in defence, energy supplies, security

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, June 16

A YEAR after they began the reset of ties at the G7 Summit in Canada, Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney on the sidelines of the G7 Summit in Evian, France, on Tuesday. They agreed to strengthen co-operation in defence, information security and energy.

Carney also invited Modi to visit Canada by the end of the year, as the two sides are working on signing the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA).

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said in a joint statement, "The two Prime Ministers welcomed the positive momentum in India-Canada relations and noted with satisfaction the progress achieved since Prime Minister Carney's successful visit to India in March 2026."



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, US President Donald Trump, French President Emmanuel Macron and other world leaders during the G7 summit in Evian-les-Bains, France, on Tuesday. PTI

Reaffirming their commitment to building a forward-looking strategic partnership, it said that the leaders underscored the complementarities between the Indian and Canadian economies and highlighted the importance of "resilient and reliable supply chains in strengthening global energy and food security".

On energy supply, the MEA said that the leaders reviewed progress in bilateral economic cooperation, including devel-

opments in "commercial arrangements relating to LNG, LPG and metallurgical coal".

On the bilateral trade pact, it said that the leaders welcomed the ongoing momentum in the exchange of high-level visits between the two countries. They took note of the recent visit by the Minister of Commerce and Industry, Piyush Goyal, to Canada and looked forward to the forthcoming Canadian trade mission to India later in 2026.

"Both sides expressed satisfaction with the progress in negotiations towards a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement and reaffirmed their shared objective of concluding the negotiations in 2026," it said.

On defence and security ties, it said, "To further deepen defence and security cooperation, the Prime Ministers agreed to launch negotiations on a General Security of Information Agreement (GSOIA).

They also welcomed recent exchanges between defence institutions, including the visit of the National Defence College of India to Canada."

It said that the two leaders welcomed the strengthening of institutional engagement between the two governments, including the recent meetings of the Joint Science and Technology Committee and the Consular Dialogue. They also looked forward to forthcoming dialogues in the areas of defence,

finance and migration. They noted ongoing collaboration under the Canada-India Talent and Innovation Strategy, including initiatives to strengthen skill development, innovation partnerships, and educational cooperation between institutions in the two nations.

Modi expressed India's support for Canada becoming a Dialogue Partner of the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA), it said. They announced the establishment of Raisina Americas as a platform to further strengthen dialogue, exchanges and cooperation.

"Prime Minister Modi thanked Prime Minister Carney for his invitation to visit Canada in 2026. Both sides agreed to remain engaged through diplomatic channels to work towards a mutually convenient date for the visit," it said.

This is a major turnaround in ties after two years of hostility between the two countries when former PM of Canada Justin Trudeau had alleged Indian government's "potential" involvement in the killing of pro-Khalistan separatist Hardeep Singh Nijjar. India has rejected the charges, calling them "politically motivated" and "absurd".

Kerala records spike in Shigella cases, 4 deaths this month

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, June 16

KERALA HAS seen a spike in cases of the highly contagious Shigella bacterial infection, with the state reporting 146 confirmed cases — 70 of them in the first two weeks of this month. Five deaths, including four this month, have also been reported this year. Kozhikode and Wayanad have been the worst-hit districts, reporting 74 and 16 confirmed cases, respectively.

Health Minister K Muralaadhara has blamed poor pre-monsoon cleaning — affected due to the Assembly polls in April. "Pre-monsoon cleaning is mainly the job of local bodies. The newly elected local bodies assumed office in December last year. By the time most of the newly elected members had settled, the Assembly poll schedule was announced. Everyone had then gone into election mood, and the pre-monsoon cleaning drive was affected," he said. On the spike in cases, he said more cases were being detected amid an increase in testing. "...There will be outbreak monitoring units in all districts."

As per the Department data, the state reported 429 Shigella cases from 2016 to 2025, with nine deaths during that period. In recent years, almost all districts in the state have reported positive cases.

Imphal: Protest continues as 3 injured Kuki men undergo treatment at RIMS

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, June 16

TENSIONS CONTINUE to simmer in Imphal over the admission of three Kuki-Zo men, who were injured in a gunfight, to the Regional Institute of Medical Sciences (RIMS), with an angry crowd gathering outside the building again on Tuesday night. Security forces used teargas to disperse the crowd.

Similar scenes were witnessed on Monday, after which security was deployed on the premises. Those agitating against the admission include members of the Meitei and Naga communities, who continue to gather despite the institute being blocked by barricades. Earlier in the day, the RIMS media cell issued a statement that all its services and departments were functioning normally. However, it condemned the use of teargas within the premises.

"RIMS strongly condemns the firing of mock bombs and smoke bombs within the hospital premises following the large-



Protesters gather outside RIMS in Imphal on Monday. ANI

scale public protest that occurred yesterday. The institute expresses grave concern over the potential risks posed by such actions to patients, attendants, healthcare personnel, and the general public. Any activity that may compromise safety within the premises is a matter of serious concern and must be strictly avoided," it stated.

The situation in Imphal has been tense since Monday after three Kuki-Zo men who sustained bullet injuries in an exchange of fire in Kangpokpi be-

tween suspected Naga and Kuki-Zo groups were admitted there.

One of the key features of the conflict between the Meitei and Kuki-Zo communities has been the restricted movement of people from one community to areas where the other community is in the majority. With a conflict flaring up between the Kuki-Zo and Naga communities as well now, Naga groups and individuals objected to the Kuki-Zo men being brought to the state capital for medical treatment by security forces.

SIT in Ayodhya, investigation into Ram Mandir 'fund embezzlement' begins

Express News Service
Lucknow, June 16

THE THREE-MEMBER Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the alleged misappropriation of donations at the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya on Tuesday questioned several people associated with the temple management, including those involved in handling and accounting of donations and valuables offered by devotees.

The SIT, headed by Lucknow Divisional Commissioner Vijay Vishwas Pant with IGP Kiran S. and Neelratna Kumar, Special Secretary in the Finance Department as members, arrived in Ayodhya on Monday and has continued its investigation over the past 24 hours.

Sources said the team is examining records related to donations received at the temple and scrutinising the entire process of counting, book-keeping and depositing funds. The investigators have also sought details of officials, employees and other individuals

Officials question several people associated with the temple management

involved in managing donations and maintaining accounts, it is learnt.

The probe is focused on verifying procedures followed in receiving, counting and depositing offerings made by devotees, sources said. The state government has constituted the SIT after allegations of irregularities in the handling of donations and valuables at the temple surfaced, with Opposition parties mounting an attack on the government over the issue.

On Tuesday, the Samajwadi Party (SP) and the Congress demanded a judicial inquiry, arguing that an independent probe is necessary to ensure transparency and maintain public confidence in the management of temple donations.

SP MP Dimple Yadav questioned the government's hand-

ling of the issue, alleging that attempts were being made to divert attention from the allegations of misappropriation. Party president Akhilesh Yadav, who had first raised the issue, would continue to seek answers and accountability, she said.

The party has alleged that gold, silver and diamond ornaments donated by devotees were replaced with fake items and that theft worth crores of rupees has taken place.

Also, AAP MP Sanjay Singh accused Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust general secretary Champat Rai of purchasing land worth Rs 24 crore, claiming that a parcel of Nazul land valued at Rs 3 crore was acquired at a significantly higher price. He demanded greater transparency in the Trust's financial dealings, while questioning the handling of funds linked to the temple project.

The Trust, however, has not publicly responded to the allegations.

BRIEFLY



A stage being built on Red Road on Tuesday. PARTHA PAUL

WEST BENGAL

Kolkata's Red Road closed for eight days ahead of Yoga Day on June 21

WITH PRIME Minister Narendra Modi and West Bengal Chief Minister Suvenud Adhikari slated to attend an International Yoga Day event in Kolkata on Sunday, Red Road has been closed for eight days, beginning June 14, for preparatory work. A traffic diversion plan, advising commuters to use alternative routes to avoid congestion and travel delays, has been issued. "Movement of all goods vehicles shall be restricted along AJC Bose Road to south from its crossing with Lenin Sarani (Moulali crossing), St Georges Gate Road, Strand Road up towards Raja Woodmunt Street... from 02:00 hrs on 21.06.2026, until the event is over," read the advisory. ENS

Rajasthan: NEET aspirant dies by suicide in Sikar

A 22-YEAR-OLD NEET aspirant in Sikar died by suicide ahead of the re-examination on June 21. Sikar police said that the now-cancelled May 2026 exam was Umesh's third attempt. Although he had previously studied at coaching centres, he was this time preparing for the re-test at home. According to police, Umesh has left behind a letter stating, "Main is duniya se dur ja raha hun, sorry (I am going away from this world, sorry)." "...Inquiry will be conducted once his family members are in a better condition," Udyog Nagar SHO Rajesh Kumar said. ENS

Kannur-Jeddah flight returns due to engine failure

AN AIR India Express flight bound to Jeddah from Kannur returned within two hours of the flight on Tuesday due to a fault in the aircraft's engine, airport sources said. The aircraft with over 180 passengers took off at 7.40 am from Kannur airport, but around two hours into the flight, the pilots saw an engine warning light and decided to return, sources said. "The flight landed safely in Kannur, and all the passengers are fine," they said. A subsequent check of the aircraft found that there was something wrong with the fuel filter, sources said. PTI

Provide all amenities to visually impaired man and his mother living in poverty, SC tells Odisha

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 16

TAKING SUO motu cognisance of news reports highlighting the plight of a poverty-stricken visually impaired man and his aged mother in Odisha, the Supreme Court on Tuesday asked the state government to provide them with all basic amenities.

A bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justice V Mohana also asked the Odisha government to furnish a compliance report. "The State of Odisha and its authorities are directed to ensure that all basic amenities are made available to Radhika Bhue and her son Japa Bhue till further orders. A status report to this effect, giving full details of the amenities extended to the mother and the son, shall be filed," the order said.

The top court directed that Japa be engaged as a paid para-legal volunteer so that he can work among specially-abled persons to sensitise them about their rights and to make them aware of the benefits under Central and State schemes which they can avail of. The news reports had highlighted how a 56-year-old Japa Bhue and his elderly mother Radhika Bhue, residents of Subarnapur

district, had been struggling to sustain themselves after the death of his father recently.

The top court registered proceedings under the title, 'In Re: Ensuring Basic Human Dignity And Social Security For Differently Abled Citizens Living In Extreme Poverty And Other Ancillary Issues'. Tuesday, the state authorities informed the bench that the mother had been allotted a house and that Japa was living with her. Besides, houses had also been allotted to his brothers, the state counsel submitted. The counsel also submitted that Radhika was being given a monthly pension of Rs 3,500 and Japa too was receiving a similar amount under disability pension. They were also being provided with free rice.

The top court said that Japa may be entitled to a separate dwelling unit and asked the state legal services authority to examine this and take it up with the government, if he is found to be eligible. The bench directed the state to file an affidavit through an official, not below the rank of Additional Chief Secretary, explaining details of the pensions being provided to Radhika Japa, as well as any social security benefits being provided to them under State or Central schemes.

Lion pride kills restaurant worker in Gujarat's Amreli

Express News Service
Ahmedabad, June 16

A PRIDE of lions mauled to death a 29-year-old man who worked at a restaurant in Gujarat's Amreli, forest department officials said on Tuesday. Prakash Chandra, from Uttarakhand, was killed after he encountered a pride of lions while walking home, officials said.

Later in the day, the forest department rescued two lions that likely belong to the same pride and efforts were on to rescue two cubs as well. "Scat analysis of the

rescued lions will be done to confirm if they killed the man," the official said. The department has issued orders to increase the number of trackers in the region and to intensify round-the-clock monitoring and patrolling there.

Chandra's body was found in Kovaya village. A forest department official said Chandra had been working at a restaurant in Rajula. A case of accidental death was registered at the Pipavav Marine police station. Inspector V K Rathod said, "There is CCTV footage (of the incident) from a distance."

@ieExplained

#ExpressExplained

If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

TECH

Telegram ban: Why the app is under scanner for paper leaks

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, June 16

THE MINISTRY of Electronics and IT has blocked the popular messaging platform Telegram in India until June 22 at the request of the National Testing Agency (NTA), responsible for conducting the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET).

It follows the cancellation and rescheduling of the undergraduate medical entrance exam earlier this year due to widespread allegations of paper leaks and irregularities. The platform is believed to have been used to circulate leaked questions and communicate with students, middlemen and others. The NEET is now scheduled for June 21.

Law behind block

The blocking order has been issued under Section 69(A) of the Information Technology Act, 2000. It empowers the government to issue directions for blocking public access to digital information.

For such orders to be issued, the Central government must be satisfied that it is necessary or expedient to do so, “in the interest of sovereignty and integrity of India, defence of India, security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States or public order or for preventing incitement to the commission of any cognizable offence relating to above...”

APP’S ORIGINS

- Pavel Durov founded Telegram along with his elder brother, Nikolai, in 2013, positioning it as focused on privacy.
- It allowed large groups and synced with multiple devices — its edge over WhatsApp.

Telegram’s USP

Pavel Durov founded Telegram along with his elder brother, Nikolai, in 2013, positioning the app as being particularly focused on user privacy. It allowed large groups with up to 2,00,000 members, and synced with multiple devices — features that gave it an edge over the likes of WhatsApp. In 2025, Russian-origin Durov said the app had over a billion active users worldwide. Telegram is among the most popular personal messaging apps in India with over 150 million users, behind only Meta’s WhatsApp.

The high degree of privacy has also led to scams, the dissemination of child pornography and other illegal activities. In 2024, France arrested Durov over moderation concerns. Telegram rejected the claims, saying: “We have to process legitimate requests to take down illegal public content (e.g., sticker sets, bots, and channels) within the app.”

However, it has linked restrictions to freedom of speech, stating that “this does not apply to local restrictions on freedom of speech,” clarifying that “if criticizing the government is illegal in some country, Telegram won’t be a part of such politically motivated censorship”.

The Indian government has also issued a direction to Telegram to disable its message-editing feature for messages already posted until June 30. According to the NTA, the feature permits a channel administrator to edit the content of a previously posted message — including the substitution of attached files such as PDFs — while the original send-time stamp is retained.

Rationale behind ban

In a statement, the NTA said that over the last few weeks, Telegram channels operating openly on the platform demanded sums ranging from a few thousand to several lakhs of rupees from candidates in exchange for purported access to the re-examination paper.

Durov posted on X that the order “punishes 150M+ ordinary Telegram users in India — not the insiders who leaked the exam materials. And the ban hasn’t stopped anything. The leaks just moved to other apps.”

On Monday, Ahmedabad police arrested two Rajasthan men for allegedly running a racket that defrauded medical aspirants and their parents via Telegram by claiming to have the NEET (UG) re-examination question paper and offering to sell it. Police said the duo did not possess any leaked documents.

HISTORY

How a Mohenjo-daro figurine became a ‘dancer’ — and a challenge to ‘modesty’

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, June 16

A CLASS 9 textbook shaded over the bare torso of the iconic “Dancing Girl” of Mohenjo-daro before the NCERT (National Council of Educational Research and Training) decided to restore its original image.

This was not the first time an attempt had been made to cover up the Harappan-era bronze figurine. In 2023, a fully clothed version of the “Dancing Girl” was unveiled as the mascot of the International Museum Expo.

The story of “vulgarity” being attached to the statue, however, dates back several decades. It is largely associated with archaeologist John Marshall choosing to interpret it as the image of a “nautch girl” or “dancing girl” without compelling evidence.

Competing claims

The government of Pakistan also had similar reservations when it was trying to acquire Harappan artefacts from India in the 1950s, arguing that Mohenjo-daro and

Harappa were both in Pakistan. India, however, contended that the legacy of the Harappan civilisation belonged to South Asia and not Pakistan alone.

An academic paper by Panjab University historian Ashish Kumar, *Sahib’s Nautch Girl*, brings out interesting details. Around 12,000 Harappan objects from Mohenjo-daro were in Delhi when Partition took place. These had been brought to the capital from the Lahore Museum by Mortimer Wheeler, who was Director General of the Archeological Survey of India between 1944 and 1948, for an exhibition.

“Owing to partition, almost all of the Harappan sites including Mohenjodaro and Harappa went to Pakistan leaving with India only two minor sites (Rangpur in Gujarat and Kotla Nihang Khan in East Punjab) of the first urban civilization of the Indian subcontinent,” Kumar writes. “Since the Harappan artifacts had been found in the territory of Pakistan at Mohenjodaro, the Pakistani officials demanded all these artifacts back from India. But the Indian officials refused to en-

POLICY

‘Like real life, kids need rules for social media use’

EXPERT EXPLAINS

Ravi Iyer

MANAGING DIRECTOR, UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA'S MARSHALL NEELY CENTER

SIX MONTHS after Australia banned social media for those under 16, the UK became the latest country to tighten online safety for children. UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer has announced that under-16s would be banned from social media by spring 2027. **Uma Vishnu** spoke to **Ravi Iyer**, a social psychologist who has earlier worked at Meta (then Facebook), where he led data science, research and product teams. He collaborated closely with Jonathan Haidt to develop the government policy and collective action sections of the latter’s *The Anxious Generation* (2024).

What is the best approach: a blanket ban, tobacco-style warning labels or design changes on platforms?

I often refer to it as an age limit, not a ban. In Australia, for example, if you want to use YouTube, you still can; just that you can’t create an account (if you are under 16). And if you can’t create an account, you won’t get notifications late at night, you won’t get as personalised an experience, you won’t get messages from strangers, you can’t post your own images and see how people react. You can still access the content. If there’s an educational video you want to watch, you can still watch it. You can also send it to your friends. So children are not being prevented from reading or watching whatever they want. It’s a limit on the contractual relationship you had formed with a company that targeted you in ways that may be inappropriate.

The warning-label idea is difficult because you are relying on teenagers, who don’t always have a lot of self-control, to heed the warning. I do think design changes have a lot of promise. Take privacy settings. When you join a service, should you automatically be recommended to other people as a friend? In India, you have locked profiles, which give people a way to be safer and more private. Maybe that should be the de-

● PATCHWORK OF STATE PROPOSALS, CENTRE WEIGHS ACTION

- CENTRE**
- The Indian Express reported this March that the government was not in favour of an outright ban, and was instead considering a more nuanced and graded approach in specifying restrictions for children under 18 years.
 - Government sources said that there will be distinct sets of restrictions for those in the 8-12 years age bracket, for 12 to 16-year-olds, and for those aged 16-18 years.
- ANDHRA PRADESH**
- Chief Minister N Chandrababu said in March 2026 that his government would roll out a programme to prevent children under 13 from accessing social media within 90 days.
 - The state, Naidu said, was also considering regulating access to social media for those in the 13-16 age group.
- KARNATAKA**
- In March 2026, Karnataka announced a proposal to ban social media use for children under 16 in its 2026-27 Budget, becoming the first Indian state to do so.



- A separate draft policy for ‘Responsible Digital Use Among Students’ includes suggestions such as capping screen time to one hour, cutting off internet access after 7 pm and implementing Aadhaar-enabled sign-ups.
- GOA**
- Goa is also weighing a social media ban for children under the age of 16, according to reports in January 2026.

fault for children everywhere, rather than something they have to turn on themselves.

Design changes are great, but I also think we should have age limits for children because companies have not made these changes on their own. They have historically done whatever is possible to get as many people, including children, to use these products as much as possible.

How is Australia’s policy working?

One survey noted that 70% of children in Australia are still on social media, but that means that 30% are now off. Many of them are using these platforms without an account. Platforms like Snapchat, where accounts are more essential, have dropped usage more than platforms like YouTube, where the experience of viewing content is largely the same without an account.

We may not get today’s 15-year-olds off these platforms, but norms are changing such that children who are 12 today will feel less pressure to be on these platforms when they are 15. We have speed limits that people don’t always obey, but they still serve a purpose. We have drinking ages that some teenagers circumvent, but they still serve a purpose. In the offline world, my children can’t simply pretend to be 25. They’re consistently treated as children. Digital services should work the same way.

Parents often have this guilt that they

How they keep you hooked

- Ephemeral content that says ‘if you don’t see this now, it will go away’.
- AI-powered systems that predict the notification that will get you to come back.
- Infinite scroll and autoplay that reduce your ability to exercise your willpower.

aren’t doing enough to keep their kids off the phone.

Everyone has a role to play in this. A lot of what companies do is rely on ‘network effects’. No child wants to be the one who is not on Snapchat if all the other children are on Snapchat. And no parent wants to be the one who stops their child from being on these products when every other kid is on it. So there is a real collective action problem. We need to make parents’ jobs a lot easier.

Many tech companies would say high engagement simply means users are finding value in their products.

If that were true, companies would not have to use every trick in the book to increase the usage of their products. You can ask any group of adults or kids if they want to be using their phone as much as they are. Most people will say they want to use their phones less. Kids are still developing self-control. I don’t let my kids order whenever they want to from a restaurant for a reason. Similarly, we shouldn’t expect kids to have the same self-control online and we shouldn’t let companies target them in the same way.

What is it about social media design that makes these platforms addictive?

The companies are making these things more tempting, more powerful, more novel through algorithms that are constantly trying to figure out what they can show you.

HEALTH

You always needed cough syrup prescription: What’s changed & why

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, June 16

THE UNION government has removed cough syrups from the list of medicines that receive certain exemptions in manufacturing and sale, such as availability in general stores in smaller villages. This comes after a spate of recent incidents where children have died after consuming contaminated syrups.

The Union Health Ministry, in a gazette notification, removed the word “syrup” from Schedule K of the Drug Rules.

Does this mean you need a prescription?

Even before this notification, a doctor’s prescription was required for almost all cough syrup formulations. The removal from Schedule K removes just one exemption that allowed general stores in smaller villages with a population of less than 1,000 to sell these syrups.

In other areas, cough syrups can only be sold at licensed medical stores with a pharmacist on site.

Why was the step taken?

It comes after several incidents of children dying because of contaminants in cough syrups. The oversight measure was first discussed in a meeting of the apex drug regulator’s Drug Consultative Committee (DCC) last November, after the deaths of at least 22 children in Madhya Pradesh’s Chhindwara.

The step, however, has been described as “too little, too late” by experts in drug regulation. “This exemption was meant only for cough syrups that do not contain any Schedule H or X drugs (which are to be sold on the prescription of a Registered Medical Practitioner only). But almost all cough syrups contain at least one component that is regulated. This meant that they should not have been sold without a prescription anyway, but, in practice, they are widely available over the counter,” said a former drug regulator, on condition of anonymity.

They added: “The only cough syrups that do not contain any of the regulated substances are herbal remedies, and they are not governed by these norms... despite

Speak to a doctor first

- Every cough needs to be treated differently and you do not need to take a cough syrup for most, says Dr Suranjit Chatterjee, senior consultant, Internal Medicine, Indraprastha Apollo hospital.
- People experiencing a dry, hacking cough can use a cough suppressant.
- However, no cough syrup should be used for a cough with phlegm, as it can dry out the phlegm in the lungs, says Dr Chatterjee.

some of them using propylene glycol (PEG), which is usually the source of the contaminant.”

Contamination with diethylene glycol and ethylene glycol usually happens in syrups when non-pharmaceutical grade PEG is used as a solvent in its manufacturing, without appropriate testing.

How can regulation happen?

Experts say certain measures are likely to better prevent contamination.

One, as discussed in the meeting, is using solvents that carry a lower risk of contamination. Two, while PEG is needed as a solvent for syrups, companies can manufacture suspensions of the same drug (which contain insoluble particles) without using it. An industry expert said, “Syrups are just sweeter and better tasting, suspensions can be equally efficacious and stable.”

Three, as the industry discussed with the drug regulator in the aftermath of the deaths in MP and other global cases linked to India-made syrups, was to ensure smaller packs of PEG are available.

The industry expert said, “PEG is

usually sold in big barrels, which is good for the big companies. But cough syrups are manufactured in very small units as well. They do not buy PEG by the barrel, they instead procure it from the open market. Their containers do not carry the company seal, and there is no way to track where the contamination enters in the supply chain.” At times, suppliers could sell cheaper, industrial-grade PEG as pharmaceutical-grade.

What precautions should you take?

Experts advise that people should only buy cough syrups from established brands to reduce the chances of contamination.

Every cough needs to be treated differently, and patients do not need to take cough syrups for most of them. Dr Suranjit Chatterjee, senior consultant for internal medicine at Indraprastha Apollo Hospital in Delhi, says, “In most cases, people are likely to get better on their own without a cough syrup, and, in some cases, taking a cough syrup when the cough lasts for long can lead to misdiagnosis of the underlying condition.”



The bronze figurine was discovered in 1926

ertain this demand and put forth an equal claim over the Harappan civilization.”

Finally, India and Pakistan agreed to a

50:50 division of the Harappan artifacts “found at Mohenjodaro and Chanhudaro with the help of Mortimer Wheeler”.

While Pakistan wanted both the ‘Dancing Girl’ and the ‘Priest King’, India was willing to hand over just one of the two.

“The Pakistani officials chose the priest king to avoid any backlash at home that a figure of a naked teenager could have invoked from religious quarters,” Kumar writes. “Here the ‘nudity’ of a teenager girl impacted the decision of the Pakistani officials, who considered its sexuality as a threat to their moral beliefs.”

However, the clamour to acquire the ‘Dancing Girl’ statue continued in Pakistan till recently too. In 2016, a writ petition in the Lahore High Court sought directions to the Pakistan government “to bring back the famous ‘Dancing Girl’ bronze statue from India”, Kumar states.

“Since this bronze girl statue had been discovered from Mohenjo-daro in 1926, Pakistan was held to be the real owner of this five thousand years old Harappan artifact,” the

paper says. “In response to this Pakistani claim, Vasant Shinde (then Vice-chancellor of Deccan College, Pune) questioned Pakistan’s exclusive claim over the Harappan civilization... since this civilization was considered a common heritage of South Asia.”

‘Nautch girl’

Significantly, even the identification of the statue as that of a dancing girl by John Marshall is contested. Marshall wrote about the statue: “The only other sculpture in the round from Mohenjo-daro that claims notice here is the bronze dancing-girl... This is a small figurine of rather rough workmanship with disproportionately long arms and legs. Almost, indeed, it is a caricature, but, like a good caricature, it gives a vivid impression of the young aboriginal nautch girl, her hand on hip in half-impudent posture, and legs slightly forward, as she beats time to the music with her feet.”

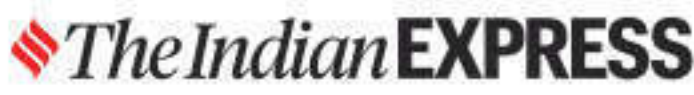
He added: “Small, too, as this figurine is, the modeling of the back, hips, and buttocks is quite effective, and in spite of ob-

vious defects shows sound observation on the part of the artist.”

However, Gregory L. Possehl, in his book *The Indus Civilisation*, expressed doubt whether the statue represents a female dancer. Historian Upinder Singh also said in *A History of Ancient and Early Medieval India*: “The dancing girl may not have been dancing at all, and even if she was, she may not represent a professional dancer.”

Ashish Kumar also says that there is no evidence to suggest that she was a dancer. The fact that colonial officials, who stayed in India alone, would often find comfort in the company of nautch girls, may have led to the instant association, he says. Marshall also associated the bronze statue with the devdasi tradition, thus suggesting continuity from Harappan times to recent times.

Significantly, while many nude terracotta representations of the female body were found from Harappan sites, these were identified as a marker of the Mother Goddess cult, while the bronze statue was identified as a “nautch girl”.



~ FOUNDED BY ~

RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Indian cities need to rethink water future

THE HEAT wave in several parts of the country has been aggravated by severe water shortage, driven by a groundwater crisis and falling reservoir levels. The emergency has shone a light on the challenges faced by cities, including metros such as Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru, and Chennai. The conventional explanation points to weather vagaries. Rising temperatures increase evaporation losses. However, climate change alone cannot explain why large parts of the country are parched. NITI Aayog's Composite Water Management Index (CWMI) had warned of a dire situation in 2018. While the timelines estimated in the report may not have been accurate, the CWMI's warning — Indian cities are living beyond their hydrological means — should have prompted a course correction. Since then, several other studies, including the Jal Shakti Ministry's latest Dynamic Groundwater Resources Assessment, have flagged the oversaturation of aquifers. The problem, however, is that municipal and state-level authorities treat every crisis as an isolated event and very little has been done to address the structural reasons for water shortfall during the dry season.

Urban India's inefficiency in water use stems from dilapidated distribution networks, inadequate metering, and poor municipal governance. Not treating wastewater and underharvesting of rainwater prevent the optimum use of scarce resources. In 2016, the Mihir Shah Committee had pointed out that “the focus of water policy in independent India had been on augmenting supplies with little attention being paid to the demand-side management of water”. This policy direction did play a major role in meeting food-security imperatives, but as the Shah Committee pointed out, there has been little emphasis on institutional innovations in the water sector. Since then, programmes such as the Atal Bhujal Yojana have taken early steps to encourage efficient use of water in agriculture. However, demand-side management also requires scientific analyses of water use at the household and industrial level, especially to prevent overexploitation by the well-heeled.

In recent years, a few cities have begun to supplement grey infrastructure — drains and pipes — with nature-based solutions. Lake restoration projects, such as those in Mumbai and Bengaluru, are welcome endeavours. However, these need to be taken up at scale to have a meaningful impact. The country still lacks a concerted policy like China's Sponge City project that uses urban landscapes and green infrastructure, such as permeable pavements, to promote natural retention of rainwater. The recent crisis should occasion conversations on such methods — cities that get flooded during monsoons shouldn't be parched in summers.

Punjab can ill afford a religious flashpoint

THE AKAL TAKHT, the highest temporal seat of the Sikhs, added a new dimension to Punjab politics on Monday by declaring Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann a “Guru *dokhi*” (anti-Guru) and “Khalsa Panth *virodhi*” (opposed to the Khalsa Panth) over an alleged sacrilege video. It directed “Nanak Naam Leva Sikhs” to refrain from socialising with him. The controversy centres on a video that surfaced earlier this year, which Mann had claimed was fabricated. However, Acting Akal Takht Jathedar Kuldeep Singh Gargaj said that forensic examinations found no evidence of tampering. Mann has rejected the finding and insisted that he is not the person seen in the video. The Punjab CM has accused Shiromani Akali Dal leader Sukhbir Singh Badal of orchestrating a campaign to malign him.

Religious edicts have often intersected with politics in Punjab. In 2024, Badal himself was declared a “*tankhaiya*” (religious sinner) after a highly publicised proceeding before the Akal Takht. Yet, the timing of the latest directive is significant. It comes days after AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal projected Mann as the party's CM face for the next Assembly elections. Sacrilege has assumed political overtones in recent times — the emotionally charged issue contributed to the Akali Dal's defeat in 2017 and its subsequent decline. The debate has intensified after the enactment of the Jagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar (Amendment) Act, 2026, which expands the definition of sacrilege and prescribes stringent penalties. At the same time, AAP has renewed its criticism of the Akali Dal's handling of the 2015 sacrilege cases and the police firing on protesters that resulted in two deaths.

While Mann's supporters may dismiss it, the directive provides his opponents, especially the Akali Dal, with fresh political ammunition against the government. Attention is now focussed on how the CM will respond. Will he appear before the Akal Takht, particularly after Sikh ministers and legislators were summoned on June 29 over the enactment of the anti-sacrilege law without consultation with Sikh religious institutions? Punjab can ill afford a prolonged political-religious confrontation. The border state faces challenges such as drug abuse, rising gangsterism and economic stress. Governance and development should hold centre stage in Punjab's politics, rather than controversies that deepen divisions.

Cricket's next prodigy needs calming influence

THE TRI-SERIES in Dambulla, Sri Lanka was supposed to be another step in Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's rise. Having earned a place in squads for India's tours of Ireland and England and the Asian Games, the 15-year-old arrived with an opportunity to show that he could bridge the gap between age-group cricket and the next level. Sooryavanshi's 79 runs in three matches aren't very worrying. But his post-match altercation with Sri Lanka A players after India's Super Over defeat on Monday raises questions. Television footage showed the teenager involved in a heated exchange that briefly turned physical.

Opposition teams often try to sledge players touted as future stars. At 16, Sachin Tendulkar encountered intimidation during his first tour of Pakistan. He replied with his bat. Every generation faces its own tests. Showing emotion is not the issue; knowing when to disengage is. For someone expected to play at the highest level, emotional control is as important as shot-making.

The BCCI's decision to allow Sooryavanshi's parents to accompany him on the Ireland and England tour recognises the unique demands on a 15-year-old. But guidance should not stop there. Someone in the touring party, a senior player or coach, needs to sit down with him — not to dampen his competitive spirit, but to help him understand the balance between passion and restraint. The selectors believe Sooryavanshi is ready for international cricket. Now comes the equally important task of preparing him for everything that comes with it.

On US-Iran ceasefire, the mediation question is the wrong one

IT IS not clear how the Iran-US deal will unfold over the next several months. The announced ceasefire and framework are more of a mechanism to postpone resolving deeper divides that still pose risks. Even if it survives, the deal will be at best a sullen ceasefire, not a peace settlement. Ahead of elections, the Donald Trump administration has incentives to avoid appearing bogged down as well as to avoid the risk of inflation and energy shocks. Once that constraint is removed, will Trump accept the strategic reality of the limits of American power? Or will he, and the American system, succumb to temptation to satiate wounded pride?

Israel, so far, has had every motive to undermine a possible agreement. Israel's quest for complete military dominance has not produced either security or lasting control. It is diplomatically isolated. But the war may produce other convulsions in the region: States like Iraq become more likely sites of proxy competition. Iran's effective practice of sovereignty has hugely exposed the vulnerabilities and costs to the Gulf states of letting the US set the terms for the region. But all these states, Iran included, could still see domestic political turmoil that complicates any peace calculus.

In India, there is much hand-wringing over the fact that it was an irrelevant player in this entire conflict. But India's diagnosis of this irrelevance, and what the world needs now, is deeply mistaken. Any mature power should not worry about who gets to mediate. India did not have the leverage, al-

liance relationships, or, frankly, the diplomatic ability to mediate. India and the world should welcome any mediation that achieves a lasting peace. So, credit to Pakistan, Qatar, Oman, whoever gets the world to where it needs to be. Even on India and Pakistan, we have misplaced pride. The sensible response is not to deny mediation, but to judge the mediator by results: If Pakistan moves toward genuine peace, on terms that are acceptable to us, the mediator should be welcomed. This is a tall order. But the formal obsession with denying “mediation” has cost us. In a nutshell, the problem with India's diagnosis of its irrelevance is that it is asking the wrong question.

We need to understand a basic fact about the current global situation. We have been consistently framing every war — Ukraine, Gaza, Iran — as if these were bilateral or limited regional affairs. There is a sense in which, of course, they are not our wars. But collectively, these wars have brought the world to unprecedented risks. None of these are regional conflicts. All of them increase the likelihood of catastrophic global economic or military risk. All of them, in their own way, represent the most massive rolling back of norms that underpin any viable international order, restraints on the use of force, respect for sovereignty, and minimal credibility for international law.

In the case of Israel's war on Gaza, the world comes close to seeing genocide in the 21st cen-



PRATAP BHANU MEHTA

Now that there is a ceasefire, the task for global diplomacy is not just to ensure that the ceasefire holds. It is to ask whether a measure of international order and norms can be restored

tury. But other things are moving the world to greater catastrophic risks: Drones have become an extraordinary technology for self-defence. But unregulated, they might proliferate violence more effectively than states can control them. We have already seen effects in Sudan and Yemen, as they have been used by states that are our closest friends. The Iran war has normalised another precedent: The legitimisation of political assassination as an instrument of statecraft. Even if the ceasefire holds in Iran, we are lowering the barriers against systematic global violence.

Where does India come into this? First of all, we spoke with forked tongues about our own positions. We were not, as they say, multi-aligned as we claimed to be. Iran is a complicated power in its region, often disruptive for states in the region, but also a victim of unrequited US attention and an important pillar of any conceivable regional balance. We politically embraced Israel with unrequited enthusiasm, the US, and later the UAE, and in doing so, put ourselves squarely on the side of political forces that were carpet bombing, literally, the international order. The problem was not these relationships; India has stakes in them. But the sense of being a supplicant in the face of the US, and too cowardly to name any crime in the international order, is palpably visible for the world to see. The problem is that we are seen as incapable of de-

fending any principle whatsoever.

Of course, most powers, especially in the West, are deeply hypocritical. But a mature power does not use others' hypocrisy to condone the kind of international nihilism India has condoned, trying to disguise it behind platitudes about world peace. Now that there is a ceasefire, the task for global diplomacy is not just to ensure that the ceasefire holds. It is to ask whether a measure of international order and norms can be restored. We are in a context where one major power, like the US, is trying to be a revisionist power. The rest of the world has been under the illusion that the way to respond to this is to construct bilateral deals. But the task of mobilising global coalitions that can speak for norms and minimise the possibility of catastrophic risks is a wide open one. India's only diplomatic relevance can be to bat for those norms.

The world needs to use this ceasefire to reassemble support for principles and public goods that make international order possible. The important thing is that this is also in India's long-term self-interest and the only source of its leverage. What India lost in the last couple of years was not its power to mediate; it was the sense that no one had any idea what India stood for. There is much consternation against the moralising of pre-2014 foreign policy. It had its limitations. But now it has been replaced by vacuity, masquerading as realism.

The writer is contributing editor, The Indian Express

The Modi era and the remaking of governance in India



TARANJIT SINGH SANDHU

HISTORY SELDOM moves in a straight line. Every generation confronts its own challenges and must find answers suited to its time. When India gained Independence in 1947, its leadership needed to establish democratic institutions, integrate a vast and diverse population, build an administrative framework, develop scientific capabilities, and chart a path toward economic growth despite severe resource constraints. By 2014, however, the challenge was making existing institutions more responsive, efficient, and capable of delivering meaningful outcomes to a population of 1.4 billion in an interconnected world. In many respects, Prime Minister Narendra Modi's contribution has been to align governance with the aspirations of a rapidly changing India.

Over the past decade, India has witnessed governance initiatives on a scale rarely seen anywhere in the world. More than 56 crore Jan Dhan accounts have been opened. Notably, more than half of these accounts belong to women, expanding economic opportunity and strengthening individual empowerment. Access to sanitation, housing, electricity, healthcare, and clean cooking fuel has expanded significantly.

Under PM Modi's lead, India has evolved from being a major consumer of digital technologies to becoming a global innovator in digital public infrastructure. Aadhaar-enabled services, UPI, CoWIN, and other digital initiatives have demonstrated how technology can be leveraged for inclusion, transparency, and empowerment. Investments in roads, railways, airports, ports, logistics corridors, and digital connectivity have expanded at an unprecedented pace. Infrastructure is seen as not just a developmental goal but a strategic foundation for growth, investment, competitiveness, and national integration.

The impact of these changes is perhaps most evident in India's growing international stature, in which PM Modi's leadership has played a significant role. Having had the privilege of representing India in key diplomatic capitals, including Washington, I have witnessed firsthand the shift in how India is perceived around the world. India today is seen as a trusted economic partner, a leader in digital innovation, a voice for the Global South, and an important contributor to conversations on climate action, healthcare, supply-chain resilience, emerging

technologies, and strategic stability. India's successful G20 presidency, its advocacy on behalf of developing nations, and its growing influence in shaping future technologies have strengthened its position.

India has long faced the challenge of cross-border terrorism, and successive governments have had to balance restraint, preparedness, and response. Under PM Modi, there has been a shift towards a more assertive approach that combines defence preparedness, stronger border infrastructure, intelligence-led operations, diplomatic mobilisation, and a clear message that terrorism and dialogue cannot proceed together. The 2016 Surgical Strikes across the LoC after the Uri terror attack marked an important moment in India's security policy. India demonstrated its willingness to undertake calibrated counter-terror operations against launchpads across the border. The 2019 Balakot air strike after the Pulwama attack reinforced this message, signalling that India's response to terrorism would not be limited by older assumptions or geographical constraints. Operation Sindoor reflected India's continued resolve against terrorism and its capacity to respond decisively when national security is challenged. I had the privilege of being part of the parliamentary delegation that engaged policymakers, lawmakers, strategic experts, and opinion leaders across the Americas in the aftermath of the attack. What stood out was the growing understanding of India's position that terrorism cannot be justified, compartmentalised, or treated as an instrument of state policy.

As PM Modi crosses a historic milestone, the significance lies not merely in the length of his tenure but in the scale of transformation he has sought to achieve. The vision of Viksit Bharat 2047 reflects an ambition that extends beyond economic growth alone. It embodies the aspiration to build a developed, inclusive, innovative, globally influential India by the centenary of Independence. In a vibrant democracy, history will continue to debate policies and outcomes, and rightly so. Yet one conclusion is already difficult to ignore: The Modi era has expanded the scale and scope of governance. It has sought to make the state more responsive, technology more accessible, development more inclusive, and India more confident in its place in the world.

The writer is Lieutenant Governor of Delhi and a former diplomat

Dear NEET aspirant, you weren't the one who failed



NANDITESH NILAY

THIS SUNDAY, on June 21, lakhs of our children will once again troop into the exam halls and retake the NEET for absolutely no fault of theirs. Before a single question paper is opened, there is something that needs to be said plainly: We, the adults — teachers, parents, and the institutions meant to protect them, let them down. On this retest, we owe them not just a ban on the Telegram app, but also an honest reckoning.

Accountability isn't a word reserved for editorials or press conferences. It must be lived, and distributed honestly across everyone who failed these students. Paper-setters and middlemen who sold integrity for money bear the gravest guilt. The testing authorities allowed cracks in the system through which unscrupulous elements sneaked in. But let us not pretend the rot stopped there.

The truth that few of us will admit to is this. It was some of us, parents, who were willing customers of this corruption, paying for shortcuts we told ourselves our children deserved, who made this happen. Surely, we told ourselves, we can cut a tiny corner; after all, the rich and the powerful do it all the time. Some teachers, some translators, who must have spent most of their working lives in classrooms teaching students what's the right thing to do, normalised the idea that the exam could be gamed rather than earned. When the people meant to model integrity instead model its absence, what will our children learn?

The students will take the retest carrying the knowledge that some of their peers' parents conspired with the very people meant to evaluate them fairly. They will always carry the question through their life: If the system was bent once, can I really trust it this time? That is not a question a 17-year-old should have to ask.

So what can we offer, beyond an apology? We can tell them: Your effort was never the broken part. The diligence with which you studied through the night, made a timetable, took and retook sample tests — none of that needs to be redone in shame. What needs repair is not you, it is us. We, the parents, must separate love for a child from ambition for her rank, and understand that a doctor's white coat means nothing if the person inside it never learned, early on, that some things cannot be bought.

It is teachers who must remember that the most important lesson is not a chapter from the syllabus, but the example of one's own integrity, day after day. To every student preparing for June 21, especially those who did everything right and are paying the price for what others did wrong, please know this: Your anger is valid, your exhaustion is valid, and your hope, however battered, is not naive. It is, in fact, the only thing standing between a generation and despair. Walk in not because the system has earned back your trust, but because you have already proved, through everything you endured, that you are exactly the kind of person this country needs more of: Someone who keeps showing up, with integrity, even when the adults compromised themselves.

We cannot promise you a perfect system on June 21. But we can promise there are many of us who see what was done to you, who are ashamed of it, and who will not stop asking the question James Madison asked centuries ago: Who will guard the guardians? Go in, do your best, and come out knowing that whatever the result, you were never the one who failed.

Nilay is the author of Being Good, Aiye, Insaan Banen and Ethikos. He teaches and trains courses on ethics, values and behaviour

40 YEARS AGO

June 17, 1986



Wrangling over Chandigarh

THE CENTRE has asked Punjab Chief Minister Surjit Singh Barnala to send his proposals about the areas to be given to Haryana in lieu of Chandigarh to enable the Centre to complete formalities for the transfer of territories on June 21. The decision to give the CM another opportunity to respond to the Venkataramiah Commission report was taken after a high-level meeting presided over by Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi.

Left sweeps Bengal civic polls

THE CPI(M)-led ruling Left Front made a clean sweep in Sunday's municipal polls in West Bengal when it captured 56 out of 75 municipal bodies, the results of which were officially known. The West Bengal Local Government and Urban Development Minister, Prasanta Sur, said while the Congress-I, won in six municipal bodies, two went to

Sri Lanka sends new proposals

SRI LANKA sent "confidential" proposals on the ethnic issue to India as President J R Jayewardene vowed to seek a political-cum-military solution to the terrorist problem. The proposals reached New Delhi amidst reports that a major flare-up in the North was in the offing again and troops had launched an operation in a northern area. The Sri Lankan government was of the view that its latest proposals should result in a breakthrough in the current stalemate.



READ. THINK. SHARE.
Scan the QR code to explore curated editorials and opinions from leading voices

● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
Israel's attempt to torpedo the agreement between the United States and Iran didn't work out well.
—Haaretz, Israel



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

NARENDRA MODI'S participation in the G7 summit at Évian this week marks India's 13th appearance at the forum and the Prime Minister's seventh in a row since 2019. Fittingly, India's engagement with the grouping began at Évian itself, when Atal Bihari Vajpayee was invited in 2003, and continued with Manmohan Singh between 2005 and 2009.

That India is a regular invitee reflects a deepening mutual engagement, rooted in the country's economic transformation since the 1990s and its growing salience in the international system. During the Cold War, India placed most of its economic and political eggs in the Russian basket. The Soviet collapse of 1991, coinciding with the breakdown of India's own economic model, forced a restructuring that profoundly altered Delhi's relationship with the West.

Today, the G7 is the principal destination of Indian exports, absorbing nearly a third of the country's merchandise shipments. Most of India's service exports also go to the G7. It is also the main destination for the outward flow of Indian professionals and students; a more restrictive America since Donald Trump's re-election as president has merely redirected some of those flows to Europe.

Despite the rhetoric about building a new global economic order with Russia and China, India's economic diplomacy in recent years has been less about BRICS than about deepening ties with the developed West through trade liberalisation. India's quest for diversification is now less between the West and BRICS than within the West — it is marked by a new determination to deepen ties with Europe, the UK and Canada in the G7.

India's real challenge today comes from



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

rapid and unexpected change within the West itself. Three trends stand out. The first is the rise of American unilateralism under Trump. Trump's instinct is to pursue the narrow national interest of the US in the name of "America First". As he forces allies to fall in line on key issues, the divisions across the Atlantic have widened.

Contrary to the popular notion of American decline, the US has grown stronger relative to its Western allies over three decades. In the mid-1990s, the European economy was roughly equal in size to America's, and Japan's GDP stood at two-thirds to three-quarters of it. Today, the eurozone is little more than half of US output and Japan barely a seventh. With its GDP at around \$31 trillion and still growing at 2.5 per cent, the US is set to widen its lead over allies and over China — the one power whose relative weight has risen, though Beijing's own troubles have dimmed the prospect of overtaking America.

Where many in Delhi's foreign policy community see an irreconcilable contradiction between the pursuit of strategic autonomy and partnership with the West, China demonstrated the art of transcending it — and against far steeper odds

To be sure, Washington has ceded some ground to Beijing in select frontier areas — advanced manufacturing, electric vehicles, increasingly competitive open-weight AI models. Trump's industrial policy is eager to make amends. But the depth of the American innovation system and its capital markets remains without parallel.

SpaceX's listing on the Nasdaq last week, on extravagant promises of a new space economy, pushed its paper valuation to \$2 trillion despite the absence of past profitability. What it really signals is a new technological revolution — in what China's communists call the "new quality productive forces". French President Emmanuel Macron's decision to seat the tech titans at Évian as near-equals underlines the rise of a new American tech capitalism with far-reaching consequences.

Third, Trump is recasting not only the internal balance of the West but the terms of its engagement with Russia and China. In

pursuit of a grand bargain with Tehran, he has strained the alliance with Israel; in South Asia, he is talking up Pakistan. His fluid new approaches, with no attachment to the past, promise to transform the geopolitics of Europe, the Middle East and the Indo-Pacific.

The task of Indian diplomacy is to manage these changes with patience and calm. The answers are only partly external; most lie at home — in restructuring the economy, modernising the defence industrial base, revitalising the technological ecosystem. Curiously, partnership with the West remains crucial to that effort.

That brings us back to Évian in 2003, where China's president, Hu Jintao, sat alongside Vajpayee — the first time Beijing was drawn into the Western outreach. China's GDP then was about \$1.6 trillion, India's barely \$600 billion. China has since raced to some \$20 trillion in 2025; India still hovers below \$4 trillion. The speed and purpose of internal transformation is what distinguishes China from India. It is not just a question of quantity. The quality of the Chinese economy in terms of its technological advances and scientific sophistication is more than impressive.

China's leaders are no longer invited to the G7, yet they loom large over it: A central question at Évian is how to manage the global imbalances produced by China's export juggernaut. That transformation underlines the twin dialectic China navigated with such aplomb over the last five decades: To rise through deeper ties with the West but also strengthen China's national capability. China today is at once a huge economic partner for the West and its principal strategic challenger.

Where many in Delhi's foreign policy community see an irreconcilable contradiction between the pursuit of strategic autonomy and partnership with the West, China demonstrated the art of transcending it — and against far steeper odds. The Korean War of 1950-53 cost hundreds of thousands of Chinese lives, yet within two decades Mao Zedong was befriending Washington. It is that cold realism that separates China's hard-headed strategy from the perpetually prickly and anxious Indian foreign policy discourse.

The writer is a contributing editor on international affairs for The Indian Express

When the room laughs, cruelty gets a pass



PARTHA SINHA

A JOKE is the only sentence a society signs collectively. The teller proposes it, but the room ratifies it. Timing may sharpen it and delivery may disguise it, but the meaning is settled in the sound that follows. The laugh is the signature at the bottom.

That is why the most revealing part of the "Rs 370 biryani" clip was not the young man's arithmetic of entitlement. At one of Pranit More's crowd-work shows, Himanshu Jangra described buying a woman a chicken biryani and concluding that the transaction entitled him to something more. He then spoke of pushing past her refusal until refusal ceased to matter. This was not really a joke searching for a punchline. It was a confession searching for company. The room provided it.

More called it "Peak Gurgaon content", gave him a cash prize and released the clip, edited and subtitled, to millions. The story passed through the rituals by which the internet launders ugliness into entertainment. First the laugh, then the clip, then the outrage, then the views. By the time disgust arrived, the confession had acquired production value.

Days later, on the same stage, a medical student described how she and her friends compared the genital sizes of male cadavers during dissection. It was offered as a mischievous glimpse into medical-school life. But consider the donor. A person who gives his body to medicine performs one of the purest acts of faith available to a secular civilisation. He gives away his last possession. He gives it to strangers so that they may learn. He asks for nothing because, by then, he can ask for nothing. And even in that final helplessness, he is measured for amusement.

Comedy has always told a flattering story about itself. It likes to imagine the comedian as the licensed fool in the king's court, speaking truths that power cannot bear. We repeat "punching up" as though laughter naturally rises towards authority, when much of it travels in the opposite direction. The woman who said no and the dead man unable to object are easier targets because they do not control the microphone.



The consequences followed the familiar economics of public shame. Jangra lost his job. The medical student was sent on leave. An FIR was registered. Institutions displayed their moral reflexes and social media performed its daily ceremony of astonishment. The comedian kept the audience. And the monetisation.

This is what makes crowdwork so revealing. In older comedy, the performer wrote the dangerous line and carried its risk. Here the audience supplies the material. Ordinary people bring their prejudices and private brutalities to the microphone. The host extracts, edits and packages them.

We have created an entertainment economy in which people incriminate themselves for free and platforms convert the evidence into reach. Now the material is the self. A generation trained to perform its interior life has discovered its ugliest instincts are content. People volunteer what an earlier age might have hidden even from friends, because the applause of strangers has become proof of existence, and cruelty has excellent engagement.

Aditi Mittal called the humiliation of a woman a familiar male bonding ritual. The description is exact. Men have long turned women into the absent centre of male fellowship. Her refusal becomes an anecdote. Her discomfort becomes proof of masculine persistence. Her humiliation is passed around like a bowl at the table. The biryani clip merely gave this old ritual a microphone and subtitles.

Kusha Kapila pointed to the applause. She was right. We prefer to interrogate the teller because the teller can be punished. The room is harder to punish because the room is where we are sitting. It is the audience laughing in the dark. It is the viewer forwarding the clip with a shocked emoji. It is the platform watching outrage and entertainment merge in the analytics. And it is also me, scrolling late at night, appalled by what I am seeing but watching until the end.

Perhaps that is the final obscenity. Not merely that the joke was told, or that the room laughed, but that millions of us arrived afterwards carrying our outrage like a ticket and gave the clip one more view. We do not laugh only at what we find funny. We laugh at what we have already agreed to forgive.

The writer is a senior advisory professional

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Fragile pact

THE US-IRAN agreement, scheduled to be signed on June 19, is expected to pave the way for unimpeded access to the Strait of Hormuz and an immediate halt to military operations ('Iran-US framework pact is a relief. Work lies ahead', *IE*, June 16). The optimism, however, should be tempered with caution. Some of the most contentious issues have merely been put on the back burner. Ultimately, this pact should be viewed as the beginning of a difficult diplomatic journey. Its success will depend on the willingness of all stakeholders to walk the talk.

SS Paul, Nadia

NEW DELHI'S "tightrope" diplomacy has been severely undermined by the US-Iran standoff ('Iran-US framework pact is a relief. Work lies ahead', *IE*, June 16). Confronted with this shifting geopolitical landscape, it is critical to determine whether to continue hedging or embrace a more assertive, mediating role, while insulating vital connectivity projects like Chabahar Port from the crossfire of secondary US sanctions. As chair of the 2026 BRICS summit, convening rivals Iran and the UAE will require back-channel negotiations, offering a unique opportunity for New Delhi to champion Global South dialogue and economic security.

Raghvi Sharma, Sunam

Parochial mindset

IT IS unfortunate that there is a tendency to cover up realities, instead promoting irrationality and a distorted view to balance administrative shortcomings ('Dancing Girl, meet modest imagination', *IE*, June 16). The definition of modesty did not spare an important artefact of history in an age when everything is accessible with a click. The path to creating positive citizens lies in fostering critical thinking and making space for the free exchange of ideas, rather than circumscribing thought within a parochial mindset.

Madhusree Guha, Kolkata



AREFA TEHSIN

THE ARAVALLI is old. Older than the Himalaya, older than our arguments, older than our institutions and those who run them. It has survived glaciations, tectonic upheavals, and centuries of illegal mining. It did not, however, anticipate being improved.

Earlier this month, a leading Rajasthan newspaper ran a Sunday "positive" story about a plan by the forest department to plant saplings on rocky forest land through a technique called "double blasting". The hard, stony ground of the Aravallis — ground that has been hard and stony for approximately 1.5 billion years and is rather settled in its ways — will be blasted — twice — so that the earth becomes crumbly. And then a plant will be put in the resulting crater. The plant, presumably, will grow. Greenery will ensue. Rajasthan's 5,476 sq km of rocky forest will be transformed. The numbers will be issued. The paperwork will be filed with satisfaction.

My father, naturalist Raza H Tehsin, who spent a lifetime in these landscapes, finds this plan remarkable. Not because it is bad science (that it is) but because it so perfectly captures our relationship with nature: We love it so much that we must slash and overpower it first. Double blasting is an engineering technique for breaking extremely hard rock — the kind that illegal miners have long cast long-

And yet, the basics remain this: If you fence a rocky patch, protect it from grazing, woodcutting and illegal mining, the vegetation belonging to that land will return by itself. It always does

ing looks at. You drill deep, you detonate in controlled stages, the rock fractures, the rubble crumbles. And then (here is the masterstroke) you plant something. The disturbed soil, we are told, will hold moisture longer. The roots will spread. Greenery will flourish where earlier there was only stubborn geological permanence.

That stubborn geological permanence is itself alive. Pradip Krishen writes in a recent article about the destruction of biocrusts — those thin, living skins of cyanobacteria, fungi, lichens and mosses that crust over rocky and arid soils. Science has only recently begun to grasp their importance: They fix nitrogen, stabilise soil, retain moisture, hold the whole fragile surface together. In Delhi, Krishen warns, the "restoration" of the Central Ridge is destroying these very crusts in the name of greening. Natural history writer Pranay Lal has written about how Delhi's Forest Department had specified a banned pesticide in its tender to "restore" the Central Ridge — not to heal it, but to theme-park it. There are 1-2 million ants and 7 million earthworms for every human on Earth. And this is not counting the biocrust. That is the kind of help we need to keep the Earth and soil going.

Rajasthan's Forest Department has, it seems, not read either piece.

How (not) to save the Aravalli range

Or, it has responded with a harrumph — it knows what it's doing. The blasting has been pitched as a pilot project covering about 5,000 sq km. If the pilot succeeds, if the saplings survive, if the numbers look good, if the press release lands well, there will be more blasting.

And yet, the basics remain this: If you fence a rocky patch, protect it from grazing, woodcutting and illegal mining, the vegetation belonging to that land will return by itself. It always does. The Aravalli, even in its most degraded patches, carries an ecological memory. Dhok, khair, ber, the tenacious grasses: They come back, given half a chance and a functioning fence. They don't need dynamite. They need us to stop. Blasting a landscape for its own benefit is something only we could think of. The Aravalli is 1.5 billion years old, and the secret of its longevity is not a formula our *dadi* told us about.

What happened to the time India took pride in worshipping nature? Those evening sessions of elders under a banyan tree, rolling the first roti for a bird, a deity associated with every hill and stream and forest? The culture that claimed nature as its god has discovered a new one — pilot projects with good PR. The saplings may or may not survive. The press release will.

Tehsin, former honorary wildlife warden, Udaipur, is the author, most recently, of The Great Indian Safari



DEEPANSHU MOHAN AND ANKUR SINGH

THE ARRIVAL of the world's first trillionaire, Elon Musk, is less a story about individual success and more a signal of how dramatically the relationship between markets, states, and societies has changed. The industrial magnates of previous centuries built wealth around railroads, oil, steel, and manufacturing. Contemporary wealth increasingly emerges from ownership of technological ecosystems, digital platforms, AI, intellectual property, and financial assets, all capable of scaling across borders at an unprecedented pace. Musk's

personal fortune crossing \$1.1 trillion represents the latest milestone in this broader transformation. His wealth is now greater than South Africa's GDP.

In today's world, the top 10 per cent of the world's population has about 75 per cent of the world's wealth, and the bottom 50 per cent has about 2 per cent. The richest 0.001 per cent of the world's population (less than 60,000 people) possess three times as much wealth as the poorest half of the world's population combined. The technological revolution was supposed to bring down entry barriers and increase economic opportunities. Its results have been mixed. The benefits of the digital economy are increasingly going to those who control the underlying infrastructure of the digital economy. The IMF

estimates that the share of labour in total income has fallen by about four percentage points in the last few decades in the advanced economies. Technological change and automation have been blamed for about half of this loss.

The World Inequality Report 2026 projects that about 1 per cent of global GDP flows from poorer countries to richer countries annually through net foreign income

Do societies possess the institutional capacity to ensure that the concentration of wealth does not outpace democratic accountability?

flows and returns on external assets. This is almost three times the total amount of development assistance given worldwide. The problem here is not just that there is high poverty and there is a higher concentration of wealth in the hands of a few. It is also about how gains and constraints are allocated between countries in the global economic system.

Musk's wealth enables him to exercise outsized influence on democratic institutions and practices, via campaign contributions, Super PACs, lobbying, and a supine media establishment. There's already mention of Musk using his economic influence via X (formerly Twitter) to stoke racial hatred in the UK. Billionaires, if contesting, are also about 4,000 times more likely to be elected to political office than the average

person, research indicates. Their influence on political power also fuels populism, across ideological spectrums. Billionaires control about 70 per cent of the world's biggest media companies. The same goes for social media.

The emergence of the first trillionaire should therefore be viewed as a marker of a changing economic era. The question is no longer whether wealth can be created at extraordinary levels. It is whether societies possess the institutional capacity to ensure that the concentration of wealth does not outpace democratic accountability.

Mohan is dean and professor of Economics, O P Jindal Global University. Singh is a research analyst with the Centre for New Economics Studies (CNES) at O P Jindal Global University

The Big Picture

WEDNESDAY, JUNE 17, 2026

13

1 IN 5 SAILORS WORLDWIDE IS INDIAN

LIVES AT SEA

After months of hostilities in West Asia, the Strait of Hormuz is set to finally open. On many of the merchant ships that sail through the busy shipping lane will be Indians, among the world's biggest seafaring workforce. SUNANDA MEHTA on the dangers and thrills of the deep sea

THAT MORNING, Abdur Rahman Mondal thought he would be dead. Swallowed by the deep, dark waters of the Strait of Hormuz, his home in Mirjapur village, in Nadia district of West Bengal, more distant than ever. "All I could think of were the faces of my ageing parents, wife and sisters. I felt I would never be able to see them again," says the 27-year-old. An Able Seaman, Mondal was on board a Palau-flagged oil tanker that was hit by an Iran-fired missile while passing through the Strait of Hormuz on March 1.

Days later, Electro-Technical Officer Vineet Sharma, 28, crossed the same waters, his ship headed for India, fully loaded with oil from an Iranian port. "Luckily for us, it was a peaceful passage through the Strait, but the stress was immense. We had many briefings preparing us for that voyage. We were on constant alert, and could not relax for even a few minutes. Back home, our families waited for our call all day," says Sharma, who is from a village near Nainital, where his father is a postmaster.

With the Strait of Hormuz set to open after months of hostilities in West Asia as part of a long-awaited deal between Iran and the US, traffic will finally resume on one of the world's busiest shipping lanes. On board many of the ships that sail out will be Indians, among the largest contingent of sailors worldwide.

With 3.08 lakh sailors as of 2024, India ranks among the top three global suppliers of maritime personnel, alongside the Philippines and China, holding approximately 17% of global crew share. Today, nearly one in five seafarers worldwide is Indian.

During the recent war, 13 India-flagged vessels, with close to 550 Indian sailors aboard, were stuck in the Strait of Hormuz for more than 100 days. Across the broader Gulf region, more than 18,000 Indian seafarers were caught in the uncertainty.

For long, the Merchant Navy was seen as a well-paid, even glamorous, career. The loneliness, the psychological weight of being at sea for months, the isolation, these stayed aboard. So did the risks. Storms, accidents, piracy — and now, in the night waters of the Persian Gulf, the dread of a loitering munition dropping onto a loaded oil tanker and a full crew.

Yet, across India's cities and small towns, thousands continue to sign up for a career in the Merchant Navy.

Preparing for the sea

The Samundra Institute of Maritime Studies (SIMS) in Lonavala, one of India's premier maritime academies, sits in serenity, with sculpted lawns and enormous trees that canopy a glass-fronted main building. Walk far enough and the real purpose announces itself: a full-scale replica of a ship's aft, or the rear section, rises from the green — all steel and impressive.

This is the beating heart of the institute

that prepares 390 cadets for a world considerably more challenging than the brochure suggests.

The institute offers four programmes: a one-year DNS (Deck Navigation Science), a one-year GME (Graduate Marine Engineering), a BTech in Marine Engineering, and an ETO (Electro-Technical Officer) course. The postgraduate courses, particularly GME, which requires a mechanical engineering background, have seen a sharp drop in demand, but undergraduate programmes tell a very encouraging story, says SIMS Vice-Principal Captain Subhendu Hati.

"Two years ago, the unified IMU-CET entrance test conducted by the Indian Maritime University drew 39,000 applicants. Last year, there were 55,000 and this year, 72,000. Most of our cadets come from tier-2 cities, small towns and even rural areas," says Hati.

The Lonavala-Karjat belt is home to some of the country's best maritime institutes — besides SIMS, Anglo-Eastern, Great Eastern and Tolani. Most of these institutes are run by shipping companies that eventually employ the cadets on their ships. SIMS, for instance, is run by Executive Ship Management. "Our cadets have guaranteed placements on our own ships. In fact our intake usually depends on our requirements," says Hati.

On the SIMS campus, amid the rigorous daily routine of academics and practical training from 5.30 am to 10.30 pm, the dangers of war and the recent casualties have quietly crept into daily conversations.

"The war comes up constantly. Our faculty share their experiences, it becomes part of the preparation. But none of it has made us regret our decision," says Oren Pacheco, a 20-year-old cadet from Goa.

For Pacheco, the sea is an inheritance — his family on both sides worked on ships, mainly in the galley or kitchen. At 11, standing on a bridge at Marmagao Port in Goa, where his father's ship had docked for some days, he had decided he would do the same. Now studying for his Diploma in Nautical Sciences at SIMS, Pacheco discusses drone strikes and stranded tankers the way his father's generation discussed monsoons.

Jeeva Bharati, 23, from Chennai, graduates in two months. The first in his family to go to sea, he turned down desk jobs for a maritime career. Asked about sailing through active conflict zones, he says with pragmatism, "Tankers pay more... The war is a hurdle. We'll overcome it soon."

Of the 390 cadets at SIMS, 19 are women. They come here, raring to prove something beyond seamanship. Kheta Patel, 19, from Gujarat, says she was in Class 8, when she decided she wanted a life in uniform, a call that meant standing up to her parents. When she couldn't get into the National Defence Academy, she walked into the Merchant Navy. "Working with machines is challenging, but girls can do it too. It is possible."

This is what Kheta's teacher Captain



ARUL HORIZON



(Clockwise from above) Fourth Engineer Shubham Vaid on his vessel while crossing the Strait of Hormuz in May; cadets training in the engine room of a ship on the campus of Samundra Institute of Maritime Studies in Lonavala near Pune; cargo and commercial ships anchored in the Strait of Hormuz; of the 390 cadets at SIMS, 19 are women

Rajwinder Kaur, who retired as a Master, told herself when she joined the Shipping Corporation of India (SCI) in 2005.

Recalling her days aboard, she says she had to constantly prove her capability to her male counterparts, especially when it came to physical work like picking up the ropes, tying the ship or working long hours at the port. Dealing with isolation was tough, too. Before Internet connectivity reached ships, communication meant expensive satellite calls from the ship. Between those calls, her parents waited and worried, she says, adding that her male colleagues rarely carried that same emotional weight.

Ex-Chief Engineer Makrand Date, who teaches engineering subjects at SIMS, believes today's cadets are better prepared than his generation. "What I prepare them for is the mental and physical toughness this career demands," says Date, who survived a pirate attack during his sailing days. Merchant shipping, he adds, isn't usually a wartime target. "A merchant vessel operates like a Red Cross convoy — it carries no allegiance. That confidence is something I pass on to my cadets," he says.

Recalling his encounter with danger in 1999, Date says, "While serving as a Fourth Engineer, my ship experienced what the industry calls an 'armed robbery' — distinct from hijacking, but no less alarming. It happened in Brazil, while the vessel was at the port. The attackers — local seafarers, disguised and carrying guns and knives — boarded during a watch changeover around midnight, took money and valuables from the Captain and fled. Even now,

more than two decades later, I remember the sequence of events that night."

Chirag Bahri calls his experience "life-changing". In April 2010, as a 28-year-old marine engineer, Bahri boarded the chemical tanker *MV Marida Marguerite*, bound for Belgium from Kandla, Gujarat. On May 8, 2010, as the ship crossed the Gulf of Aden, pirates boarded the vessel. Bahri, working in the engine room, was called to the bridge of the ship, where he found an AK-47 pointed at his forehead. For the next eight months, the crew were held hostage and tortured. In December 2010, the company paid \$5.5 million and Bahri returned to Delhi on January 7, 2011. Despite the trauma, he briefly returned to the sea, before dedicating himself to the International Seafarers Welfare and Assistance Network.

At sea, the weather can be treacherous. Speaking on condition of anonymity, a Master Mariner recalls that while loading in Greenland, they received a message that the ice was closing, which would have meant the ship remaining stuck on the shore for months. They swiftly sailed out only to hit an iceberg a few miles away. "As water started to pour inside, the entire crew was on deck trying to stop that. The nearest port was a day away. We managed to reach there, but every one aged 10 years that one day," he says.

Navigating war zones

As they factor in newer challenges, academies nationwide are rewriting their curricula, with safety training now covering how to navigate active war zones.

At the 116-year-old TS Rehman, a mari-

time institute at Nhava near Mumbai, where close to 700 officers and Ratings (non-officers or hands-on operational, technical crew) train round the year, the routine has quietly shifted: for three months now, Saturday lectures have moved to war discussions.

"We discuss case studies from the war zone that shipping companies send us, update cadets on armed guards and their roles, how to mitigate risks, and on their insurance and medical cover. There's a psychologist on campus, and many of us on the faculty share our own experiences," says Captain Ashutosh Apankar, the principal.

Institutes also rely on simulation to prepare seafarers for drone and missile attacks. One scenario, for instance, simulates a Shahed-136 loitering munition attack at 2 am, giving the candidate 90 seconds to communicate the emergency, manage crew panic, and decide on evasive action, while biometrics track heart rate, eye movement, decision latency, and voice stress.

Companies are responding too. Maersk and others have introduced dedicated apps and WhatsApp groups to keep families updated when vessels enter affected areas or crew communications are paused for operational security.

The future of the ocean

While the demand for seafarers is rising, with India driving much of that growth, recruitment isn't keeping pace, says Captain Sanjay Parashar, former Master Mariner and CEO, VR Maritime Services Pvt. Ltd., which today manages crew for over 200 ships.

India has nearly 12,000 active captains against a demand of 25,000–40,000.

"The Merchant Navy offers extraordinary pay but demands physical presence, extended separation, and hardship far from land — things this generation is increasingly reluctant to give. Those still joining come either because they are passionate or are from smaller towns, where seafaring salaries still outweigh the pull of city life," says Parashar, who was also a member of the National Shipping Board.

Cadets start at salaries of around Rs 40,000 a month, junior engineers get around Rs 1 lakh. Within a decade, a senior officer earns Rs 10-15 lakh a month; at career peak, a Master or Chief Engineer commands Rs 10-20 lakh a month. Industry experts say LNG carriers, chemical tankers, and gas carriers pay the highest salaries.

The geography of Indian seafaring is equally revealing. Parashar says 90% of Ratings come from villages in Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and coastal pockets near Rameshwaram in Tamil Nadu. "In households earning \$100 a month, a Rating's \$2,000 salary transforms not just one life but a whole family's standing," he says. Close to 50,000 Indians are employed on cruise or passenger ships annually, with a notable proportion of them women, particularly from Manipur.

As the number of Indian seafarers has increased more than five-fold over the past one-and-a-half decades, from 62,267 in 2010 to 3.07 lakh in 2024, the workforce composition has shifted distinctly towards non-officers, with more Ratings joining ships, according to data maintained by the Directorate General of Shipping.

But the profession hides a deeper, darker shadow. Seafarers desperate for work take contracts on vessels across West Africa and the Gulf, where ownership is deliberately opaque, with ships sailing under the dubious Flags of Convenience. When owners vanish and insurance lapses, Indian cadets are invariably the ones left stranded. India accounts for 18% of global seafarer abandonments or sailors being abandoned by ship owners.

Back in Lonavala, the light is fading over the ship's replica, steel catching the last of the sun. Inside, a drill is underway — alarms, instructions, the rehearsed choreography of calm under pressure.

In a few months, for cadets like Pacheco and Bharati, drills like this one will stop being simulations. The sea has always asked for courage, and now it is asking for some more.

With inputs from Purnima Sah, Mumbai, and Jay Mazoomdar, Delhi



ARUL HORIZON

G7 expresses optimism for peace after Trump’s ‘good’ Zelenskyy meeting



US President Donald Trump with French President Emmanuel Macron, Canadian PM Mark Carney, Italy’s PM Giorgia Meloni, Japan PM Sanae Takaichi, European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen, leaders of Egypt, Qatar, the UAE and German Chancellor Friedrich Merz at the G7 summit in Evian-les-Bains, France, on Tuesday. REUTERS

Ursula: Tide is turning for Kyiv, time to double down on support

Reuters
Evian (France), June 16

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said Russia should make peace with Ukraine after a “very good” meeting with President Volodymyr Zelenskyy on Tuesday, in comments that sparked cautious optimism among G7 leaders that a peace deal could be struck.

The upbeat mood over the Ukraine war, now deep into its fifth year, stands in stark contrast to Zelenskyy’s meeting with Trump at the Oval Office last year, when he was told he had no leverage in potential

peace talks with Russia.

Zelenskyy and his European allies came to this week’s G7 summit in the French lake-side resort of Evian-les-Bains hoping to impress upon Trump that Ukraine’s battle-field fortunes had improved thanks to its drone incursions deep into Russia.

Trump said he would do what he could to end the conflict in Ukraine, but there were few details of any concrete steps to raise the pressure on Moscow.

“Look, Russia should make a deal,” Trump told reporters. “I’m gonna do whatever I can.”

German Chancellor Friedrich Merz said Trump’s statement that Russia should end the war was cause for cheer. “I found him to be very cooperative, and I also saw him listening very attentively,” Merz told reporters. “And in that respect, once again, it gives me a certain degree of optimism that we here, as Euro-

peans and as Americans, are now doing everything we can, together, to end the war.”

After the group meeting with Trump, Zelenskyy told Reuters that G7 leaders agreed that Russia was not winning the war. He said they discussed additional sanctions targeting Russia’s oil exports, its banking sector and its military production to bring Moscow to the negotiating table.

Zelenskyy, who was due to have face-to-face talks with Trump later on Tuesday, said that did not come up in a call between Trump and Putin.

“The tide is turning for Ukraine,” European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen posted on X. “Russia’s fatigue is openly showing. That’s the time to double down on our support.”

INTERIM U.S.-IRAN ACCORD COULD BE SIGNED ON FRIDAY AT BURGENSTOCK RESORT IN SWITZERLAND

Trump: Iran deal to be public soon, it’ll rule out n-weapons for Tehran

Deal allows Tehran to immediately begin selling oil and fuel: US official

Reuters
Evian, (France) Dubai, Jerusalem, June 16

DETAILS BEGAN to emerge on Tuesday of the US and Iran’s interim deal to end the war in West Asia, with President Donald Trump saying it will rule out a nuclear weapon for Tehran and a US official saying it allows Iran to sell oil upon signing.

The interim deal is set to extend a tenuous ceasefire announced in April by another 60 days and reopen the Strait of Hormuz, which Iran has effectively blocked since the US and Israel attacked Iran in February.

The US President said the text of the deal states clearly that Tehran will not have a nuclear weapon, and the full agreement would be made public in a formal setting in a few days. Speaking at the G7 meetings in France, Trump added that he liked the idea of sending the Iran deal to Congress for review, a request by some Republican lawmakers.

A senior US official said the deal allows Iran to immediately begin selling oil and fuel, and included banking, transportation and insurance services to facilitate the sales.

The official added the agreement has conditions. “Iran can only access any benefits of the MoU if they abide by all of the points they agreed to – including no nuclear weapon, neutralizing its enriched material, and not interfering with the free flow of navigation in the Strait.”

Negotiators will address difficult issues like the future of

Iran’s nuclear programme during the next phase of talks, which Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said would start in Switzerland on Friday after the signing of the framework deal.

Two other issues that Trump and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu used to justify the war – ending Iran’s support for regional armed proxies and curbing its missile programme – are not thought to be on the agenda for those negotiations.

“Iran wants to get it done,” Trump told reporters about the next phase of negotiations with Iran. “They have to get back to business, and the relationship is now normalized, so I think it’s going to go pretty quickly.” Earlier he described the deal as “a wall to a nuclear weapon” for Iran. US Vice President JD Vance and Iran’s top negotiator Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf are expected to attend Friday’s formal signing.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian wrote on social media on Monday that the interim agreement was an “important step” toward stopping the fighting, but noted a final deal for a lasting truce “has yet to take shape”. Vance told CNN that the signed memorandum was a “very general document”.

Both sides say the Strait of Hormuz will be open from Friday. On Tuesday, Iranian state television reported operations to lift its maritime blockade, while stressing that vessels must still coordinate with Iran’s Revolutionary Guards.



A man flashes a victory sign as he rides a motorcycle past a banner that reads “Thank You Iran” following a deal between the US and Iran, in the southern suburbs of Beirut, Lebanon, on Tuesday. REUTERS

Hidden naval mines might still stymie Gulf shipping after war

John Ismay & Nicholas Kulish
June 16

THE DEAL to reopen the Strait of Hormuz has raised hopes that “oil will flow on both ends,” as President Donald Trump said Sunday, quickly easing an impending energy crisis.

But it might not be that simple. To restart ship traffic in the strait, one of the most important questions will be whether the Iranians laid naval mines and, if so, how quickly they can be found and neutralized.

It is not even clear that the Iranians laid any mines at all; scores of ships have passed through the strait during the war without hitting mines. In March, United States Central

Command said that it had attacked 16 Iranian mine-laying vessels near the Strait of Hormuz, but the impact of those efforts is uncertain.

On Monday, Trump said that the strait was “already partially opened” and that “they’re doing a little hunting for a couple of mines.” He is also expected to ask European leaders to provide help clearing mines, saying it would not hurt to have “a ship or two up from a few countries.”

Britain said last month that it could deploy mine-hunting drones as part of a multinational mission to secure the Strait. On Monday, President Emmanuel Macron said France was prepared to dispatch mine-clearing vessels if peace deal was confirmed. NYT

A \$300-billion ‘fund’ for Iran

Dubai: A \$300 billion private fund designed to trigger investment into Iran is outlined in the US-Iran framework agreement and more than half that sum has already been committed, a source told Reuters.

The new fund is a private investment vehicle, not a reconstruction or reparations program and will not include any government money or grants, the source said, adding that companies based in the US, the Gulf Arab states, Asia, South America and Africa have agreed to commit financing.

REUTERS

Ebola cases in Congo rise to 837, Africa CDC warns of record spread

Reuters
Nairobi, June 16

THE NUMBER of confirmed Ebola cases in the Democratic Republic of Congo has increased to 837, including 196 deaths, government data showed on Tuesday. The number represented the total number of confirmed cases as of Monday, according to a situation report that documented 29 new cases and four new deaths in the previous 24 hours.

Meanwhile, the head of Africa’s Centres for Disease Control and Prevention warned on Tuesday that the Ebola outbreak in Congo could be the worst ever, saying that it could cost billions of dollars to contain later if critical weaknesses in the response are not addressed quickly.

“If we don’t stop the outbreak very soon it will be worse than what we had in West Africa and eastern DRC,” Africa CDC Director-General Jean Kaseya told a virtual meeting of African heads of state in Burundi.

His warning, which echoed a similar projection by the US CDC, referred to the outbreak that affected Guinea, Liberia and Sierra Leone in 2014 to 2016, which killed over 11,000 people, and a



Congolese healthcare workers attend a Ebola response training camp at a treatment centre in Bunia, DR Congo. FILE

less deadly 2018 outbreak.

A Red Cross official said separately on Tuesday that the Ebola epidemic in eastern Democratic Republic of the Congo had not yet peaked. “We are afraid that this could last one year to end this disease,” Bruno Michon, operations manager for the International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, said.

Africa’s CDC is seeking \$518 million for a joint plan with WHO aimed at containing the outbreak. “If we don’t have it in the next four weeks, we will not ask again for \$500 million, we’ll be asking about \$1.5 billion. It will be \$7.5 billion if delay,” Kaseya said.



Former Palestinian soccer player Fadi Al-Arawi (right) watches a 2026 World Cup match streamed on a laptop alongside others in Khan Younis, in the southern Gaza Strip, on Tuesday. REUTERS

Amid ruins, Gaza watches World Cup

Reuters
Gaza, Cairo, June 16

FADI AL-Arawi, a footballer in the Gaza Strip Premier League, hasn’t been able to take the pitch since pro sports were suspended with the outbreak of war more than two years ago. Like most Gazans, he no longer even has a home where he can watch the World Cup on TV.

As Saturday’s match between Qatar and Switzerland was about to get under way, he wore his old Gaza Sports Club professional uniform and medals he had picked up at in-

ternational competitions.

He hovered in the darkness over a flickering laptop, trying to get an internet signal to watch the match with a group of friends in a room in a school converted into a shelter for Gazans displaced by Israel’s campaign.

“See, this is the internet, it’s starting to cut out and the match hasn’t even started yet,” Al-Arawi, 38, told Reuters in Khan Younis as Israeli drones hummed overhead. “Can you hear the drones? We might live or die, we might be bombed.”

Much of Gaza was destroyed and its infrastructure heavily

damaged during Israel’s two-year military assault in the territory, launched after the October 2023 Hamas attacks.

Alaa Babil, who runs the Royal Cafe in Gaza City, installed two alternative power lines and a backup battery to ensure late-night matches can still be screened once fuel-powered generators shut down after midnight. “The cafe could be targeted,” he said. “Something next to me could be targeted and I could lose my life... But despite everything we are suffering, we are continuing, and we will watch the matches.”

US Air Force B-52 bomber crashes in California, killing 8 crew on board

Reuters
Los Angeles, June 16

A US Air Force B-52 Stratofortress bomber crashed on take-off on Monday at Edwards Air Force Base in Southern California’s Mojave Desert, bursting into flames and killing all eight crew members aboard, Air Force officials said.

The eight-engine, jet-powered aircraft, built to carry a wide array of nuclear and conventional bombs, was on a routine test mission when it crashed on the runway at Edwards just after leaving the ground, Air Force Colonel James Hayes said at a press conference hours later.

A towering pall of black smoke billowing from the crash site was visible for miles immediately after the accident.

He said the “mixed crew” aboard the aircraft consisted of government civilians, government contractors and uniformed military personnel.

The flight was intended to support a radar modernization program, Hayes told reporters. The cause of the crash was unknown and under investigation, he added. Air Force officials did not name the victims, saying they were still in the process of notifying their next of kin.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED KINGDOM

Prince George to follow father’s footsteps, join prestigious Eton



Prince George attends a carol service at Westminster Abbey. FILE

BRITAIN’S PRINCE George, the 12-year old grandson of King Charles, will follow in the footsteps of his father and attend the prestigious Eton College later this year, Kensington Palace said on Tuesday. George’s father, the heir to the throne Prince William, and his uncle Prince Harry also attended Eton, one of Britain’s most elite schools. “Kensington Palace can confirm Prince George will attend Eton College from September,” William’s office said. REUTERS

ZIMBABWE

Nine dead, 25 injured after bus and train collide

POLICE AND rail authorities say at least nine people, including two children, are dead after a train collided with a bus in Zimbabwe. The crash occurred at a railway crossing in Triangle when a freight train collided with the bus, according to police. National Railways of Zimbabwe spokesperson Andrew Kambura said the bus driver failed to stop and check for oncoming trains before crossing the tracks. He said at least 25 were hurt. AP

INDONESIA

6.7-magnitude quake causes damage, injuries

A 6.7 MAGNITUDE earthquake shook part of central Indonesia’s Sulawesi island Tuesday, injuring dozens of people, damaging homes and infrastructure and rattling residents of a city devastated by a quake and tsunami eight years ago, officials said. The initial quake was centred inland about 43 kilometres east-southeast of Palu, and the US Geological Survey said it was about 10 kilometres deep. AP

• A.I. SYSTEMS UNDER DEVELOPMENT CAN AUTONOMOUSLY IDENTIFY OBJECTS LIKE ENEMY VEHICLES AND EVEN SINGLE OUT PEOPLE — LIKE ENEMY SOLDIERS

How Ukraine uses AI to knock out deadly Russian drones

Maria Varenikova
June 16

AT A launch site deep in a pine forest in central Ukraine, five men in balaclavas removed a camouflage cover from a lightweight replica of a Russian-made Shahed drone. “Pull!” one man shouted, and the winged, triangular drone flew up over the trees.

Standing nearby was a miniature black rocket with four propellers. This was the PI-Sun Long, one of Ukraine’s first interceptor drones powered by artificial intelligence. Trained to find and knock down Shahed-type aircraft, it, too, took off.

The PI-Sun reflects both the

Ukrainian military’s embrace of AI and the rapid evolution of its defenses against Shaheds. Russia fires the drones — essentially flying bombs — into Ukrainian cities in relentless daily waves, destroying infrastructure, killing civilians and sowing terror.

Earlier in the war, Ukraine relied mostly on heavy machine guns, electronic warfare and occasionally missiles to bring down Shaheds. Last August, the Ukrainian military began to widely deploy interceptor drones piloted by humans, without AI.

Now, a major Ukrainian drone manufacturer, SkyFall, which conducted the recent test in the forest, says its interceptors



A Shahed drone replica is prepared for launch during training. NYT

have made dozens of AI-assisted strikes on Shahed-type drones since November, among thousands of interceptions overall.

The interceptor drones are

among a range of AI-powered weapons that have been deployed in recent months after being trained on the immense troves of data that the war has

produced.

These weapons include unmanned ground vehicles equipped with machine guns that use AI to help them quickly identify small quadcopters known as FPV drones, because of the first-person view they offer to remote pilots. AI is also used in so-called terminal guidance systems, in which a weapon locks onto a target in its final approach and completes its strike without further human intervention.

Many AI systems under development can autonomously identify objects like enemy vehicles. Some, in a more sensitive potential application, can single out people, like enemy

soldiers. SkyFall is among those quietly testing people-targeting capabilities in Ukraine.

AI developers and Ukrainian leaders say they are aware of the risks as the war spawns a technological revolution. As an era of fully autonomous lethal weapons approaches, human rights groups say reducing life-or-death decisions to an algorithmic calculation is a threat to humanity. At the same time, Ukraine is eager to use any technology that can increase its interception rate against Shaheds, and that means turning to highly automated air defenses.

As of now, AI does only part of the work. Humans remain involved in critical aspects. NYT



Ukraine’s President Volodymyr Zelenskyy and Prime Minister Yulia Svyrydenko visit the Dormition Cathedral of the Kyiv Pechersk Lavra which was hit by a Russian missile strike on Monday. REUTERS

FRIDGES, ACs ARE AMONG 9 ITEMS THAT MAKE UP JUST 1% OF ENTIRE CPI BASKET OF GOODS & SERVICES

The memory chip problem that is slowly feeding into inflation

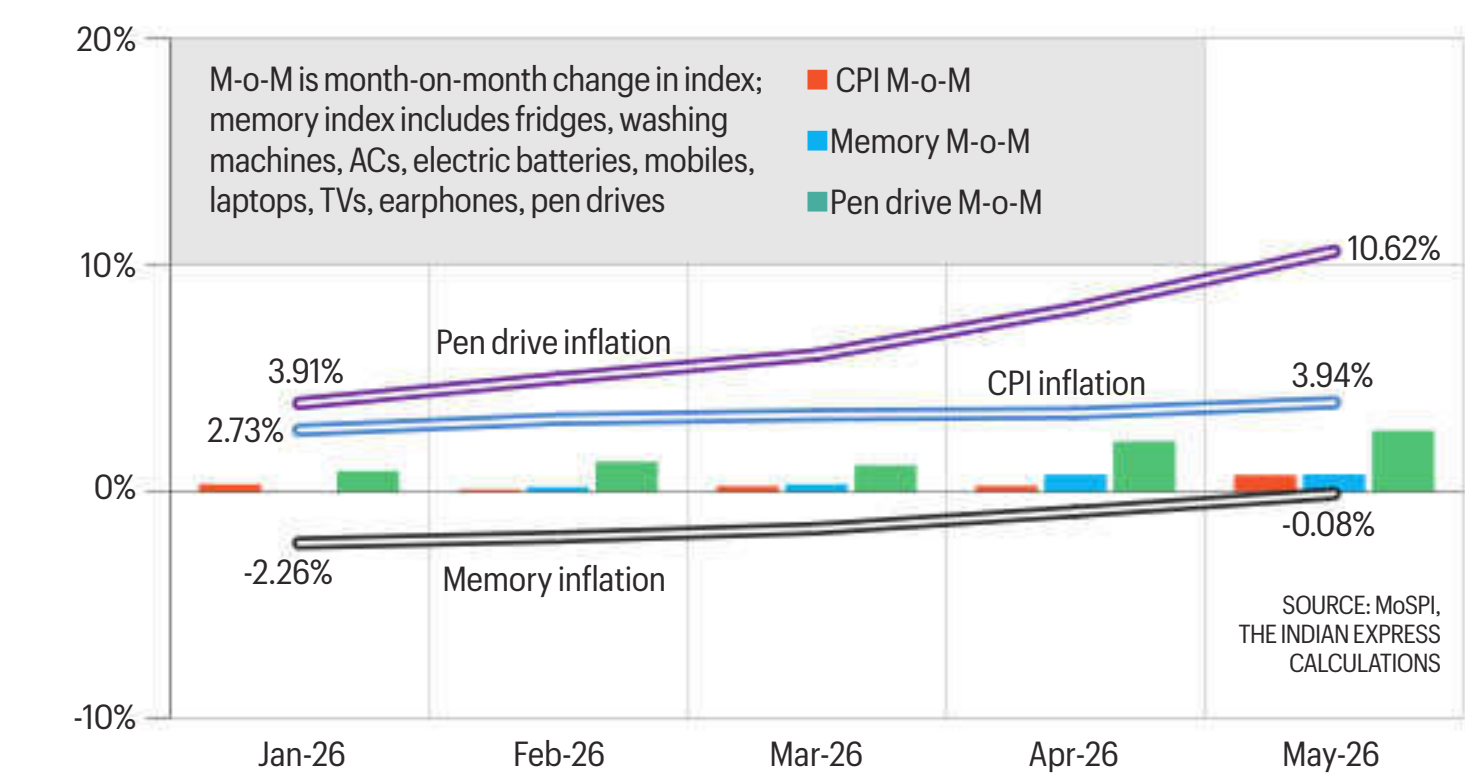
Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 16

FRIDGES, WASHING machines, air conditioners, electric batteries, smartphones, laptops, televisions, earphones, and... pen drives — over the last few months, each of these items have seen their prices rise from one month to the next, to varying degrees, all because of one minuscule component that is common to them all: memory chips. Together, these nine items make up just 1% of India's entire Consumer Price Index (CPI) basket of goods and services. But they are increasingly exerting upward pressure on headline retail inflation and may continue to do so for years.

The global investment boom in artificial intelligence (AI) has led to key chip suppliers such as TSMC, Samsung, and SK Hynix experiencing unprecedented growth over the last year.

What it has also done is pushed these manufacturers to make the more in-demand and advanced chips used in data centres sprouting up all over the world. What is being sacrificed are DRAM (Dynamic Random Access Memory) and other chips used in everyday electronics goods such as refrigerators, washing machines, ACs, smartphones, laptops, TVs, and earphones. The result of the supply shortage of the chips essential to consumer electronics is a mass-

● Risk to inflation in India from global AI super-cycle



ive rise in their prices. And electronics manufacturers are now passing on these higher chip prices to consumers so much so that it's even reflecting in the country's headline retail inflation data.

Memory inflation

In May, the price index for laptops, computers, and tablets was up month-on-month for the seventh month in a row. For mobiles, it was six months; for fridges, washing machines, and TVs, it was four months. And three months in a row for ACs, electric batteries, and headphones and earphones.

But the largest and longest sequential price rise has been for pen drives and hard disks.

Pure memory storage devices, the price index of this category has risen sequentially in 15 of the last 16 months — the period covered by the new CPI series with 2023-24 as the base year. The inflation impact of the price increases announced by phone and other electronic goods manufacturers has not been very high. But month-on-month increases in the price indices of refrigerators, washing machines, ACs, phones, PCs, and TVs are either already at 1% or approaching it. The figure

for pen drives and hard disks is nearing 3%. Policymakers across the world are already taking note of this new source of inflation.

Last month, economists from the Federal Reserve wrote of the "unprecedented contribution" to core inflation by the rapid price increases seen in the "Computer Software and Accessories" category of the US's Personal Consumption Expenditures price index.

A structural shortage

In India, the contribution to inflation of the nine items mentioned above has been rather small, partially because they

only make up 1% of the entire CPI basket; compare that with the three TOP vegetables (tomato, onion, potato) that account for nearly 2% of the CPI. Moreover, electronics manufacturers don't pass on higher input prices as quickly and substantially as farmers. Why? Because manufacturers already have a substantial profit margin built into the final price. However, the price increases announced so far are already hurting sales.

The India problem

As it turns out, not all buyers may be locking in long-term deals. Sumit Sadana, executive vice-president and chief business officer at Micron, told a media outlet last month that the US chip manufacturer's Indian customers were probably not understanding the gravity of the situation. He said that in terms of long-term demand, it was difficult to get "reliable signals" from Indian customers and what the company needed at this point was a "commitment" to such demand and not just an indication. The prospects for consumer electronics prices — and retail inflation — for Indians are not bright, then. The RBI currently expects CPI inflation to average 5.9% in the final three months of 2026. By then, the contribution to inflation from these electronics goods may be much higher. **FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM**

MORE EXPENSIVE PHONES & PCS

How consumers are now quietly paying for AI boom

Soumyarendra Barik & Anil Sasi
New Delhi, June 16

SMARTPHONE SALES, especially those at the budget end of the spectrum, are beginning to hit a wall, thanks to the surging price of RAM — basic memory that once was one of the cheapest smartphone and computer components — which has more than tripled in value since October 2025.

The cost of memory as a percentage of the total cost of a low-end phone has surged from under 10% to over 40% now.

Like phones and laptops, rising memory costs could end up impacting other electronic devices such as smart TVs and medical devices.

The single biggest reason for the surge in memory cost is the explosive growth in the data centres which power AI, which has started to fall back on RAM (random-access memory) now from the previous heavy reliance on graphics processing units (GPUs).

What that's leading to is a longer usage duration of smartphones especially in price-sensitive markets such as India.

And the proportionate increase is higher in the lower end of the market, where price elasticity is higher.

AI has triggered a global memory shortage by pushing chipmakers to divert production towards lucrative high-bandwidth memory used in data centres, leaving less conventional DRAM (dynamic random-access memory) available for smartphones and PCs and driving up prices across the electronics supply chain.

AI boom hits budget phones, computers

According to a report by market intelligence firm Counterpoint Research, memory will account for a massive 43% of the total bill of materials (BOM) for smartphones priced under Rs 20,000 (\$200), and their whole BOM may climb by as high as 25% in 2026. For top-end phones, priced above Rs 80,000, BOM costs could rise by Rs 10,000-Rs 15,000 by the second quarter of 2026. Bill of materials is the total cost of all components and materials required to manufacture a product, excluding expenses



Soaring memory costs are projected to drive worldwide smartphone shipments to drop by 8.4% in 2026. REUTERS

such as marketing, distribution and taxes, and is a crucial metric used by manufacturers to assess profitability and pricing strategy. Senior analyst at Counterpoint, Shenghao Bai noted, "The memory price surge is delivering a structural impact to smartphone BOM costs. In 2026, OEMs will struggle to balance component costs, gross margins and shipment targets. Those who rely heavily on entry-level models to drive market share will face a significant risk of short-term losses." The way that manufacturers will mitigate these rising costs, according to Counterpoint, is by reducing expected shipment targets for low-end models, downgrading non-core specifications to offset costs, and simply passing the cost on to customers.

"Considering the massive memory price surge, standard cost-cutting measures may only result in limited returns. A rise in retail prices seems unavoidable in 2026. We expect low-end retail prices to increase by around \$30, while the cost pressures on some premium flagships will likely be passed on to consumers, resulting in price hikes of \$150 to \$200," Shenghao said.

Soaring memory costs are projected to drive worldwide PC shipments to decline 10.4% and smartphone shipments to drop by 8.4% in 2026, compared to 2025 levels, according to Gartner, Inc., a business and technology insights company.

States' development, welfare spending surges 131% in 10 years: CAG

New Delhi: States' aggregate expenditure rose sharply by 131% between 2015-16 and 2024-25, keeping pace with economic growth, as they focused on welfare and development activities, said a CAG report Tuesday.

Revenue expenditure continued to dominate budgets, averaging over 83% of total spending, while capital expenditure increased in absolute terms but remained a relatively smaller share. "Social and economic services together accounted for about two-thirds of total expenditure, reflecting states' focus on welfare and development," said the CAG's Publication on State

Finances 2024-25. The report was released by the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG), K Sanjay Murthy. Committed expenditure and subsidies consistently absorbed more than half of revenue expenditure, reaching 53.31% in 2024-25, with subsidies growing particularly rapidly. At the disaggregate level, states' expenditure remained concentrated in 8 object categories — including 3 types of grants-in-aid, salaries, pensions, interest payments, subsidies and major works — accounting for nearly 78.46% of total spending and about 12.38% of combined Gross State Domestic Product. PTI

RBI relaxes ECLGS 5.0 norms

ENS Economic Bureau
Mumbai, June 16

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) on Tuesday allowed banks and other regulated entities to assign a 0% risk weight on 75% of the eligible guaranteed exposure under the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0, easing the capital treatment for such loans, it said in a notification.

"Exposures guaranteed under the ECLGS 5.0 shall attract risk weight of zero percent to the extent of 75% of the guaranteed portion, i.e., to the extent of guaranteed portion wherein the settlement amount is expected to be received within thirty days from the date of invocation. The re-

As of June 10, more than 1.06 lakh loans worth over Rs 48,484 crore had been guaranteed under ECLGS 5.0, with 96% of the guarantees extended to MSMEs

maining exposure shall attract risk weight as per the extant guidelines," the notification said.

The central bank amended the capital adequacy norms for scheduled commercial banks, all-India financial institutions, small finance banks, regional rural banks,

urban cooperative banks and non-banking financial companies.

The move follows the government's introduction of ECLGS 5.0 in May to provide guaranteed credit support to sectors such as — micro, small and medium enterprises (MSME), non-MSMEs and airline sector — facing liquidity challenges arising from the prevailing external geopolitical situation.

According to the Department of Financial Services, the scheme has crossed the one lakh guarantee mark in just over a month.

As of June 10, more than 1.06 lakh loans worth over Rs 48,484 crore had been guaranteed under ECLGS 5.0, with 96% of the guarantees extended to MSMEs. FE

US apex court setback: TCS to take \$70 mn hit

Urvi Malvania
Mumbai, June 16

TATA CONSULTANCY Services (TCS) will make provision for a one-time additional charge of \$70 million in the first quarter of FY27 after the US Supreme Court declined its appeal for overturning a compensation award in a long-running trade secrets lawsuit. "The company has already provided \$150 million in relation to this matter in the books of accounts...and will make necessary provision now for the incremental amount of \$70 million towards damages, interest and legal cost, as a one-time exceptional expense..." TCS said in an exchange filing.

The dispute stems from a lawsuit filed by Computer Sciences Corporation and DXC Technology alleging misappropriation of trade secrets.

In June 2024, TCS disclosed that a US district court had ruled against the company and held it liable for \$56.2 million in compensatory damages, \$112.3 million in exemplary damages and \$25.8 million in prejudgment interest. FE

SpaceX vaults past Amazon's market value as options listing fuels surge

Reuters
Bengaluru, June 16

SPACEX ROARED past Amazon's market valuation on Tuesday and briefly topped that of Microsoft, rapidly scaling the list of the world's most valuable companies on a topsy-turvy trading day fueled by frenzied action in the firm's newly listed option contracts.

SpaceX shares were up 10% at \$211.63 after trading as high as \$225.64, giving Elon Musk's company a market value exceeding \$2.7 trillion — nearly \$1 trillion above its record initial public offering valuation set last week. The shares have surged as investors pile in to bet on SpaceX's sprawling empire, which spans rockets to AI.

A big driver of the early surge was Tuesday's launch of options in SpaceX stock, which confer the right, though not the obligation, to buy or sell the shares at a certain price by a stated date. They are often used by traders seeking to cash in on rising interest in a stock or to wager that shares will rise or fall quickly. More than 500,000 SpaceX options contracts changed hands within the first hour of trading, according to Trade Alert data. SpaceX's heavy bullish options trading volume likely helped lift the stock early in the session, said Brent Kochuba, founder of options analytics service SpotGamma.

● BRIEFLY

Trump says US could let Russian oil waivers lapse

France: President Donald Trump said on Tuesday that the US was now in a position to let Russian oil waivers lapse after reaching an agreement to end the Iran war. "Soon we'll be able to do that, because the oil is now flowing," he told reporters during a meeting with United Arab Emirates President Sheikh Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan at the G7 summit in France. REUTERS

TaMo PV aims for industry-leading growth in FY27

New Delhi: Notwithstanding macro and geopolitical uncertainties, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles is confident of delivering industry-leading growth in FY27, led by a robust pipeline of new launches and multi-powertrain offerings, according to its Chairman N Chandrase-

karan. Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles and its British arm Jaguar Land Rover will continue to collaborate on manufacturing, technology and people, enhancing scale efficiencies, accelerating learning and reinforcing capital discipline, he said in his letter to share-holders in the firm's annual report for 2025-26. PTI

Gems, jewellery exports in May dip 2.49%

Mumbai: India's gems and jewellery exports declined by 2.49% year-on-year in May to \$2,047.89 million (Rs 19,573.96 crore) led by high gold prices and supply constraints, Gem and Jewellery Export Promotion Council said. Exports were at \$2,100.21 million (Rs 17,896.16 crore) for the same period last year, according to GJEPC data. The decline was primarily driven by a sharp contraction in Plain Gold Jewellery exports, GJEPC said. PTI

● MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▲	US Dollar ▼
76,808.48	23,989.15	₹1,50,663	₹94.56
544.15	135.25		
0.71%	0.57%	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
		₹2,49,179	\$82.84

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JUNE 15, 2026

KERALA STATE ROAD TRANSPORT CORPORATION
Transport Bhavan , Fort P.O, Thiruvananthapuram- 695023
E-TENDER NOTICE

Name of Item	Last Date of Bid submission
Implementation of an INTEGRATED CASE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (CMS) FOR KSRTC Pre-bid meeting: 19.06.2026, 02.30 pm	25.06.2026, 06.00 PM

For the detailed tender document visit:
www.etenders.kerala.gov.in/,
www.keralartc.com/tenders/purchase, e-mail: edpc.krtc@kerala.gov.in

sd/-
Chairman & Managing Director

16.06.2026

Government of India, Department of Space
ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPRC)
Mahendragiri P.O., Tirunelveli District, Tamil Nadu-627133, India
CORRIGENDUM

16.06.2026

In continuation to the e-NIT notifications published, the sale period for the below-mentioned works is extended up to 29-06-2026.

- Vertical extension of Main Building at IPRC, Mahendragiri. (Civil, PH, Electrical & AC works) (No.: IPRC/CMG/TD/e-10/MW/CMP-02/2026-27, Dated: 22-05-2026) (Estimated cost: ₹ 565.00 Lakhs)
- Construction of LVMS3 Hardware storage facility at IPRC, Mahendragiri (Civil, PH, Electrical, Mechanical & AC works) (No.: IPRC/CMG/TD/e-11/MW/CMP-03/2026-27, Dated: 22-05-2026) (Estimated cost: ₹ 1259.59 Lakhs)

For eligibility criteria and other details, interested tenderers may please refer to the detailed bilingual (Hindi-English) Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT) on the website <https://www.isro.gov.in/Tenders.html> and tender free view at <https://www.tenderwizard.com/isro> Group Head, CMG

NMDC Limited
(A Government of India Enterprise)
'Khanji Bhavan', 10-3-311/A, Castle Hills, Masab Tank, Hyderabad - 500028.
Telephone : 0091-40-23538713 to 23538721 Ext : 229 / 138, 23538710
Email : kvbhaskar@nmdc.com, kvprakash@nmdc.com

Global Tender Notice (E-Procurement Mode Only)

Tender No. NMDC/HO/MM/PURCH/PP/2026/3 Dtd. 16-06-2026
(MSTC Ref no : NMDC/Hd Office/Material Management/6/26-ET/167)

E-tenders are invited for following items from reputed manufacturers directly or through their dealers / accredited agents through MSTC portal website https://www.mstcecommerce.com/eproc/home/nmdc/buyer_login.jsp.

Description	Qty (No)	Pre-bid meeting date	Display & Sale of Tender Documents Period	Last date & Time for submission of offer
Supply, Supervision of Erection & Commissioning with 12 years / 32,000 Hours (whichever will be earlier) of Cost Cap of 05 Nos. of Hydraulically Operated Wheel mounted Front End Loaders of 8-9 cubic meter derated bucket capacity for Bachelhi (03 Nos.) & Kirandul (02 Nos.) Complexes.	05	23-06-2026	FINAL 07-07-2026 to 28-07-2026	28-07-2026 By 02.30 PM (IST)

Prospective bidders may visit our websites : www.nmdc.co.in ; CPP Portal <https://eprocure.gov.in> ; <https://mstcecommerce.com> and may download the tender documents. Any corrigendum to the above tender notice will be uploaded on our website and MSTC e-portal only.

CGM (Materials)

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF ANDHRA PRADESH LIMITED
(A Government of Andhra Pradesh Undertaking & an ISO 27001:2022 Certified Company).

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The APTRANSCO invites bids online for Spec.No.PMM32-e-47/2026: Supply of 2 Nos. 220V, 850AH VRLA Battery banks.
Date & Time of availability of above tender : 24.06.2026 at 6:00PM. Website: www.tender.apecprocurement.gov.in. Contact No.CE/Transmission:0866-2429230.
R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/83/26-27 Sdr.-CHIEF ENGINEER/TRANSMISSION

SBIL

Strategic Training Unit, Corporate Centre, Madame Cama Road, Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400021

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL FOR SELECTION OF CONSULTANT / INSTITUTE

Offers are invited from reputed consultants / institutes for organizing a programme on Design thinking. For details, please see Procurement News at Bank's website <https://sbil.bank.in>.

Sd/-
Deputy General Manager (L&D)
(STU Department)

Place: Mumbai
Date: 17.06.2026

SBIL

Information Security Department, State Bank of India, Global IT-Centre, Sec-11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai-400 614

Corrigendum - 5

Ref: SBIL/GITC/ISD/2026-27/SOC/1442 Dated: 06.04.2026

State Bank of India (SBIL) has issued Request for Proposal (RFP) for Setting up Cyber Defence Centre. For details, please visit 'Procurement News' at <https://sbil.bank.in> and e-tender portal (<https://etender.sbi/SBI>). Eligible bidders, based on the criteria in the RFP notice, may obtain the full RFP upon payment of the tender fees up to 03:00 PM on 24.06.2026. Corrigendum-5 of the RFP may be downloaded from e-tender portal (<https://etender.sbi/SBI>).

Last date and time for Bid submission: Up to 05.00PM on 30.06.2026

Dy. General Manager (SOC)
Information Security Department

Place: Navi Mumbai
Date: 17.06.2026

ARTIFICIAL LIMBS MANUFACTURING CORPORATION OF INDIA
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
G.T. Road, Kanpur-209217
Visit us : www.alimco.in
Phone- +91 79852 03608.

OPEN TENDER NOTICE

Online Bids (Technical & Price Bid) are invited for Renovation & Construction Works as per details indicated below:

Bid number	Category of Items	Qty.	Approx. Value (Rs.)	Due Date of Opening
PT/OT/02/BE/ dated 15.06.2026	Renovation of existing toilets at PMD-VK ALIMCO, Paharganj, New Delhi.	01 Job	Rs. 28,28,500.00 (Including GST)	14.07.2026

Interested Tenderers may download the tender document from ALIMCO website www.alimco.in (for reference only) and CPPP website <https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app>. Tenderers are requested to submit their Offers/Bids through E-Tendering Process only on CPPP website. The Technical Bid will be Opened on as indicated above. ALIMCO reserves the right to reject any or all requests/Offer without assigning any reason.

Note: For any corrigendum in the tender, Tenderers may please visit CPP portal and ALIMCO web-site.

For ALIMCO DGM (Projects)

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Alamdar Hussain Hedri @ Mohd Hazi Alamdar, S/o Mohd Abbas Hedri, R/o H.No. 6, Street No.1, Shahi Masjid, Rashid Market, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051, have changed my name to Alamdar Hussain, for all purposes. 0040860823-1

I, ABDHESH S/o Ram Prakash Sharma, B-119, Mehla Mohalla, Madanpur Khadar, Delhi-76 have changed my name to AVDHESH SHARMA. 0071042365-1

I Sakshi Ahuja Pathak W/o J.S. Pathak R/o 25-C, Road No-01, Ashok Nagar, Holy Angel School, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand - 834002, have changed my name to Sakshi Pathak 0071042362-1

I Pawan Kumar, S/o Dalveer Singh, R/o HN 17 Bhopa Mohalla Fatehpur Beri New Delhi, have changed my name to Pawan Tewatia. 0130065805-2

I,hitherto known as MANVIKA DEOL,D/o- Sh.Jai Deol, R/o-177,Ek Jot-Apartment, Gate.No.2,Jeevan Hospital, Ashram,New Delhi, Ashram, PO-Jungpura,Distt. South-Delhi,Delhi-110014,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as MANVIKA OBEROI. 0040860927-7

I,VISNHU BANSAL,S/O-PARLAD PRASAD BANSAL,R/O,H.NO-4/1724-A,4TH FLOOR,GALI NO-7,RAMA BLOCK,BHOLA-NATH NAGAR,SHAHADRA, DELHI-110032,have changed my name to VISNHU BANSAL,for all, future purpose. 0040860928-8

I,VIRENDER SINGH BHATI,S/O,BHO PAL SINGH, R/O A-236,A-BLOCK, SECTOR-122,NOIDA, GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR,UTTAR PRADESH-201301, have changed my name to VIRENDRA SINGH BHATI. 0040860901-6

I,VIRENDER S/O JEET RAM SHARMA R/O 232,C-5,SECTOR-31,NOIDA, DISTT-GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR,U.P.,state that my father's name has been wrongly mentioned in passport as Geet Ram. Correct name is Jeet Ram Sharma. 0040860926-2

I,VINOD KUMAR SHARMA S/O PREM CHAND R/o H.N.-145 First Floor,Indira Vihar,Delhi-110009, have changed my name to VINOD KUMAR. 0040860901-1

I,Tabasum Wajeda, W/o Jalal Khan, R/o 3250, Fourth Floor, Kucha Tara Chand, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Wajida Tabassum, permanently. 0040860901-10

I,Surender Jain,S/o-Jaipal Jain,R/o-77,Binauli, Baghpat,UP-250345,have changed my name to Surender Kumar Jain. Surender Jain and Surender Kumar Jain is one and the same-person. 0040860901-12

I,Shashi W/o Vijay R/o 8/177, Sant Colony, Bahadurgarh Distt Jhajjar (Haryana)-124507, have changed my name to Shashi Dhamija for all Purposes. 0040860927-5

I,Saraswati Mondal W/o Khokan Mondal R/O,H-39/77, Laxmi-Park, Nangloi, West-Delhi, Delhi-110041, have changed my-name to Bijali Mondal for all-purposes. 0040860928-6

I,Sanjay Pal,s/o-Des Raj,r/o- House-no-905,Sector-7 Ext.,Urban Estate,near Vivekanand-Public School,Gurgaon,Haryana-122001, have changed my name Sanjay Pal to Sanjay Sapra for all purpose. 0040860927-8

I,SNEHA D/O NIKKA RAM SHARMA,R/O-WZ-105 PLOTNO.42 SECOND-FLOOR RAM-NAGAR ADARSH MANDIR-VILLAGE CHAUKHANDI TALAK-NAGAR,DELHI-110018.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SNEHA SHARMA. 0040860901-3

I,Natasha Ahuja W/o Gautam Walia R/o House No.-65/57, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Central Delhi, Delhi- 110005, have changed my name to Natasha Walia 0071042305-1

I,SARITA W/O VIVEK GUPTA R/O A-1/187 PASCHIM VIHAR,DELHI-110063.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SARITA GUPTA FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0040860901-2

I,Ram Kishore Bhadana,S/o-Khajan Singh,R/o F-1802,Ibiza Town,Sector-39, Surajkund, Faridabad,Haryana-121009,have changed my name to Ram Kishore,for all purposes. 0040860928-2

I,Rajsi Katiyar,W/o-Rohit Singh,R/o P-704,Block F,Tower Blueberry,Green-Arch, Techzone-4,Greater Noida-West,G.B.Nagar,J P-201306,have changed my name to Rajsi Katiyar Singh,for all, future purposes. 0040860928-10

I,RAGHUVINDER,S/O-SIS PAL SINGH,R/O RZ-25A, DHARAMPURA-COLONY NAJAFGARH DELHI-110043,have changed my name to RAGHUVINDER SINGH,for all, future purposes. 0040860901-5

I, Mohammad Nadeem Khan, S/o Mohammad Naseem Khan, residing at D-308, Vivek Vihar, Sector-82, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201304, have changed my name to Nadeem Khan and shall hereafter be known as Nadeem Khan for all purposes. 0071042353-1

I,Premvati Bhadana,W/o-Ram Kishore,R/o F-1802,Ibiza Town,Sector-39, Surajkund Faridabad Haryana-121009, have changed my name to Prem Wati for all purposes. 0040860928-3

I,Preeti thakran,w/o-Sanjeew pawar,address-53-D,village Besarai,P.O. Huazkhas new delhi,have changed my name to Preeti pawar for all future purposes. 0040860928-7

I,Paras Choraria,S/o Sumer Mal Choraria,R/O B-33,East Krishna Nagar,Delhi 110051,have changed my name to Paras Kumar Choraria,for all purposes. 0040860927-10

I,POOJA GUPTA,W/O-MAQSOOD ALI,R/O-KH.NO-38/7,RIGHT PORTION,4TH FLOOR,STREET. NO-4,NEAR-MOTHER DAIRY, SANGAM-VIHAR, JHARODA MAJRAA,NORTH DELHI-110084,Changed my name to TABASSUM MAQSOOD for all, future purposes. 0040860927-2

I,PARKASH/PRAKASH BHARDWAJ S/O SULTAN SINGH R/O D-4 VEENA ENCLAVE NANGLOI DELHI-110041.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PARKASH BHARDWAJ. 0040860927-1

I,Nazneen Parveen,W/o-Md Muzibul,R/o-H.No.257, PKT-7,Sec A-10,Punarvas Colony,Narela, Delhi-110040,have changed my name to Nazni Parveen,for all future purposes. 0040860927-11

I,Narayan Dass,S/O-Anurudh Choubey,R/O H.no.D-67 S G-M-Nagar NH-4, Faridabad, Haryana-121001,Have changed my name to Narayan Choubey,for all,future purposes. 0040860951-1

I,Mohd Muzibul,S/o- Md Mukeem,R/o-H.No.257, PKT-7,Sec A-10,Punarvas Colony,Narela, Delhi-110040,have changed my name to Md Muzibul,for all future purposes. 0040860927-12

I,Mohammad Faheem,S/O-Karimuddin,R/O-Flat.no.20005, Durian Tower-18, Mahagun,Mywoods,Sec-16C, Greater-Noida West,G B.Nagar,UP-201306,have changed my name to Mohd Faheem,for all,future purposes. 0040860928-9

I,KM Prachi Srivastava,W/o-Abhishek Sinha,R/o-Flat.No.1201,12th-Floor, Tower-C,Mulberry-County,Sector-70, Ballabgarh, Faridabad, Haryana-121004,have changed my name to Prachi Srivastava. 0040860927-3

I,KESHAR BHATI,W/O, VIRENDRA SINGH BHATI,R/O A-236,A-BLOCK,SECTOR-122,NOIDA,GAUTAM BUDH NAGAR,UTTAR PRADESH-201301,have changed my name to KESAR BHATI. 0040860901-7

I,KARUNA GROVER W/o Hitesh Grover,R/O C-5,Ashoka Niketan,Delhi- 110092,have changed my name to KARUNA CHUGH for all future purposes. 0040860951-3

I,Juma Saha,W/o-Debasish Saha,R/o-70,Panchabati, Sodepur,Panihati,Distt. North-24,Parganas,West-Bengal-700113,have changed my name to Juma Saha,wide-Affidavit No.IN-DL33274945272947Y dated-15/06/2026. 0040860927-9

I,JEOFFREY MATHEW S/O Aman Mathew,R/o-783, Sunlight Colony 2, Hari Nagar, Ashram,New Delhi-110014, have changed my name to JEFFREY MATHEW permanently. 0040860928-4

I,JAGMOHAN SINGH JAGGI,S/O-MADAN SINGH,R/O FLAT.NO-101,FIRST FLOOR, SECTOR-3,VAISHALI, Ghaziabad,Uttar Pradesh-201010,have changed my name to JAG MOHAN SINGH,for all,purposes. 0040860927-4

I,IMRAN,MLIK,S/o-AKBAR ALI,R/o,H.No-132,Gali.No.-4,-E-Block,Chand Bagh Delhi-94,declare that in my name Mohd Imran khan in school records, my names has been wrongly recorded as MOHD IMRAN KHAN, whereas the correct names is IMRAN MALIK.In future, my name should be known as IMRAN MALIK only. 0040860928-11

I,Deepika Agarwal, W/o Shri Etesh Agarwal, R/o ED-29-B, ED-Block, Pitampura,Delhi-110034, have changed my name from Deepika Rani to Deepika Agarwal. 0040860901-9

I,Deepak,S/o-Anil Kumar,R/o- House No-5267,Gali No-2,Nangla Enclave Part-2, Faridabad,Haryana-121005, have changed my name to Deepak Mittal,for all purposes. 0040860928-1

I,DIKSHA PUNJ D/o-Sanjay Kumar Sharma R/o-747,C.A.Apartment,A-3 Block, Paschim Vihar,New Delhi-110063, have changed my name to DIKSHA SHARMA, permanently. 0040860951-2

I, MINAKSHI KUMARI W/o Ghanshyam Kumar, 301, Police Chowki Road, Sector-21D, NIT, Faridabd-121001, have changed my name to MINAKSHI JAISWAL. 0071042345-1

I, HARIJOT SINGH KOHLI S/O DIVJOT KAUR R/O D1/20, BHARTI NAGAR, NEAR KHAN MARKET, LODHI ROAD, PO: LODHI ROAD, DIST: CENTRAL DELHI DELHI-110003 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO HARIJOT SINGH FOR ALL PURPOSES. 0071042341-1

I,Chetna D/o Mr Rajkumar R/o-J-173 Saket,New Delhi-110017 have changed my name from Chetna to Chetna Thagela for all purposes. 0040860901-11

I,Babli Kumari,Mother of Heemani Kumari,Father of Baanish Kumar,R/o-H.No.8, Hasanpur,Bhopawar,Kausham bi, Ghaziabad,U.P.-201010,Avni Kumari and Heemani Kumari are the one and same person. 0040860926-1

I,ADITYA JAISWAL,S/O,OM PRAKASH JAISWAL, R/O,PLOT. NO.1076,SF-1,SECTOR 01, VASUNDHRA, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201012, have changed my name to AADITYA JAISWAL. 0040860901-8

I, Sreya R Krishna, D/o Sh Unnikrishna Kurup R Resident of C-61, Soochana Apartments, Vasundhara Enclave, East-Delhi, Delhi-110096, Have changed my name from Sreya Resmy Krishna to Sreya R Krishna. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of Sreya R Krishna for all future purposes. 0040860818-1

I, Sourabh Malik S/o, Sh. Vijay Kumar Malik, resident of Flat 418, Tower-10, Purvanchal Royal Park, Sector-137, Noida, Uttar Pradesh -201305 do hereby declare that I have changed my name from SORABH MALIK to SOURABH MALIK and henceforth I shall be known as SOURABH MALIK in all purpose, vide affidavit no. IN-UP17378217374339Y sworn before the Notary Public at Noida, Uttar Pradesh on 20th Day of April, 2026, SOURABH MALIK and SORABH MALIK both are same and one identical person 0071042304-1

I,Unnikrishna Kurup R, S/o Sh Raveendran Nair Resident of C-61, Soochana Apartments, Vasundhara Enclave, East-Delhi, Delhi-110096, Have changed my name from Unnikrishna Kurup Raveendran Nair to Unnikrishna Kurup R. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of Unnikrishna Kurup R for all future purposes. 0040860819-1

I,Nisha Pillay,D/o Chandran Pillay,R/o 20/306, New Moti Nagar Delhi-15 have changed my name to Nisha Pillay. 0040860901-4

I,Shahrukh Ansari S/o Mohammad Dilshad Ansari r/o 1831, Hathhi Khana, Azad Market, Delhi-110006, have changed my name to MOHAMMAD SHAHRUKH ANSARI for all purposes. 0040860828-1

I, Sarvesh S/o Ram Ujagir R/o C275, Street-5, Gagan Vihar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Sarvesh Nishad. 0071042355-1

I, Sachin Jain S/o Satish Kumar Jain,R/o-C-9/152, Sector-7,Rohini, Delhi-110085,Have changed my minor daughter's name from Aarvi Jain to Hridya Jain. 0040860826-1

I, SUNIL KUMAR SHARMA C/o Parmanand Sharma, Maszid Wali Gali,15, Gali No-8, Sangam Vihar, Delhi-62, have changed my name to SUNIL SHARMA. 0071042361-1

I, Ritu w/o Pushpender Dhir r/o House No.-38, Upper Grounder Floor, Pocket-6, Sector-22, Rohini, Delhi-110086 have changed my name as RITU DHIR permanently. 0040860852-2

I, R. Rishab S/o Rajan Kumar R/o No.249, 3rd Main, Parasmani Blossom Door No.401 4th Floor, Chamarajpet, Bangalore South, Bengaluru, Karnataka - 560018, have changed my minor daughter's name from Ruthveen Jain aged 11 years to Riya Jain forever 0071042364-1

I, R. Rishab S/o Rajan Kumar R/o No.249, 3rd Main, Parasmani Blossom Door No.401 4th Floor, Chamarajpet, Bangalore South, Bengaluru, Karnataka - 560018, have changed my minor daughter's name from Mishri Jain aged 05 years to Misshre Jain forever 0071042367-1

I, Puneet chandok S/o Ashok Chandok R/O Tower-4, 2504, Saya Gold Avenue, Vaibhav Khand, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, UP-201014, have changed my name to Puneet Chandhok for all future Purposes. 0071042299-1

I, Pawan Kumari W/O Manoj Bhardwaj R/O - Block B1,105,Sector 11,Faridabad, Haryana-121006, have changed my name to PURVI BHARDWAJ for all future purposes. 0130065851-1

I, Neeraj Kumar Jain, S/o Narender Kumar Jain, R/o H.No.A-31, Gali No.4, Kaithwara, New Usmanpur, Shastri Park, Delhi-110053, have changed my name to Neeraj Jain, for all purposes. 0040860816-1

I, Nasim Ahmad S/o Imamoodin R/o-190, Aryapuri Kairana Dehat, Shamli, UP, have changed my name to Nasim Ahmad. 0071042357-1

I, Murshida D/O Mazrul Islam R/O/F-117 J.J. Colony Wazirpur Ashok Vihar Delhi - 110052. In my educational document mother's name wrongly mentioned as ARJINA but correct and actual name is Arjina Begum for all purposes vide Affidavit no. IN-DL32352071674034Y Date 13-06-2026. 0040860820-3

I, Anupam Kumar Asharam Sharma S/o Asha Ram Sharma R/O 108 C, Block-C, Express View Apartment , Sector-105, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh have changed my name to A. A. Sharma permanently. 0040860830-1

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Mohd Sharukh S/o Fikre Alam R/o C-248, Gali No.-10, Mulla Colony, Gharoli, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 318/2022, U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Gazipur, East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mohd Sharukh** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohd Sharukh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Mohd Sharukh** the said accused of **FIR No. 318/2022, U/S 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Gazipur, East Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
East Distt., Court No.-16,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/8083/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Adnan, S/o: Akbar @ Gullu R/o: C-202, Thokar, No. 4, Sahin Bagh, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 226/2025, U/s: 109(1)/332(B)/189(4) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Adnan**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Adnan**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Adnan**, of **FIR No. 226/2025, U/s: 109(1)/332(B)/189(4) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-3
South East Room No. 512
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/8062/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Vaseem, S/o Shakeel, R/o. H.No. 372, Gali No. 8, Takkowali, Matiya Mahal, Delhi Gate No.1, Delhi, Central**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 415/2020, U/s. 354/354B/323/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Shastri Park, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Vaseem**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Vaseem**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Vaseem, FIR No. 415/2020, U/s. 354/354B/323/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Shastri Park, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to anshwer the said complaint on or before **17.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Rishika Srivastava,
Judicial Magistrate First Class
(Mahila Court-01), Court No. 67. 4th Floor,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/8056/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. PC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person is/are: **Md. Aftab Khan, S/o. Abdul Karim Khan, R/o.: Mohan Badiyaam, P.S. Sankri, Distt. Madhubani, Bihar Also at: Gali No. 2, Sukh Nahar, Prem Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.220/2019 U/S 279/337 IPC** registered at **P.S. Paschim Vihar East, Outer District, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Md. Aftab Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Md. Aftab Khan** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Md. Aftab Khan**, accused of **FIR No. 220/2019 U/S 279/337 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar East, Outer District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.07.2026**.

By Order, **Moksha Bains,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II (West),
Room No. 206, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi.

DP/8065/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Pankaj S/o Devender Kumar R/o H. No. U-78 30 Foota Road, Phase-04 Lok Vihar, Karawal Nagar, North East Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 392/2022, 304/2022 U/s 135/138 I.E ACT, PS Karawal Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Pankaj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pankaj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Pankaj in FIR No. 392/2022, 304/2022 U/s 135/138 I.E ACT, PS Karawal Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.07.2026**.

By order
Sh. Ashish Rastogi
Additional Sessions Judge-05
East District, Court No. 21, 1st Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/7909/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons **(1) Naresh Kumar, S/o Govind Ram (2) Veena W/o Naresh Kumar both R/o C-81, Yadav Nagar, Samaypur, Delhi** have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence case **(1) Naresh Kumar- FIR No.1135/2021, (2) Veena- FIR No.1119/2021 u/s 135 Electricity Act. at P.S. Samaypur Badli, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the **(1) Naresh Kumar, (2) Veena** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the **(1) Naresh Kumar, (2) Veena** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the **(1) Naresh Kumar, (2) Veena** accused of **FIR No.1135/2021 & FIR No.1119/2021 u/s 135 Electricity Act. at P.S. Samaipur Badli, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **27.07.2026**.

By Order: **Shri Prashant Kumar,**
Additional Sessions Judge-(Electricity), North-West,
Court No. 316,
Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/8106/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Sanjay, S/o Shyam Bihari R/o H.No. U-524, Gali No. 2, 2nd Pusta, Usmanpur, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR: 586/2022, U/s. 25 Arms Act**, registered at **P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Sanjay**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Sanjay**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Sanjay, FIR: 586/2022, U/s. 25 Arms Act**, registered at **P.S.: Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
(Central) Court No. 138. First Floor,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8088/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manoj @ Raju, S/o: Kalyan Singh, R/o: Village Kalyanpur, Distt. Aligarh, U.P.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 80039009/2024, U/s: 406/411 IPC, P.S. Raja Garden Metro, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Manoj @ Raju** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Manoj @ Raju** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manoj @ Raju of P.S. Raja Garden Metro, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ankur Panghal
JMFC-05, West, Room No. 336-A,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8059/METRO/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Harjinder Singh S/o Santokh Singh R/o Village Hardo Sheikh, PS: Nurmahal, Post - Bhandal, Teh.-Phillaur, Jalandhar, Punjab-144039** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 121/2019 u/s 419/420/120B IPC & 12 PP Act at P.S. IGI Airport, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Harjinder Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Harjinder Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Harjinder Singh** accused of **FIR No. 121/2019 u/s 419/420/120B IPC & 12 PP Act at P.S. IGI Airport, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **31.08.2026**.

By Order: **Sh. Pranav Joshi,**
Addl. Chief Judicial Magistrate-01,
Court No. 02, Ground Floor, Main Building,
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

DP/8026/IGIA/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons, **Jahur, S/o Khalil Rehman R/o H.No. 352, J-Block, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC NI ACT : 80041900/2024, U/s: 379/411/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Mundka, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Jahur**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Jahur**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Jahur, CC NI ACT : 80041900/2024, U/s: 379/411/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Mundka, Delhi**, are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06,
West Delhi, Room No. 355
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7889/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

 कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, केन्द्रीय मण्डल, उत्तराखण्ड जल संस्थान जल भवन, 'बी' ब्लॉक, नेहरू कालोनी, देहरादून										
पत्रांक : 227 / ई-निविदा / 2026-27						दिनांक: 16.06.2026				
ई-निविदा सूचना										
उत्तराखण्ड जल संस्थान की ओर से केन्द्रीय मण्डल, देहरादून द्वारा निम्न सामग्री की आपूर्ति हेतु ई-निविदा, टू-बिड सिस्टम (तकनीकी बिड एवं कॉमिश्नियल बिड) आधार पर निम्नानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है।										
निविदा सं.	कार्य विवरण	धरोहर धनराशि रु.	ई-निविदा प्रश्न डाउनलोड करने की तिथि एवं समय	ई-निविदा अपलोड करने की प्रारंभ एवं अंतिम तिथि व समय	ई-निविदा सूचना क्र.सं. 7 अनुसार नूतन प्रश्न विभाग में जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	तकनीकी बिड खोलने जाने की तिथि एवं समय	निविदा की वैधता	क्रि-बिड मॉडिंग की तिथि एवं समय		
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9		
04 / 26-27	वार्षिक दर अनुव्यय पर, ISI marked H.D.P.E. Pipe material grade P.E. 80 for Pressure rating 6 Kg/cm² and 10 Kg/cm², conforming to IS specification: 4984-2016 or its latest amendment(s) की आपूर्ति।									
	5,49,000.00	20.06.2026 from 11:00 a.m.	27.06.2026 from 11:00 a.m. to 04.07.2026 upto 5:00 p.m.	06.07.2026 upto 5:00 p.m.	07.07.2026 at 11:00 am.	90 days	24.06.2026 at 11:00 a.m.			
05 / 26-27	वार्षिक दर अनुव्यय पर, Multijet domestic mechanical water meter class-B, dry dial, magnetically coupled, tamper proof conforming to IS 7799-1994 or ISO: 4064 IP68 of different sizes की आपूर्ति।									
	9,10,000.00	22.06.2026 from 11:00 a.m.	03.07.2026 from 11:00 a.m. to 10.07.2026 upto 5:00 p.m.	13.07.2026 upto 5:00 p.m.	14.07.2026 at 11:00 am.	90 days	29.06.2026 at 11:00 a.m.			
ई-निविदा से सम्बन्धित समस्त जानकारीयं व शर्तें उत्तराखण्ड की वेबसाइट www.uktenders.gov.in एवं विभागीय वेबसाइट http://ujs.uk.gov.in पर ऑन लाइन देखी / प्राप्त की जा सकती है।										
New Delhi					"जल संचय-जीवन संचय"					अधिशासी अभियन्ता



MAJ IS BABBAR, KC (POSTHUMOUS)

A Gallant and selfless soldier who made the supreme sacrifice on 17 June 2003 when he executed a successful operation killing three terrorists. His valour will remain a beacon for us & future generations. Remembering the departed soul and sharing our sorrow

with Babbar Family.

Commanding Officer & All Ranks (Dogra Gunners Family)



11 GORKHA RIFLES REGIMENTAL CENTRE
Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, Late Rfn Mita Bahadur Limbu of 1/11 Gorkha Rifles (Batalik) who made the supreme sacrifice in Naga Hills on 17 June 1967.

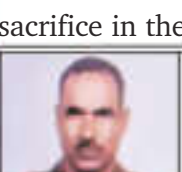
Colonel 11 GR & Sikhim Scouts and All Ranks BORDER SECURITY FORCE



SH B B YADAV
ASSISTANT COMMANDANT
112 BN BSF
09-07.1959
- 17.06.2004

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Officer Sh. B B Yadav, Assistant Commandant on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained grievous injuries, while fighting militants in Iqbal Market area, Sopore, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Satish Kumar Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice while on operational duty in area of BOP Lalghat, Shillong, Meghalaya.



CONSTABLE SATISH KUMAR SINGH
170 BN BSF
17.01.1982
- 17.06.2022

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Satish Kumar Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice while on operational duty in area of BOP Lalghat, Shillong, Meghalaya.

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Satish Kumar Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice while on operational duty in area of BOP Lalghat, Shillong, Meghalaya.



Veer Balidani Constable Lalman
8 Bn
11-03-1939 To
17-06-1964

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Lalman of 8 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while countering a fierce attack by insurgents on 17 June 1964 in Nagaland. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Jai Pal Singh of 5 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists during an area domination patrol in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 17 June 1991. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Jai Pal Singh
5 Bn
28-07-1966 To
17-06-1991

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Jai Pal Singh of 5 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists during an area domination patrol in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 17 June 1991. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Jai Pal Singh of 5 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating terrorists during an area domination patrol in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir on 17 June 1991. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable/Fitter Parminder Singh
86 Bn
19-07-1971 To
17-06-1999

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Suresh Singh of 6 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Chhattisgarh on 17 June 2008. For his exceptional gallantry and selfless bravery, he was posthumously awarded the President's Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

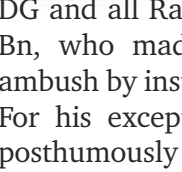
DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Suresh Singh of 6 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Chhattisgarh on 17 June 2008. For his exceptional gallantry and selfless bravery, he was posthumously awarded the President's Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Sahibrao Gangaram Chauhan
86 Bn
26-07-1968 To
17-06-1999

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Suresh Singh of 6 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Chhattisgarh on 17 June 2008. For his exceptional gallantry and selfless bravery, he was posthumously awarded the President's Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Suresh Singh of 6 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Chhattisgarh on 17 June 2008. For his exceptional gallantry and selfless bravery, he was posthumously awarded the President's Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Suresh Singh
6 Bn
01-08-1971 To
17-06-2003

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Suresh Singh of 6 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Chhattisgarh on 17 June 2008. For his exceptional gallantry and selfless bravery, he was posthumously awarded the President's Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Suresh Singh of 6 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in Chhattisgarh on 17 June 2008. For his exceptional gallantry and selfless bravery, he was posthumously awarded the President's Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Head Constable Devi Das
Gubade 65 Bn
01-05-1967 To
17-06-2008

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Balen Harizan of 203 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating Maoists during a search and destroy operation in Girdih district, Jharkhand on 17 June 2016. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

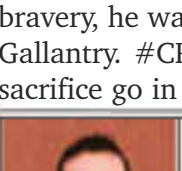
DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Balen Harizan of 203 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating Maoists during a search and destroy operation in Girdih district, Jharkhand on 17 June 2016. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Balen Harizan
203 CoBRA Bn
14-02-1987 To
17-06-2016

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Balen Harizan of 203 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating Maoists during a search and destroy operation in Girdih district, Jharkhand on 17 June 2016. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Balen Harizan of 203 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating Maoists during a search and destroy operation in Girdih district, Jharkhand on 17 June 2016. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Balen Harizan
203 CoBRA Bn
14-02-1987 To
17-06-2016

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Balen Harizan of 203 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating Maoists during a search and destroy operation in Girdih district, Jharkhand on 17 June 2016. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Balen Harizan of 203 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating Maoists during a search and destroy operation in Girdih district, Jharkhand on 17 June 2016. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



Veer Balidani Constable Balen Harizan
203 CoBRA Bn
14-02-1987 To
17-06-2016

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Balen Harizan of 203 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating Maoists during a search and destroy operation in Girdih district, Jharkhand on 17 June 2016. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Balen Harizan of 203 CoBRA Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice after being seriously injured while bravely combating Maoists during a search and destroy operation in Girdih district, Jharkhand on 17 June 2016. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.



VSAKSHAPATNAM METROPOLITAN REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
"e"-Procurement Tender Notice
The VMRDA, Visakhapatnam invites RFP Bids on "e" Procurement Platform for following works

Name of the Project	Tender Notice Nos.	Last Date
REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL for Consultancy Services for Comprehensive Environmental and Social Impact Assessment studies ESIA's and securing end to end CRZ clearance for the Project Enhancing Coastal Resilience along the Visakhapatnam Metropolitan Region	10/2026-27/CE/SE-IEE-IVMRDA Dt:11-06-2026.	26/06/2026 03:00 PM

For further details please login to www.apoprocmurement.gov.in

Sd/- Metropolitan Commissioner, VMRDA

For further details please login to www.apoprocmurement.gov.in

Sd/- Metropolitan Commissioner, VMRDA

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Gulafsa D/o Shehzadali R/o 173, Jhuggi, J.J. Camp, Majboor Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 347/2025 U/s 109(1)/61(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at P.S. Madhu Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gulafsa** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gulafsa** have absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gulafsa of FIR No. 347/2025 U/s 109(1)/61(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at P.S.: Madhu Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 17.07.2026.**

By order

Ashish Kumar Meena
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
Room No. 13, 2nd Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/8121/ED/2026

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Gulafsa D/o Shehzadali R/o 173, Jhuggi, J.J. Camp, Majboor Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 347/2025 U/s 109(1)/61(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at P.S. Madhu Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gulafsa** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gulafsa** have absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gulafsa of FIR No. 347/2025 U/s 109(1)/61(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at P.S.: Madhu Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 17.07.2026.**

By order

Ashish Kumar Meena
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
Room No. 13, 2nd Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/8121/ED/2026

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Gulafsa D/o Shehzadali R/o 173, Jhuggi, J.J. Camp, Majboor Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 347/2025 U/s 109(1)/61(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at P.S. Madhu Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gulafsa** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gulafsa** have absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Gulafsa of FIR No. 347/2025 U/s 109(1)/61(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at P.S.: Madhu Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 17.07.2026.**

By order

Ashish Kumar Meena
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
Room No. 13, 2nd Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/8121/ED/2026

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. DEE/TRD&GSU/J.P, acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders for following works. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **NIT No.:** GSU-EL-TRD-JP-25-26-SR-4; **Name of work:** OHE work in connection with proposed Platform raising (PF-1, 2) of KAWT, KHRA, BAGA, MADA, JILO, APJ, KMNP station; Platform Extension at KAWT, SMPR station and Foot Over Bridge (6 mtr wide) at DBLA, KAWT station in RPC Section of Jaipur Division **NIT Cost (Rs.):** 66,54,103.63/-; **Bid Security (Rs.):** 1,33,100.00/-; **Tender opening date:** 10.07.2026; **NIT No.:** GSU-EL-TRD-JP-2026-27-02; **Name of work:** OHE work in connection with proposed, (i) PF raising (PF-1, 2) of LNH, BUB, RSWT, MWR station; PF Extension at LNH, FPS station & FOB (6 mtr wide) at LNH, BUB, RSWT station, (ii) PF raising (PF-1, 2) of BDHL, BILA, PCMK, RNW, SFE, MNHA station & FOB (6 mtr wide) at BDHL station in RPC Section, (iii) PF raising (PF-1, 2) of RSH, CRWA, NUA, BWPL, BOTR, NRKE station; PF Extension at CRWA Station & FOB (6 mtr wide) at RSH station, (iv) PF raising (PF-1, 2) & FOB (6 mtr wide) at SRGH, NWH, DOB station, (v) PF raising at JJJN Station in SIKR-LHU Section of Jaipur Division. **NIT Cost (Rs.):** 1.81,54,379.18/-; **Bid Security (Rs.):** 3,63,100.00/-; **Tender opening date:** 10.07.2026; **Note:** Date & time of closing e-tenders: On tender opening date Upto 15.00 hours; **Date & time of opening e-tenders:** On tender opening date after 15.00 hours; **Complete details of tender can be seen on website:** <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

Please join us on  /NWRRailways 867-AM/26

Sr. DEE/TRD&GSU/J.P, acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders for following works. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **NIT No.:** GSU-EL-TRD-JP-25-26-SR-4; **Name of work:** OHE work in connection with proposed Platform raising (PF-1, 2) of KAWT, KHRA, BAGA, MADA, JILO, APJ, KMNP station; Platform Extension at KAWT, SMPR station and Foot Over Bridge (6 mtr wide) at DBLA, KAWT station in RPC Section of Jaipur Division **NIT Cost (Rs.):** 66,54,103.63/-; **Bid Security (Rs.):** 1,33,100.00/-; **Tender opening date:** 10.07.2026; **NIT No.:** GSU-EL-TRD-JP-2026-27-02; **Name of work:** OHE work in connection with proposed, (i) PF raising (PF-1, 2) of LNH, BUB, RSWT, MWR station; PF Extension at LNH, FPS station & FOB (6 mtr wide) at LNH, BUB, RSWT station, (ii) PF raising (PF-1, 2) of BDHL, BILA, PCMK, RNW, SFE, MNHA station & FOB (6 mtr wide) at BDHL station in RPC Section, (iii) PF raising (PF-1, 2) of RSH, CRWA, NUA, BWPL, BOTR, NRKE station; PF Extension at CRWA Station & FOB (6 mtr wide) at RSH station, (iv) PF raising (PF-1, 2) & FOB (6 mtr wide) at SRGH, NWH, DOB station, (v) PF raising at JJJN Station in SIKR-LHU Section of Jaipur Division. **NIT Cost (Rs.):** 1.81,54,379.18/-; **Bid Security (Rs.):** 3,63,100.00/-; **Tender opening date:** 10.07.2026; **Note:** Date & time of closing e-tenders: On tender opening date Upto 15.00 hours; **Date & time of opening e-tenders:** On tender opening date after 15.00 hours; **Complete details of tender can be seen on website:** <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

Please join us on  /NWRRailways 867-AM/26

Sr. DEE/TRD&GSU/J.P, acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders for following works. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **NIT No.:** GSU-EL-TRD-JP-25-26-SR-4; **Name of work:** OHE work in connection with proposed Platform raising (PF-1, 2) of KAWT, KHRA, BAGA, MADA, JILO, APJ, KMNP station; Platform Extension at KAWT, SMPR station and Foot Over Bridge (6 mtr wide) at DBLA, KAWT station in RPC Section of Jaipur Division **NIT Cost (Rs.):** 66,54,103.63/-; **Bid Security (Rs.):** 1,33,100.00/-; **Tender opening date:** 10.07.2026; **NIT No.:** GSU-EL-TRD-JP-2026-27-02; **Name of work:** OHE work in connection with proposed, (i) PF raising (PF-1, 2) of LNH, BUB, RSWT, MWR station; PF Extension at LNH, FPS station & FOB (6 mtr wide) at LNH, BUB, RSWT station, (ii) PF raising (PF-1, 2) of BDHL, BILA, PCMK, RNW, SFE, MNHA station & FOB (6 mtr wide) at BDHL station in RPC Section, (iii) PF raising (PF-1, 2) of RSH, CRWA, NUA, BWPL, BOTR, NRKE station; PF Extension at CRWA Station & FOB (6 mtr wide) at RSH station, (iv) PF raising (PF-1, 2) & FOB (6 mtr wide) at SRGH, NWH, DOB station, (v) PF raising at JJJN Station in SIKR-LHU Section of Jaipur Division. **NIT Cost (Rs.):** 1.81,54,379.18/-; **Bid Security (Rs.):** 3,63,100.00/-; **Tender opening date:** 10.07.2026; **Note:** Date & time of closing e-tenders: On tender opening date Upto 15.00 hours; **Date & time of opening e-tenders:** On tender opening date after 15.00 hours; **Complete details of tender can be seen on website:** <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

Please join us on  /NWRRailways 867-AM/26



GOVERNMENT OF ANDHRA PRADESH SAMAGRA SHIKSHA, AMARAVATHI
Tender is invited through e-procurement platform for supply of Student Kit items under "Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan Vidyarthi Mitra" (SRKVM-II) vide Tender Notice NIT No.28/2025, Dt.16.06.2026 in Samagra Shiksha, Amaravati at Patamata, Vijayawada for 01 work in the state of Andhra Pradesh. Tender downloading starts from : 17.06.2026 after 10.30 AM Last date for receipt of Tender : 26.06.2026 upto 05.00 PM **Note :** Further details can be viewed at <https://tender.approcurement.gov.in> or contact +919154294118. Sd/- B.Srinivasa Rao, I.A.S., State Project Director, APSS, Amaravati

DIPR No.5179PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22, Dt.16/06/2026

DIPR No.5179PP/CL/ADVT/1/1/2021-22, Dt.16/06/2026

कार्यालय नगर निगम, भरतपुर

क्रमांक :- न.नि.म./निर्माण-2026-27 / 217 दिनांक :- 09.06.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना-06/2026-27

नगर निगम, भरतपुर द्वारा उपयुक्त श्रेणी में एवं अन्य विभागों के "A"&"AA" श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई प्रोक्चोरमेंट प्रक्रिया से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाइन निविदा दिनांक 13.06.2026 से अन्तिम दिनांक 06.07.2026 तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। जिसमें टेण्डर निविदा की महत्वपूर्ण शर्तें एवं विवरण वेबसाइट <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in/> एवं कार्यालय समय में कार्यालय में देखी जा सकती है।

UBN Number:-
1. DLB2627WSOB07543 2.DLB2627WSOB07544 3. DLB2627WSOB07545
4. DLB2627WSOB07546 5. DLB2627WSOB07547 6. DLB2627WSOB07548
7. DLB2627WSOB07549 8. DLB2627WSOB07550 9. DLB2627WSOB07551
10. DLB2627WSOB07552

राज संवाद / सी / 26 / 5019 नगर निगम, भरतपुर

कार्यालय नगर निगम, भरतपुर

क्रमांक :- न.नि.म./निर्माण-2026-27 / 217 दिनांक :- 09.06.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना-06/2026-27

नगर निगम, भरतपुर द्वारा उपयुक्त श्रेणी में एवं अन्य विभागों के "A"&"AA" श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई प्रोक्चोरमेंट प्रक्रिया से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाइन निविदा दिनांक 13.06.2026 से अन्तिम दिनांक 06.07.2026 तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। जिसमें टेण्डर निविदा की महत्वपूर्ण शर्तें एवं विवरण वेबसाइट <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in/> एवं कार्यालय समय में कार्यालय में देखी जा सकती है।

UBN Number:-
1. DLB2627WSOB07543 2.DLB2627WSOB07544 3. DLB2627WSOB07545
4. DLB2627WSOB07546 5. DLB2627WSOB07547 6. DLB2627WSOB07548
7. DLB2627WSOB07549 8. DLB2627WSOB07550 9. DLB2627WSOB07551
10. DLB2627WSOB07552

राज संवाद / सी / 26 / 5019 नगर निगम, भरतपुर

कार्यालय नगर निगम, भरतपुर

क्रमांक :- न.नि.म./निर्माण-2026-27 / 217 दिनांक :- 09.06.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना-06/2026-27

नगर निगम, भरतपुर द्वारा उपयुक्त श्रेणी में एवं अन्य विभागों के "A"&"AA" श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई प्रोक्चोरमेंट प्रक्रिया से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाइन निविदा दिनांक 13.06.2026 से अन्तिम दिनांक 06.07.2026 तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। जिसमें टेण्डर निविदा की महत्वपूर्ण शर्तें एवं विवरण वेबसाइट <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in/> एवं कार्यालय समय में कार्यालय में देखी जा सकती है।

UBN Number:-
1. DLB2627WSOB07543 2.DLB2627WSOB07544 3. DLB2627WSOB07545
4. DLB2627WSOB07546 5. DLB2627WSOB07547 6. DLB2627WSOB07548
7. DLB2627WSOB07549 8. DLB2627WSOB07550 9. DLB2627WSOB07551
10. DLB2627WSOB07552

राज संवाद / सी / 26 / 5019 नगर निगम, भरतपुर



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice
Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E -Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-N-2026-144

Description of work : Maintenance of 3rd line Between Antri Sithouli section for 24 months under ADEN/LINE/JHS sub division.

Approx Cost : 10116848.81 Earnest Money : 202300.00

Date of completion /period from issue acceptance letter. 24 Months

Date of closing Tender : 06/07/2026 at 15:00 hrs., Tender on line can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 06.07.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1351/26 (D)

North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Buta Singh S/o Jaspal Singh R/o Rehpa, PS Mukundpur, Distt SBS Nagar, Punjab**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 38/2022 U/s 419/420/468/471/120B IPC & 12 PP Act PS: IGI Airport, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Buta Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Buta Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Buta Singh** accused of **FIR No. 38/2022 U/s 419/420/468/471/120B IPC & 12 PP Act PS: IGI Airport, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.08.2026.**

By Order

Sh. Pranav Joshi
JMFC-01, Room No. 02,
Patiala House Court, new Delhi

DP/8029/IGIA/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Buta Singh S/o Jaspal Singh R/o Rehpa, PS Mukundpur, Distt SBS Nagar, Punjab**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 38/2022 U/s 419/420/468/471/120B IPC & 12 PP Act PS: IGI Airport, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Buta Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Buta Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Buta Singh** accused of **FIR No. 38/2022 U/s 419/420/468/471/120B IPC & 12 PP Act PS: IGI Airport, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.08.2026.**

By Order

Sh. Pranav Joshi
JMFC-01, Room No. 02,
Patiala House Court, new Delhi

DP/8029/IGIA/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Buta Singh S/o Jaspal Singh R/o Rehpa, PS Mukundpur, Distt SBS Nagar, Punjab**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 38/2022 U/s 419/420/468/471/120B IPC & 12 PP Act PS: IGI Airport, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Buta Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Buta Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Buta Singh** accused of **FIR No. 38/2022 U/s 419/420/468/471/120B IPC & 12 PP Act PS: IGI Airport, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.08.2026.**

By Order

Sh. Pranav Joshi
JMFC-01, Room No. 02,
Patiala House Court, new Delhi

DP/8029/IGIA/2026 (Court Matter)

Office of Commissioner of Police, Faridabad Sector 21-C, Faridabad Telephone No. 0129-2438000, 2438555

भर्ती सूचना

फरीदाबाद पुलिस में 98 (SPO) विशेष पुलिस अधिकारियों की भर्ती के लिए दिनांक 03 जुलाई 2026 तक आवेदन करने बा।

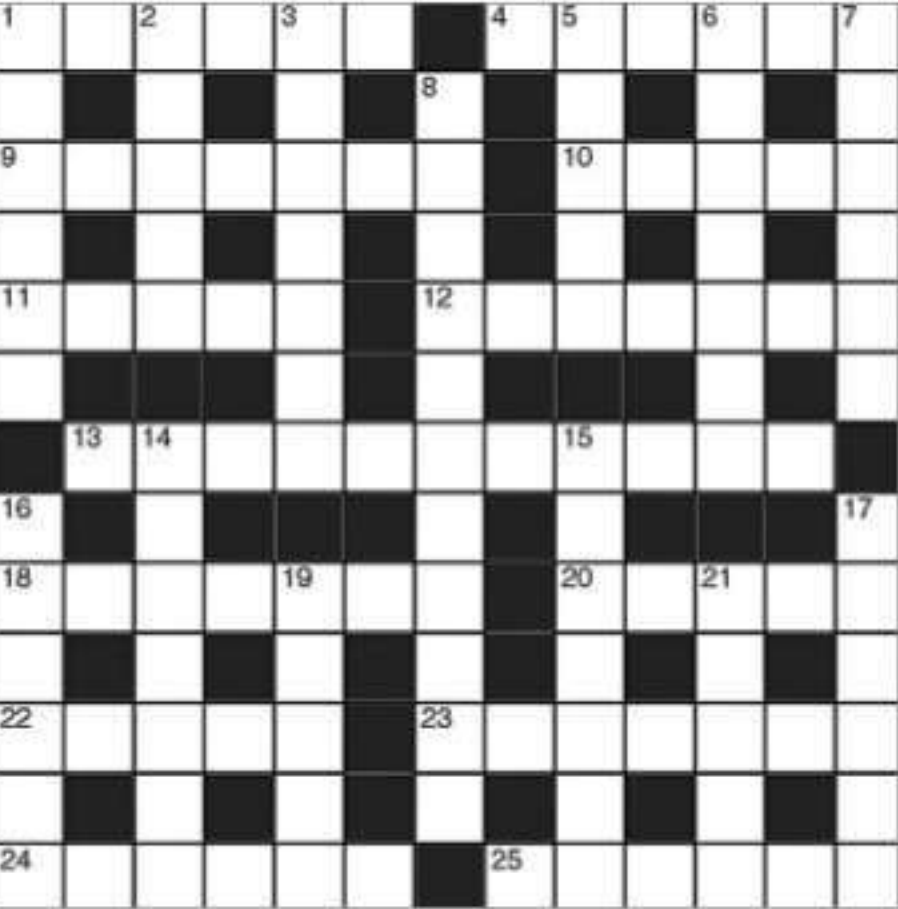
सेना एवं अर्धसैनिक बल के सेवानिवृत्त कर्मचारी, HISF बटालियन के हटाए गए कर्मचारी तथा 2004 में हरियाणा सशस्त्र बल के हटाए गए कर्मचारी को फरीदाबाद पुलिस में विशेष पुलिस अधिकारी (SPO) के तौर पर भर्ती किया जाएगा। इच्छुक आवेदक दिनांक 03 जुलाई 2026 तक व्यक्तिगत रूप में जिला निरीक्षक कार्यालय सेक्टर-21 सी फरीदाबाद में उपस्थित होकर संबंधित आवश्यक दस्तावेजों सहित संपर्क करें।

चयनित उम्मीदवार को 20,000/-रु० प्रतिमाह वेतन दिया जाएगा।

चयनित उम्मीदवार के वेतन से ड्युटी के दौरान हरियाणा राज्य परिवहन में हरियाणा राज्य में नि:शुल्क यात्रा करने के संबंध में 120 रु प्रति माह काटा जाएगा।

भारतीय सेना कि सिगनल कोर्स से सेवा निवृत्त व तकनिकी उपकरणों

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Rises for many members (6)
4 A summary of prices (6)
9 Great at ordering meeting between banks perhaps (7)
10 Ron for example may be beyond help (5)
11 A loyal subject in Belgium (5)
12 Mouthful of water? (7)
13 One of four relatively speaking (11)
18 All thin construction workers build one (7)
20 Trendsetter in wild caper (5)
22 Charmer whose guests made pigs of themselves (5)
23 I meant having a change to liven things up (7)
24 It's used for pounding with a mortar (6)
25 Something like a rush on silver is accepted (6)

DOWN
1 The never-ending round (6)
2 Cosy feature of a mountain glen (5)
3 Bird from the frozen north (7)
5 Just as normal as rain (5)
6 Order I cannot enclose (7)
7 Request to be put on board jets (6)
8 Provide food and support for a lover of greens (11)
14 Lab equipment used to provide the answers (7)
15 Form of sound insulation for playing pop music (7)
16 Officer assisting general in plan that's crazy (6)
17 It's half-day closing pal! (6)
19 Conception many find immaculate (5)
21 A case that can never be completely closed (5)
18 It moves the helicopter up or down (5)
20 Swim before one can walk (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6016 ACROSS: 1 Exhaust, 5 Armed, 8 No great shakes, 9 Steer, 10 Auditor, 11 Catchy, 12 Recipe, 15 Hairnet, 17 Aegis, 19 Budding author, 20 Three, 21 Dreamed **DOWN:** 1 Ernes, 2 Highest bidder, 3 Uneath, 4 Titian, 5 Ached, 6 Make things hum, 7 Deserve, 11 Cohabit, 13 Erasure, 14 Staged, 16 Noise, 18 Shred

JUMBLD WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

_____ is a way of getting the answer yes without asking a clear question - Albert Camus (5)

CARPS

ABISC

SMIRCH

EOPPSH

ANSWER: Charism

question - Albert Camus

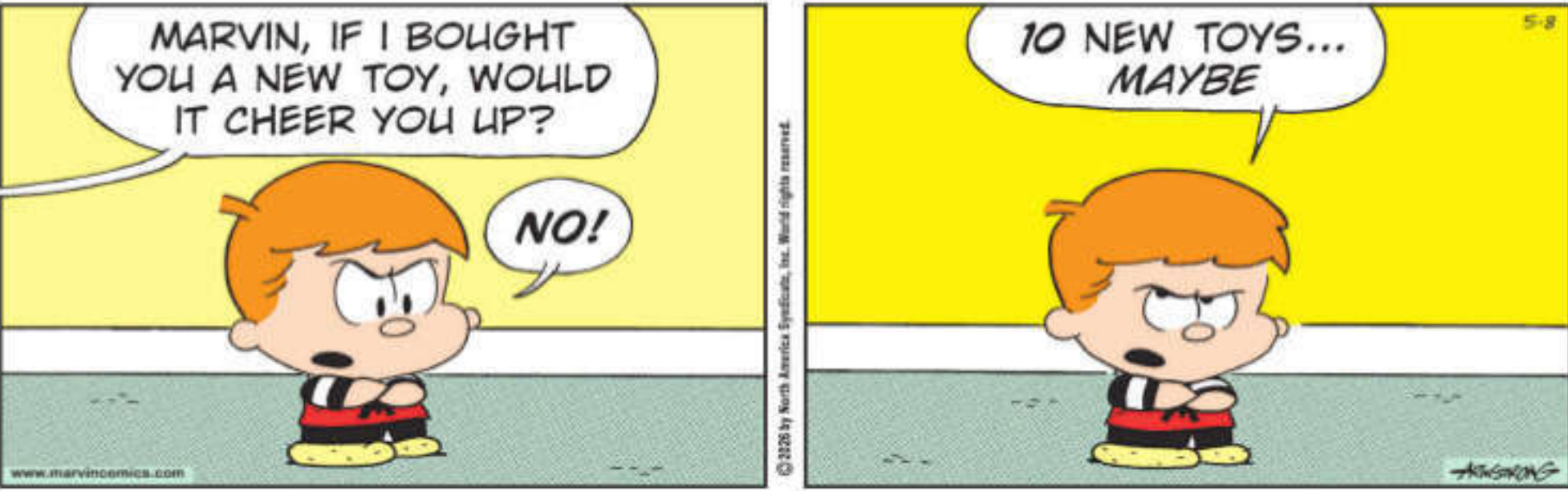
OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



SUDOKU 6352

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s
INSTRUCTIONS
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6351

9	8	3	5	1				
	3	1	9					
5	9		2	4				
5	7			2	8			
2	9			5	1			
2	7	4	8					
5	6	4						
7	1	8	3	5				

ROYAL STARS

Aries (Mar 21 - Apr 20): Your verbal skills are great today. However, parents need to cut their kids some slack because power struggles might arise. Romance can also suffer from ego conflicts and issues related to power and control. Tread carefully. Tonight: Socialise.

Taurus (Apr 21 - May 21): Your well-meaning intentions might backfire when dealing with parents and authority figures today. Perhaps you're coming on a little too strong. You have definite ideas about decorating. Lighten up. Tonight: Relax at home.

Gemini (May 22 - June 21): Steer clear of conflict with others, especially about controversial subjects. They could turn into nasty arguments. The Sun is in your sign and you're powerful right now. Finances favour you. Be careful talking to others today. Tonight: Interesting discussions.

Cancer (June 22 - July 23): Try to avoid power struggles about money and financial control today. These issues might arise. Fortunately, with Venus in your sign, you'll be tactful. Tonight: Check your money.

Leo (July 24 - Aug 23): Today the Moon is lined up with fair Venus, making you eager to get out and socialise. The problem is that at the same time, the Moon is opposite Pluto, which means you might not agree with your friends about social plans. Tread carefully. Tonight: You win.

Virgo (Aug 24 - Sep 23): People admire you today. Furthermore, your relations with friends and groups are warm and smooth. Nevertheless, you might be at odds with someone at work. Patience is your best friend today. Tonight: Enjoy solitude.

Libra (Sep 24 - Oct 23): You like to get along with others because you like harmony in your surroundings. You will feel warmhearted to a friend; however, a difference of opinion could lead to a clash that could be nasty. Tonight: Be friendly.

Scorpio (Oct 24 - Nov 23): Power struggles with authority figures might arise today. You also might find yourself at odds with spouses, partners or close friends. Travel and do something different. Run away. Tonight: You're admired.

Sagittarius (Nov 24 - Dec 22): Power struggles with family members, parents and bosses might create challenges for you today. Fortunately, you have energy to work and get things done. Tonight: Learn and explore.

Capricorn (Dec 23 - Jan 20): It might be tough to avoid money squabbles today. Unfortunately, some challenges will arise. Venus opposite your sign will save the day because you are charming with everyone right now. Tonight: Check your finances.

Aquarius (Jan 21 - Feb 19): You have no choice other than to cooperate with others today to keep the peace and to achieve what you want to do. Avoid power struggles and instead choose a playful outlet like socialising with friends, sports or fun activities with kids. You'll be happier. Tonight: Listen and cooperate with others.

Pisces (Feb 20 - Mar 20): Struggles related to your health, parents and your work might be a challenge today. Instead, escape with some fun socialising. You also might choose to relax at home. Tonight: Get better organised.

Office of the Executive Engineer,
PMGSY Division Jammu
Near DGP(P) Residence Bikram Chowk, Jammu
Phone No.: 0191-2439734

Subject:- Change of critical dates of bids/ Extension of Notice Inviting Tenders.
Ref:- This office e-NIT No. EE/PMGSY/J/16 of 2026-27
Dated :- 05.06.2026 issued vide endorsement No. EE/PMGSY/J/102-108
Dated :- 05.06.2026.
CORRIGENDUM- 01
Due to technical issue, the critical dates of the work floated at S.No-10 in the above mentioned e-NIT have been extended given below:-

S.No.	Particular	Original Date	Revised Date
1	Closing date of downloading bidding documents	13.06.2026	17.06.2026
2	Dead line for submission of bids in electronic format on the website.	13.06.2026	17.06.2026
3	Time and date of opening of received bids on the website	15.06.2026	18.06.2026

Rest all the terms and conditions will remain same as already advertised.
Sd/-
No.:-EE/PMGSY/J/1799-1806 (Er.Bhopinder Kumar Banotra)
Dated:- 15.06.2026 Executive Engineer
PMGSY Division Jammu.
DIP/J-3777/26- DATE 16 JUNE 2026

खुशहाल बागवानी

बगवानी प्रशिक्षण हेतू आवेदन आमन्त्रित

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि बागवानी विभाग, हरियाणा सरकार, उद्यान प्रशिक्षण संस्थान, उचानी करनाल में जून माह में विभिन्न विषयों पर पाँच दिवसीय प्रशिक्षण कार्यक्रम का आयोजन किया जा रहा है। हरियाणा राज्य के सभी जिलों के किसान नीचे दी गई पंजीकरण करने की अंतिम तिथि तक उद्यान विभाग की वेबसाइट <http://kaushal.hortharyana.gov.in/> के माध्यम से ऑनलाइन आवेदन कर सकते हैं। प्रशिक्षण कार्यक्रम के लिए प्रार्थी की न्यूनतम आयु 18 वर्ष होनी चाहिए। प्रशिक्षणार्थियों का चयन पहले आओ पहले पाओ के आधार पर होगा। रजिस्टर्ड किसान अपना आधार कार्ड, बैंक पास बुक तथा पैन कार्ड लेकर आएँ। प्रशिक्षणार्थियों को हरियाणा रोडवेज बस किराया DBT द्वारा प्रदान किया जाएगा। प्रशिक्षण के दौरान ठहरने व खाने की व्यवस्था निशुल्क रहेगी। अतः इसके अलावा यह भी सूचित किया जाता है कि निम्नलिखित विषयों पर पूर्व में प्रशिक्षण ले चुके किसान पुनः उन्ही विषयों पर पंजीकरण न करवायें। चयन की प्रक्रिया पहले आओ पहले पाओ के आधार पर होगी। जून माह के प्रशिक्षण कार्यक्रम की सूची निम्नलिखित है।

महीना	दिनांक	अवधि	विषय	प्रशिक्षणार्थियों की संख्या	पंजीकरण करने की अंतिम तिथि
जून	22-26 जून 2026	5	खुम्ब उत्पादन एवं तुड़ाई उपरान्त प्रबंधन पर प्रशिक्षण कार्यक्रम	40	21.06.2026 सांय 5:00 बजे
जून	29 जून 03 जुलाई 2026	5	फल व सब्जियों में प्रसंस्करण परिरक्षण एवं मूल्यवर्धन पर प्रशिक्षण कार्यक्रम	40	28.06.2026 सांय 5:00 बजे

नोट:- प्रार्थी अधिक जानकारी के लिए कार्य दिवस पर प्रातः 9:00 बजे से सांय 5:00 बजे तक संपर्क कर सकते हैं।
संपर्क: 8570077877
हस्ता/-
प्रधानाचार्य
उद्यान प्रशिक्षण संस्थान,
उचानी, करनाल
No. 46290/HRY

Director Medical Education & Research,
Haryana, Panchkula
4th floor, DHL Square, Plot no.9, IT Park, Sector 22, Panchkula, Haryana- 134112
Ph. No. 0172-2584633, 2560799 email: dmer-hry@nic.in
Website: <https://dmer.haryana.gov.in/>

PUBLIC NOTICE
It is for the information of all Students/Parents and other stakeholders that Department of Medical Education & Research has proposed some amendments in the counseling process for admission to various Medical Education courses for the Academic Session 2026-27.
The proposed amendments can be downloaded from the Department website i.e <https://dmer.haryana.gov.in> and website of Pt. BD Sharma UHS, Rohtak i.e. <https://uhsr.ac.in>. Any comments/objections/observations on the proposed amendments may kindly be sent through email on dmer-hry@nic.in latest by 29.06.2026.
Yashendra Singh, IAS
Director, Medical Education & Research,
Haryana, Panchkula
No. 46293/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH	OLD REFERENCE/NIT NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HVPNL	2026/48B435 8D08 4C8D B41A 9978C111A8401056HP/TENDER ID:-2026_HBC_517830_1/E-TENDER ENQUIRY No.0427202610-41-18/HVPNL DET/HRY.DATED 27.04.2026	*CORRIGENDUM No.04, THE LAST DATE OF ONLINE BID SUBMISSION IS EXTENDED UPTO 22.06.2026 (13.00 HRS)*	www.hvnpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.haryanaprocurement.gov.in OR tenders@nic.in OR 0172-2583789/HRY

CENTRUM

Corporate & Registered Office : Unit No. 801, Centrum House, CST Road, Vidyanagri Marg, Kalina Santacruz (East), Mumbai - 400098, CIN No. U65922MH2016PLC273826

DEMAND NOTICE

Under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with Rule 3 (1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

The undersigned is the Authorised Officer of Centrum Housing Finance Ltd under Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 (the said Act). In exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorised Officer has issued Demand Notices under section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower/s (the said Borrower), to repay the amounts mentioned in the respective Demand Notice/s issued to them that are also given below.

In connection with above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Borrower to pay to Centrum Housing Finance Ltd, within 60 days from the publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated herein below, together with further interest and other charges till date of repayment of the dues in full, as detailed in the said Demand Notices, from the dates mentioned below till the date of payment and/or realization, payable under the loan agreement read with other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Borrowers. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged to Centrum Housing Finance Ltd by the said Borrowers respectively.

Sr. No.	Loan Account No./ Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	NPA Date Sec.13(2) Notice Date FCL Date	Description of secured asset (immovable property)
1	MTCMR24015326 / Narayan Singh / Shelvada Devi	Rs. 4,21,904.00 (Rupees Four Lakh Twenty One Thousand Nine Hundred Four Only)	11-05-2026 09-06-2026 02-06-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Part of Plot No. 49, Khasra No. 12, adm. 52.25 sqmts., Mauza- Masum Nagar Andrun Masum Nagar, Tehsil & Distt. Mathura-281001, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : Part of Plot No. 49 West : Road 20 feet North : Plot No. 50 South : Road 25 feet
2	MTGCM22009177 / Jyendra Kumar / Mintesh Devi	Rs. 10,08,345.00 (Rupees Ten Lakh Eight Thousand Three Hundred Forty-five Only)	11-05-2026 09-06-2026 09-06-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Plot On Mpl No. 461/3-A, Khasra No. 430 Ml. adm. 83.61 sqmts., Village- Kancharpur Ghopla, Pargana, Tehsil & Distt.-Meerut-250103, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : H/o seller West : Rasta 20ft wide North : Plot of seller South : Land of seller
3	MTCSR24015558 / Ladli Devi (Legal Heir of Lt. Pawan Kumar Panjiyara) / Legal Heir of Lt. Pawan Kumar Panjiyara	Rs. 16,36,489.00 (Rupees Sixteen Lakh Sixty Thousand Four Hundred Eighty Nine Only)	11-05-2026 09-06-2026 02-06-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Part of Khasra No. 324, adm. 811.25 sqfts., Gram -Sisouna Musthakam, Pargana & Tehsil- Bhagwanpur, Distt. Haridwar-247661, Uttarakhand. Boundaries:- East : Prop. Of Rampal Saini West : Prop. Of Mandir North : Rasta 20 ft wide South : Prop. Of Others
4	MTGCM24016911 / Dharm Singh / Kanta Devi	Rs. 8,06,538.00 (Rupees Eight Lakh Five Thousand Five Hundred Thirty Eight Only)	11-05-2026 09-06-2026 02-06-2026	"In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Residential Plot Part of Kh. No. 369, adm. 89.01 sqmts., Village Sadullapur Lodhi, Pargana & Tehsil- Bhagwanpur, Distt.-Haridwar-245205, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : H/o Jeevan West : H/o Sanjeev North : Road 8ft wide South : H/o Jagroshni"
5	MTGCM24016924 / Sudesh Pal / Savita Devi	Rs. 8,05,673.00 (Rupees Eight Lakh Five Thousand Six Hundred Seventy Three Only)	11-05-2026 09-06-2026 02-06-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Residential Plot Part of Khasra No. 369, adm. 100 sqmts., Village- Sadullapur Lodhi, Pargana & Tehsil- Garhmukteshwar, Distt.-Haridwar-245205, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : H/o Ratansingh West : H/o Raghunath North : Road 10ft wide South : H/o Sadi
6	VNSGP22007887/ Deo Sharan Sharma/ Amrita Sharma	19,47,167.00 (Rupees Nineteen Lakh Forty Seven Thousand One Hundred Sixty Seven Only)	11-05-2026 15-06-2026 15-06-2026	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Arazi No 489, adm. 1225.05 sqft., Mauza Rampur, Tappa -Rajdhani, Pargana- Haweli, Tehsil- Sadar, District- Gorakhpur-273001, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : 20' wide Road West : Plot Vendor North : Plot Indrawati devi South : Plot Savita Datta

If the said Borrowers shall fail to make payment to Centrum Housing Finance Ltd as aforesaid, Centrum Housing Finance Ltd shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the Act and the applicable Rules, entirely at the risks of the said Borrowers as to the costs and consequences. The said Borrowers are prohibited under the Act from transferring the aforesaid assets, whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of Centrum Housing Finance Ltd. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the said Act or Rules made thereunder, shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.
Place :Uttar Pradesh Date : 17.06.2026
Sd/-, Authorised Officer For Centrum Housing Finance Ltd

GRIDCO LIMITED

(A Govt. of Odisha Undertaking)
Regd. Office: Janpath, Bhubaneswar-751022, ODISHA
Phone: 0674-2543452; Web: www.gridco.co.in

AVAIL POWER AT RS. 4.10 PER UNIT

As per Hon'ble OERC order, eligible commercial & industrial consumers willing to avail green energy at Rs.4.10 per unit, under the Day-Ahead scheduling mechanism, during solar hours (i.e. 08 AM to 04 PM) through a tripartite arrangement with GRIDCO and respective DISCOMs may contact concerned DISCOMs or GRIDCO on E-mail ID : dir.trading@gridco.co.in
OIPR-4001/4056/1/26-27/0013

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Arjun Chopra S/o Ranvir Chopra R/o D-1065, (Near Ashram Chowk), New Friends Colony (Srivinaspuri) New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Ct Case No. 3244/23 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Chittaranjan Park, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Arjun Chopra** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Arjun Chopra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Arjun Chopra** accused of **Ct Case No. 3244/23 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Chittaranjan Park, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shruti Sharma
Jmcc- 02. Room No. 609,
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/8045/SD/2026
(Court Matter)

GUJARAT MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED

(A Government of Gujarat Undertaking)
Regd. Office: Block No. 14/1,
Dr. Jivraj Mehta Bhavan, Sector-10, Gandhinagar
☎ 079-23250767, 23250766, 23257698

TENDER NOTICE NO:GMSCL/ D-30/2026-27

Tenders are invited online from reputed Manufacturers/formulators/ Direct importers for Tablet & capsule, Injection and Miscellaneous Item on Rate contract basis and details of specification, quantity is available on, <https://gmscl.gujarat.gov.in> All tender documents can be downloaded free on the website: <https://tender.aprocure.com> Interested bidders are requested to submit the tender through e-tender process.

Duration of downloading of tender document (online):-
16/06/2026 to 01/07/2026 up to 18.00 Hrs
Last date for Submission (online): 01/07/2026 up to 18-00 HRS
Last date for submission of EMD/Tender Fee (Physical) : 02/07/2026 upto 18:00 HRS
Opening of Technical Bid Date (online): 04/07/2026 At 15-00 HRS.

Pre-Consultation meeting (Pre-Bid)
Interested Manufactures/formulators/Direct Importers are requested to remain present for pre- Consultation meeting to be held on 23/06/2026 at 11:30 am at Committee room at above mentioned address. Only one representative from each Manufacturer carrying authority letter would be allowed to participate in the pre-bid.

INF-600-2026-27
MANAGING DIRECTOR

● RESULTS
GROUP G
Belgium 1-1 Egypt
Seattle Stadium
GROUP H
Saudi Arabia 1-1 Uruguay
Miami Stadium
Iran 2-2 New Zealand
Los Angeles Stadium
● MATCH SCHEDULE
GROUP K
Portugal vs DR Congo
Houston, 10:30 pm
(Wednesday)
GROUP L
England vs Croatia
Dallas, 1.30 am
(Thursday)
Ghana vs Panama
Toronto, 4.30 am
(Thursday)
GROUP K
Uzbekistan vs Colombia
Mexico City, 7.30 am
(Thursday)
ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS

Araujo equaliser saves Uruguay vs Saudi Arabia

MAXI ARAUJO scored a late equaliser to salvage a 1-1 draw for Uruguay in their World Cup opener against Saudi Arabia, preventing another stunning upset in Group H after Spain's earlier goalless draw with Cape Verde. The Saudis looked on course for a shock courtesy of Abdulrahman Alotaibi's 41st-minute strike until winger Araujo stepped up 10 minutes from time. REUTERS



Herve Renard. AP

Tunisia replace coach Lamouchi with Renard

TUNISIA HAVE sacked coach Sabri Lamouchi following a woeful start to their World Cup and have reached an agreement to replace him with Frenchman Herve Renard, Tunis Afrique Presse reported. Renard, twice an AFCON winner, coached Saudi Arabia at the 2022 World Cup and led them to a victory over Argentina in the group stage. REUTERS

Sayak Dutta
Kolkata, June 16

BRUNO FERNANDES once had a coach who told him that if he wanted to be a top player, he should be a central defender, while if he just wanted to be a good player, he should be a midfielder. Bruno ended up choosing the latter and is now proving his prediction wrong and showing that sometimes it's better to listen to one's instincts. "I wanted to be the best out of all of them. And if I need to do a nutmeg on someone, I will do it - I don't care," he said in a Manchester United podcast in 2020. His devil-may-care attitude occasionally does not work in the United setup, where the forwards don't always anticipate the audacious passes that Bruno attempts, resulting in the team giving away possession. But when he pulls them off, and it produces the required result, it's like a breath of fresh air in the stuffy, mechanical world of modern football, where teams mostly play a certain way.

Midfield maestro

The ability to conjure up something out of nothing with just his flair is one of the reasons Bruno has not only evolved into one of the best players in his midfield general role but also moulded himself into the heart-

ISLAND VS A FOOTBALLING NATION - IN NUMBERS

30K

Spain (more than 30,000) has almost 300 times as many clubs as Cape Verde (100-120). Spain has more registered clubs than the number of people residing in Praia (about 190,000).

Leagues apart

All of Spain's squad play in Europe's top five leagues (Premier League, La Liga, Bundesliga, Serie A, Ligue 1), while only one from Cape Verde (Logan Costa, Villarreal) has that distinction.

Short on matches

Spain played their first international game back in 1920, while the Blue Sharks made their maiden appearance only in 1978. They have played 16 African Cup of Nations matches.

Talent pool mismatch

The number of registered football players in Spain (over 1.25 million) is nearly 2.4 times the entire population of Cabo Verde, whose player count stands closer to 5,000.

GDP: Trillions & billions

Spain's GDP (2.09 trillion) is approximately 606 times that of Cape Verde (3.45 billion). Spain per capita income is \$41,563; Cape Verde's \$6,670.

Insta sensation

After his goalkeeping heroics, Cape Verde goalkeeper Vozinha's Instagram following went from 56,000 to well over 6 million in a matter of hours.



ROCK OF CAPE VERDE

Goalkeeper Vozinha's mum couldn't make it to watch mother of all upsets

40-year-old goalie gave his country their greatest night in football but couldn't share the moment with family



Sandip G
Los Angeles, June 16

AS ATLANTA Stadium dissolved into celebration, the person Vozinha searched for was not there.

The tickets had been booked. The bags had been packed. But his mother never made the trip - the visa did not arrive in time. A Cape Verdean flag hung from his shoulders as the goalkeeper ran in joyous circles around the pitch. When television crews finally caught up with him, tears mixed with the sweat on his face. He had just produced seven saves against Spain, seven moments that would carry Cape Verde into football history. Yet when the cameras found him, the tears were not about football.

"She didn't manage to be here because of the visa. Because of the money you have to pay for the visa, we didn't manage on time. I would like her to be here," he said, clutching the player-of-the-match award. Cape Verde was among the countries whose citizens the Trump administration required to post a bond of up to \$15,000 before a US visa would even be considered. Then his thoughts drifted elsewhere. "I cried after the game because I grew up with my grandparents when I was a kid, and they could not be there. They passed away a few years ago."

They call him Vozinha, little grandmother. Growing up on

the streets of São Vicente, he would play football with older kids, lose, and stomp home to his grandparents. The older kids teased him for it. The nickname stuck. At first, Josimar José Évora Dias was not pleased. Eventually he embraced it - and when he moved to Angola for his first spell abroad and found another Josimar already at the club, Vozinha it became permanently. The first name Josimar was itself a tribute to his father's favourite player, the Brazilian right back. On the greatest night of his life, he found himself thinking about the people who were missing from it.

He turned 40 a week before the tournament, the oldest World Cup debutant. Cape Verde, the third smallest nation at this World Cup, ten islands off the West African coast, population 529,000, did not have a structured football ecosystem when Vozinha was growing up on São Vicente. He was 25 by the time he became a professional, moving through obscure leagues in Cyprus, Angola, Moldova and Slovakia before reaching Portuguese second-division side Desportivo de Chaves. He nearly didn't make it here at all. Bruno Varela had become first choice and Vozinha seriously considered walking away entirely. "All my team-mates talked to me, they encouraged me to stay because of the World Cup. I stayed because of that, because it was my dream, the dream of all of us."

On Sunday in Atlanta, the Rock of Cape Verde made Spain's celebrated attack look ordinary. The finest save came two minutes into first-half stoppage time when Aymeric Laporte's glancing header seemed



An emotional Cape Verde goalie Vozinha after he made seven saves in the 0-0 draw against Spain. Fans celebrate in São Vicente. AP

destined for the far corner. Vozinha got there. Earlier he had denied Mikel Oyarzabal another header. It was not only the saves, or the reflexes, but his command of the box, his judgment of when to come and when to hold, his voice organ-

ising the defence, yelling sometimes, encouraging when they made last-ditch interventions. Spain kept probing. Vozinha kept standing in the way.

By full-time, one commentator had already dubbed him the Rock of Cape Verde. The

Cape Verde was among the countries whose citizens the Trump administration required to post a bond of up to \$15,000.

once considered a greater prospect than Paul Pogba and Riyad Mahrez. The 25-member squad contained players born in France, Ireland, Switzerland, the Netherlands, Portugal and Cape Verde itself, all 25 playing for 25 different clubs across 16 countries. What held them together was language. Families scattered across continents had preserved Cape Verdean Creole - a language with words borrowed from French. The culture travelled wherever the people went. With FIFA funding, they built a state-of-the-art stadium. The president wanted to name it after Pelé, before someone told him that the Brazilian had never visited the country. Now, they could perhaps name it after Vozinha.

A lively contingent of supporters, many of them immigrants settled in Massachusetts, filled the stadium with noise.

Centre-back Pico Lopes's parents, brothers and wife's family had come from Ireland, his mother's country. Lopes himself nearly missed his international career entirely - a LinkedIn message from the Cape Verde coach sat unread for nine months before he finally replied. Some players were luckier than Vozinha.

"I would tell 18-year-old Vozinha to be really proud of himself. He worked a lot. To be honest I never dreamt of stuff like this when I was a kid, but after this game I can tell my younger version that it was all worth it."

He would have liked his mother to be at the stadium.

De Bruyne 0, Salah 1: How Egypt star won World Cup duel



Mohamed Salah (R). AP

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 16

FOR THE better part of a decade, the world was in thrall of their feats in northwest England. On Monday, the Kevin De Bruyne-Mohamed Salah duel reprised, now transposed to northwest America. The Premier League giants captained their teams in a taut FIFA World Cup encounter, which stood level after a goal precipitated by another ageing great - Romelu Lukaku. The draw perhaps pleased Egypt supporters more than those of Belgium, but for the neutrals, it was a rare opportunity to see the Manchester City and Liverpool legends cross swords amid different, bigger stakes.

De Bruyne too was looking forward to the reunion with Salah, saying before the game that it would be "nice to compete again like old times". One wonders how 'nice' the Belgian midfield rock still felt, after falling excruciatingly short of scoring on several occasions.

Having slammed a shot wide in the early exchanges, De Bruyne very nearly got it right in the 53rd minute with a free-kick that clattered the woodwork. The Napoli star was to mistime an effort to let go of one more big chance, before getting substituted in the 86th minute. Thibaut Courtois, the third member of the Red Devils' old-guard core, also had an off day. The veteran goalkeeper committed uncharacteristic errors in open play as well as set pieces and was lucky not to concede a second goal, that would have dramatically altered the Group G equations.

Salah made his 34th birthday special by threading through the perfect pass to set up Emam Ashour's 19th-minute scorcher. He was also the second-oldest African player to land an assist at the World Cup since 1966, after Roger Milla (38 years and 42 days).

The Pharaohs' skipper played in a new number 10 role, behind rather than alongside Omar Marmoush. Going into the match, Egypt had won three of their previous four face-offs with Belgium, including a 2-1 friendly victory in 2022. In that game, De Bruyne's blunder just outside his own penalty area had led to Egypt's opener. The result was different, but in a way, history repeated itself on Monday.

PORTUGAL CAMPAIGN STARTS

Bruno holds Portugal's World Cup key



Bruno Fernandes (C) headlines Portugal's midfield at the World Cup. AP

beat of Portugal's creative nexus. While their campaign will march ahead with Cristiano Ronaldo as the face, the strings of their success will be wrapped around the fingers of Bruno and his midfield brethren.

However, the journey to get here hasn't been easy. In the attempt to force Fernandes from playing out of the deep, the Portuguese talisman lost a bit of spark, with frustration boiling over on the pitch. But things improved when Ruben Amorim was sacked, and Michael Carrick came in. The 31-year-old was restored to his No.10 role, and unsurprisingly, in a free role, he thrived and dragged an in-transition United to third in the 2025/26 season. He also broke the Premier League assists record and was adjudged the Player

of the Season.

Regaining his spark

An in-form Bruno could be ominous signs for Portugal's opponents at the World Cup. The maestro will have more freedom in national colours with PSG's Vitinha and Joao Neves for company and on occasions, Manchester City's Bernardo Silva.

This will enable Fernandes to go higher up, close to the opponent's penalty box and lash in a wicked shot towards goal or look for the Hollywood pass, which might work better for Portugal than with Manchester United, with AC Milan's Rafael Leao, Chelsea's Pedro Neto and Juventus' Francisco Conceicao the likely targets down the wings.

With Ronaldo a fading force, Portugal might need Fernandes

Number Plate

29

● Bruno Fernandes, known for breaking the Premier League assist record this season, has 29 goals in 87 appearances, even netting in the warm-up match vs Chile.

to fill in as a goal scorer as and when required. The 31-year-old isn't a slouch in front of goals either, having scored 29 goals in 87 appearances, even netting in the warm-up match vs Chile.

Bruno, however, wants Portugal to do for Ronaldo what Argentina did for Lionel Messi in the 2022 World Cup: Win the entire thing. "I will try my best to make my country proud. Wrapping up this last World Cup with Cristiano winning it would be something amazing. I really hope we can make it happen, not just for Portugal, but for everything Cristiano gave to football and the world," he told Wayne Rooney in a BBC podcast ahead of the World Cup.

With Portugal playing DR Congo on Wednesday, it'll be worth watching if Fernandes can pull the proverbial rabbit out of the hat and win the whole thing or if it'll be another false dawn for him and his side.

DR Congo's story: 52 years, an Ebola outbreak and a squad without a home

Sriram Veera
Mumbai, June 16

ON MARCH 31, 2026, in Guadalupe, Mexico, Axel Tuanzebe scored in the 100th minute against Jamaica. The goal sent DR Congo to the World Cup for the first time since 1974. In Kinshasa, the streets filled. They had waited 52 years for this.

After the game, Cédric Bakambu told FIFA.com: "When we get back to Kinshasa, it's going to be crazy." They never went back.

Six weeks later, on May 15, an Ebola outbreak was declared in DR Congo, the country's 17th since the virus was first identified there in 1976. The outbreak is of the Bundibugyo strain, one of the rarest Ebola viruses, with no approved vaccine and no approved treatment. By June 8, the Ministry of Health had confirmed 515 cases and 91 deaths. The CDC has warned it could become the largest Ebola epidemic on record, rivalling the 2014-16 West Africa crisis that killed more than 11,000 people. The disease has spread to Uganda, which confirmed 19 cases and closed most of its western border.

For the Leopards, the timing could not have been worse. DR



Defender Axel Tuanzebe helped DR Congo qualify for the World Cup for the first time since the 1974 edition. REUTERS

Congo cancelled their training camp in Kinshasa and relocated to Belgium, where most of their diaspora players are based. On June 4, they drew 0-0 with Denmark in Liège, before moving to Marbella. A planned warm-up against Chile was cancelled when the mayor of La Línea de la Concepción banned the match. Desabre offered to play behind closed doors. The mayor refused. The game moved to Orléans, France. The delegation must maintain a 21-day bubble outside the country before entering the United States. None of the players have visited their homeland recently.

Desabre did not flinch. "The only thing I can say is that we're used to adapting. Whatever

The CDC has warned it could become the largest Ebola epidemic on record, rivalling the 2014-16 West Africa crisis that killed more than 11,000 people.

happens, we'll have no problem adapting to all these situations."

The 1974 World Cup, when DR Congo competed as Zaïre under Mobutu Sese Seko's authoritarian regime, is remembered for two things. A 9-0 loss to Yugoslavia. And Mwepu Ilunga running out of the defensive wall during a Brazil free kick to boot the ball downfield.

By many later accounts it was closer to protest than farce. Mobutu had delivered an ultimatum: lose to Brazil by more than three goals and the players should not expect to return home safely. Neither should their families. In the 85th minute, with Brazil leading 3-0, Ilunga sprinted from the wall and kicked the ball away. He later said he wanted a red card. He was trying to get off the pitch. They lost 3-0. They went

home. Fifty-two years is a long time to carry that as your only World Cup memory. This squad is different in every way. Captain Chancel Mbemba has 107 caps. Yoane Wissa of Newcastle is their danger man up front. The squad is drawn from the diaspora, players raised in Europe.

When Tuanzebe scored that 100th-minute winner, he was a Burnley defender playing for the country of his heritage. That he was on the pitch at all had been in doubt. Nigeria challenged his eligibility, arguing that Congolese law banning dual citizenship made his participation illegal. FIFA's Disciplinary Committee rejected the complaint, though Nigeria has since appealed. Aaron Wan-Bissaka, the West Ham right back, once said his aim was England. He came close to a senior call-up in 2019 and never received another. He is in Houston now.

DR Congo will be based in Houston. Their first match is against Portugal. Then Colombia on June 24 in Guadalajara, the same stadium where they qualified. Then Uzbekistan on June 28. The risk to fans is low. The burden on the Leopards is not. The longest wait in the tournament ends on a football pitch in Texas.

PREVIEW: ENGLAND VS CROATIA

Team that refuses to age against youngsters with high ambition

Eight years after semifinal in Moscow, they meet again; Croatia are older, injured and still dangerous

Shuvaditya Bose

New Delhi, June 16

"THEY SHOULD be more humble and respect their opponents more."

Luka Modric's rebuke had arrived with the relief of vindication. It was directed not at England's players but at the journalists and pundits who had spent the week calling Croatia tired, the walking dead, a team running on fumes after three successive extra-time matches. In the 109th minute in Moscow, Mario Mandžukić ended the argument. England went home.

Eight years later, the cast has barely changed. England and Croatia meet again at a World Cup, this time in the group stage in Dallas rather than a semi-final in Moscow. Modric, yet again, leads an aging Croatian squad. England, meanwhile, are the fourteenth youngest team in the competition.

Nowhere is that contrast clearer than in the midfield.

Zlatko Dalić has flirted with experiments recently — he fielded three centre-backs in a friendly against Belgium, Croatia lost, and he promptly returned to the safety of a 4-2-3-1. Should familiarity prevail, Thomas Tuchel can expect to face a double pivot of Modric and Mateo Kovačić, with Andrej Kramarić afforded licence in the number ten role. Together, they have accumulated 427 caps and scored 70 goals for the Kockasti. Their average

age is 35.

Against them: Declan Rice, fresh off a Premier League title with Arsenal; Jude Bellingham, fresh off winning the Champions League with Real Madrid; and Elliot Anderson, one of the Premier League's most reliable defensive midfielders this season. Together, they have made 129 appearances for England — only 298 fewer than their counterparts. Their average age is 24.

Croatia's football carries a weight that statistics cannot measure. At Maksimir stadium in Zagreb in 1990, Zvonimir Boban — Modric's childhood idol — kicked a security officer during a riot between Dinamo Zagreb and Red Star Belgrade. Many Croatians still call it the kick that started the war. The fans of Dinamo Zagreb were among the first to volunteer for the conflict that followed. President Franjo Tudman, who understood football's grip on a people better than most politicians, put it plainly: "Football victories shape a nation's identity as much as wars do."

It is not the same country Modric grew up in. His grandfather — also named Luka — was killed by Serbian forces while tending cattle on the slopes of the Velebit mountains. The family fled to Zadar, where they lived in a refugee hotel for years. Modric played football in the hotel corridor, first with a paper ball, then a real one, going to sleep with it beside him. His childhood home still has a "Mines — Keep



The group-stage fixture will see an inter-generational midfield battle as Croatian veteran Luka Modric (R), 40, takes on England's Declan Rice, 27, fresh off an excellent season with Arsenal. REUTERS

Together, Modric, Mateo Kovacic and Andrej Kramaric have accumulated 427 caps and scored 70 goals. Their average age is 35.

Out" sign. The only thing that interrupted his games was the sirens. "It happened a million times that we were going to training as the shells were falling," a childhood friend recalled, "and we were running to shelters."

Croatia's first FIFA ranking was 117th. They have spent almost an uninterrupted decade among the world's top 20.

Yet even now, Dalić struggles to look beyond a 32-year-old Kovačić — six months sidelined by an ankle injury —

as the long-term successor alongside Modric. Kramarić, too, has been playing through an adductor injury. Modric wears a protective mask after a cheekbone fracture, though even at 40 he started the vast majority of AC Milan's Serie A matches this season.

"We don't have a big roster," Dalić has admitted, "and these are some of our most important players."

England have their own disruptions to absorb. Hours after arriving in Kansas City, a tornado warning sent the squad indoors. Their training equipment was stolen from their base — boots, gloves, kit. Most of it was recovered. Two men were charged. Dean Henderson, asked if his boots had made it, said: "Yeah, thankfully. I think they got stolen but we got them back so it's all good."

Tuchel's squad went through European qualifying with eight wins from eight and a 22-0 goal difference. He could leave Cole Palmer — the face of England's commercial campaigns — out of the squad entirely. Dalić does not have that problem, or that luxury. Modric will likely be at his last World Cup. He begins it against the country he humbled in Moscow. He cannot run a tournament the way he once could. But he does not need to. His value now is in tempo, in positioning, in the unhurried authority of someone who has survived far worse off the pitch.

In what is almost certainly the last World Cup for this generation, they will do what they have always done: outlast the predictions, outlast the pundits, and make England humble again.

Transition needs players willing to fill big shoes, says spin coach Bahutule

Tushar Bhaduri

Lucknow, June 16

"TRANSITION" IS probably the most frequently used word in the context of Indian cricket these days. The national selectors, in consultation with head coach Gautam Gambhir, are ringing in the changes to find out who has the ability to step into big shoes. It's no surprise that along with batting and pace bowling, spin bowling is also getting a lot of attention, with the ongoing series against Afghanistan the perfect stage for trial to avoid possible errors in the future.

With Ravichandran Ashwin long gone and attempts underway to find a successor for Ravindra Jadeja as well, the one-off Test and the three-ODI series is an audition of sorts for Manav Suthar and Harsh Dubey. Kuldeep Yadav is the only senior spinner in the squad, with Axar Patel rested as well. And on the evidence of the two games, the two left-arm spinners haven't done their long-term prospects any harm. Spin bowling coach Sairaj Bahutule is suitably impressed.

"This is a transition time for spinners. I feel Harsh and other youngsters who are coming in and have been given chances, will realise that they have big shoes to fill. They have the capabilities, they have the potential but I think the more they will play, the more they will settle down. Harsh is a player who definitely has that potential and can be a good all-rounder," Bahutule said ahead of the second ODI against Afghanistan in Lucknow.

Suthar took seven wickets — six in the first innings — in the three-day innings win in New Chandigarh, while Dubey bounced back after a tough start in the 25-over ODI in Dha-



Harsh Dubey made his ODI debut against Afghanistan. AP

ramshala.

"He (Dubey) is a player for the future. He has got the skills, he has got a good temperament and has proved it not only in domestic cricket, but that one game which he got last time, he came back very strongly and did very well. So moving ahead, I am sure the more he plays, the more experience he gets and definitely he will enhance his skill," Bahutule gave a vote of confidence.

"For me, every spinner is unique. I am sure in the coming time, Harsh will learn from every game and just grow. The selectors, Gautam and everybody, they are having a look at all the spinners. Those who have the potential, those who have the right attributes, they will definitely be given a chance. That is what the process is. In a transition, you have to identify the right bowler," the spin bowling coach said.

"(This is) definitely a series where different players can be tried to see how they respond to international cricket."

● **India vs Afghanistan, 2nd ODI. Live on Star Sports Network & JioHotstar, 1.30pm.**

'Sooryavanshi provoked, needs to learn'

Tushar Bhaduri

Lucknow, June 16

SAIRAJ BAHUTULE, the spin bowling coach of the senior Indian team, has backed Vaibhav Sooryavanshi in the wake of the heated scenes that unfolded during India 'A's tri-series clash against Sri Lanka 'A' on Monday.

Bahutule, who is currently in Lucknow with the senior side for the ODI series against Afghanistan, said he does not believe the 15-year-old is the kind of player who would lose his composure without provocation. His comments come after India 'A' were beaten in a Super Over, following which tempers flared between players from both sides, leading to a brief but intense aexchange involving shoving before the situation was eventually brought under control.

"I think it was an unfortunate incident, but we don't know how it was provoked. The way I know Vaibhav, he is a very composed boy," Bahutule said on the eve of the second ODI.

The former leg-spinner did admit that the youngster, who has taken the cricket world by storm after his exploits against pedigreed bowlers in the Indian Premier League, needs some guidance on how to stay calm under duress.

"There are experienced coaches around him who will explain it to him. We will make sure that information is given to him as to why that happened. But he will learn. He is a young kid with a lot of responsibilities and is obviously representing India. I think some sort of understanding will be there, and I'm sure he will not repeat it," Bahutule said.

After the game in question, Sooryavanshi and Sri Lanka 'A's Vishen Halambage were seen engaged in a heated conversation, which led to physical contact before Niroshan Dickwella stepped in to defuse the situation.



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली



विश्वास के, विकास के, जनकल्याण के



जन कल्याण शिविर
सेवा, सुविधा और समाधान



18 से 20 जून 2026



सुबह 10:00 बजे से शाम 05:00 बजे तक

केंद्र सरकार एवं दिल्ली सरकार की विभिन्न जन कल्याणकारी योजनाओं की जानकारी पाएं और लाभ उठाएं

सेवाएं

- पैंक कार्ड
- राशन कार्ड
- ई-श्रम कार्ड
- जन धन खाता
- लखपति बिरिया योजना

- पीएम-उदय योजना
- प्रधानमंत्री स्वनिधि योजना
- आधार पंजीकरण काउंटर
- टैलेंट हंट - हौसलों की उड़ान
- राष्ट्रीय वयोश्री योजना (ALIMCO)

- गृह कर (House Tax) संबंधी सेवाएं
- सोलर पावर-प्रधानमंत्री सूर्य घर योजना
- MSME/ उद्योगों के लिए ऋण सुविधा
- "एक पेड़ माँ के नाम" अभियान हेतु पौधा वितरण
- SC/ST योजनाएं : छात्रवृत्ति, उच्च अध्ययन सहायता, जाति प्रमाण पत्र, इत्यादि

- प्रधानमंत्री मातृ वंदना योजना
- विधवा पुत्री विवाह सहायता
- LPSC - DJB के अंतर्गत जल कनेक्शन का नियमितिकरण
- विधवा एवं दिव्यांग पेंशन तथा अन्य पेंशनधारकों के अभिलेखों का अद्यतन
- 70+ आयु के वरिष्ठ नागरिकों एवं BPL कार्डधारकों के लिए आयुस्मान कार्ड



शिविर स्थलों एवं अन्य जानकारी के लिए QR स्कैन करें



Vol XCIV- 188 Regd.No. DL-21046/03-05 R.N.I. No.506/1957. Printed and Published by Ramesh Chander Malhotra on behalf of The Indian Express (P) Limited and Printed at The Indian Express (P) Limited Press, A-8, Sector-7, Noida - 201301 and Published at The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 & 10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Editorial office: The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 & 10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Phone: 0120-6651500. Advertising office: The Indian Express (P) Ltd., Express Building, B1/B, Ramnath Goenka Marg, Sector 10, Noida-201301. Phone: 0120-6651291. Chairman of the Board: Viveck Goenka, Chief Editor: Raj Kamal Jha, Editor: Unni Rajen Shanker, Editor (Delhi): Monojit Majumdar** **Responsible for selection of News under the PRP Act. Copyright: The Indian Express (P) Limited. All rights reserved. Reproduction in any manner, electronic or otherwise, in whole or in part, without prior written permission is prohibited. The Indian Express®





epaper.indianexpress.com



New Delhi





DIP/Shabdarth/Display/037/26-27